The exam consists of THREE mandatory parts.

In the first part, listening comprehension is assessed through 8 multiple choice questions. It is worth 3 points.

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In the third part, written expression is assessed. Here, you may choose ONE of the two given options. It is worth 4 points.

Part 1: Listening comprehension

AN INTERVIEW WITH GOTCHA, THE MUSICAL FORCE

In this podcast you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

to quote: citar textualment / citar textualmente
prone: propens / propenso
bouts: períodes / períodos
harp: arpa

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the podcast.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. When Gotcha explains what inspired "Turning a Blind Eye", what does she say is behind the feeling of defeat? ☐ The pressure of competing with other contemporary Australian musicians. ☐ Her inability to adapt to present-day Australian lifestyle. ☐ Her awareness of how everyday habits lead to overconsumption. ☐ A disappointment about how little artists care about technology.	☐	☐	☐
2. Gotcha finds it difficult to change her environmental habits because ☐ it's hard to know what really helps. ☐ there is too much information, she feels overwhelmed. ☐ she thinks no one else is making an effort. ☐ it's difficult to change long-established habits.	☐	☐	☐
3. How does Gotcha describe the way she sees the future? ☐ She is idealistic most of the time, so her songs are optimistic despite her negative thoughts. ☐ She alternates idealism and deep pessimism about the future, which is reflected in her songs. ☐ She feels the world is as pessimistic as she is, though some people do want to change the world. ☐ She is indifferent about the future, so her songs are never influenced by her emotions.	☐	☐	☐
4. What does touring make Gotcha aware of? ☐ The contrast between her environmentally friendly lifestyle and that of other musicians. ☐ How travelling constantly increases her environmental impact. ☐ How certain hotels contribute to the overall carbon footprint. ☐ How each culture approaches environmental problems differently.	☐	☐	☐
5. How does Gotcha feel about her growing success? ☐ She thinks success always brings joy to anyone. ☐ She fears larger projects will feel less meaningful to her. ☐ She is afraid that fans will expect her to keep things as personal as they have been so far. ☐ She believes enjoying fame will fix her environmental worries.	☐	☐	☐
6. What challenges does Gotcha mention regarding communication on social media as her audience grows? ☐ She now posts more often because she feels she owes it to her new followers. ☐ She is more aware of the diversity of her audience and how that affects her communication. ☐ She prefers to post less because communication with her listeners has become less sustainable. ☐ She feels that social media makes followers focus on what she says rather than on her music.	☐	☐	☐
7. What happens when Gotcha records an acoustic instrument note by note? ☐ The instrument sounds the same as usual. ☐ The resulting sound is amazing. ☐ The instrument as such does not appear in the resulting album. ☐ The sound of the instrument becomes angelic.	☐	☐	☐
8. Gotcha enjoys experimenting with unusual objects to create sounds because ☐ all other artists use traditional instruments, which is uninteresting. ☐ they help her explore a new way to make music and create more original musical stories. ☐ it takes less time than recording traditional instruments. ☐ avoiding experimentation makes her music sound like everybody else's.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

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In the third part, written expression is assessed. Here, you may choose ONE of the two given options. It is worth 4 points.

Part 1: Listening comprehension

A CONVERSATION WITH YAYOI KUSAMA ON THE POWER OF ART AND EMOTIONS

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

art installations: instal·lacions artístiques, creacions artístiques / instalaciones artísticas, creaciones artísticas
polka dots: estampat de rodones / estampado de lunares
boundless: sense límits / sin límites
tapestry: tapís / tapiz

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. How does Yayoi Kusama see the relationship between her work and the emotions it expresses? ☐ The essence of her art is driven by a love for immense chaos and mystery. ☐ Her installations aim to change viewers' perspective on love. ☐ The essence of her art lies in creating a collective supportive feeling. ☐ Her work is meant to reflect the limits of love and hope.	☐	☐	☐
2. Yayoi Kusama created her "Infinity Rooms" to invite people to think about ☐ the problem of mental illness. ☐ the possibility of space travel. ☐ our place in the universe. ☐ mirrors and tapestries.	☐	☐	☐
3. In her autobiography, Yayoi Kusama mentions suffering from mental health problems. How has art affected her? ☐ Art has increased her sense of despair and hopelessness. ☐ Art has given her tools to reverse her suffering and despair. ☐ Art has intensified her need to overcome her mental health problems. ☐ Creating art has cancelled her positive emotions.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to the interviewer, why does Yayoi Kusama paint dots abundantly? ☐ To portray the universe. ☐ As a form of artistic rebellion. ☐ To represent distress. ☐ To create a sense of abundance.	☐	☐	☐
5. What other type of message does Kusama's use of polka dots convey? ☐ The dots represent how the elements of outer space are interconnected. ☐ They serve as a visual metaphor for the chaotic nature of the universe. ☐ Polka dots symbolize how individuals are connected. ☐ The repetition of dots represents individuals' everyday fighting.	☐	☐	☐
6. Why does Yayoi Kusama believe her art can surpass cultural gaps? ☐ Because people from all walks of life visit her installations. ☐ Because her art speaks a language that can be understood by all art experts. ☐ Because her art connects people at the core of their essence as human beings. ☐ Because polka dots are bound to a specific cultural audience.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Yayoi Kusama, why did she choose to leave Japan? ☐ Kusama was aware of her artistic identity in Japan and chose to leave to develop it further. ☐ The Japanese artists did not support her because of her mental health issues. ☐ The Japanese government's restrictions on kimonos made her move. ☐ Kusama had connections in New York that could allow her to succeed as an artist there.	☐	☐	☐
8. How does Yayoi Kusama see the power of art in facing global challenges? ☐ Art has the power of eliminating global uncertainty. ☐ Art inspires people to work together for the common good. ☐ Art helps people see global challenges as an inevitable part of their future. ☐ Art gets people to look into the past and learn from it.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

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Part 1: Listening comprehension

THE WORLD OF CENOTES

In this podcast you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

limestone: pedra calcària / piedra caliza
coral reef: escull de coral / arrecife de coral

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the podcast.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. How does Alison Zicari explain the natural event that gives rise to a cenote? ☐ A river slowly dries up over time. ☐ A cave ceiling collapses and reveals hidden water. ☐ Rainfall digs a hole directly into the ground. ☐ Earthquakes open giant cracks in the soil.	☐	☐	☐
2. Why does the Yucatán Peninsula contain such a high concentration of cenotes? ☐ It was once part of a flat desert that eroded quickly over time. ☐ It is built of giant old volcanic rocks. ☐ It used to be a coral formation that became exposed. ☐ It receives more rain than any other area in Mexico.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to Alison Zicari, the underground rivers below the Yucatán Peninsula are formed by ☐ rapidly melting ice. ☐ water travelling through rock beneath the surface. ☐ lakes draining into deep reservoirs. ☐ ocean waves carving inland tunnels.	☐	☐	☐
4. What have researchers gained from studying cenotes and their connected caves? ☐ Maps of modern underwater cave systems. ☐ Evidence of ancient life, both human and animal. ☐ New species of plants that grew during the Ice Age. ☐ Proof that the Maya invented scuba diving.	☐	☐	☐
5. Why did the Maya place many of their structures so close to cenotes? ☐ They believed these places gave them good luck in the underworld. ☐ The land around cenotes was the most valuable. ☐ Cenotes provided water and were seen as spiritual gateways. ☐ They wanted to protect the cenotes from outsiders.	☐	☐	☐
6. What do the offerings found in sacred cenotes suggest about Maya culture? ☐ All remains found there were human sacrifices. ☐ They valued precious items for religious ceremonies. ☐ They did not understand how metals were made. ☐ They believed there was no life after death.	☐	☐	☐
7. What link does Alison Zicari make between cenotes and the dinosaur-killing asteroid? ☐ The asteroid dried out the cenotes completely. ☐ Water flows around the impact crater made a circular chain of cenotes. ☐ Cenotes were created by lava after the impact. ☐ Dinosaurs lived in the cenotes before they disappeared.	☐	☐	☐
8. Why do animals like manatees sometimes enter cenotes? ☐ They look for protection and need a quiet shelter. ☐ Cenotes contain algae that grow only in underwater caves. ☐ The water in cenotes is warmer than the ocean. ☐ They are disturbed by tourists and go there to get some peace.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

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Part 1: Listening comprehension

ULURU: EXPLORING THE HEART AND SPIRIT OF AUSTRALIA

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

sandstone: pedra arenosa / piedra arenisca
layers: capes / capas
tilted: inclinat / inclinado
hue: tonalitat / tonalidad

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Why is Uluru considered sacred by the Anangu people? ☐ It is made of a rare type of sandstone. ☐ It holds deep connections to their Tjukurpa, or belief system. ☐ It is the deepest natural formation in Australia. ☐ It was used as a meeting point for caretakers.	☐	☐	☐
2. Why do the Anangu discourage ascending Uluru? ☐ It poses significant risks to visitors. ☐ They encourage exploring other cultural experiences instead. ☐ They think it violates the sacred meaning of the site. ☐ There are no established trails to follow.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to Chris Wood, how did Uluru form? ☐ In the same way as the Himalayas. ☐ Through the erosion of a mountain range. ☐ Through the petrification of an ancient sea. ☐ From the gradual accumulation of desert sand.	☐	☐	☐
4. Why is Uluru red? ☐ It contains copper minerals. ☐ The sandstone oxidizes when in contact to the air. ☐ It is actually grey, not red. ☐ The soil around it stains the rock.	☐	☐	☐
5. When is the worst time to visit Uluru? ☐ December to February. ☐ June to August. ☐ March to May. ☐ September to November.	☐	☐	☐
6. What safety precautions are important when visiting Uluru? ☐ Avoiding interactions with local wildlife. ☐ Drinking water and using sun protection. ☐ Hiring a ranger or tour guide. ☐ Avoiding travel in the winter months.	☐	☐	☐
7. What does the Uluru Cultural Center offer visitors? ☐ Accommodation for overnight stays. ☐ Guided tours of the rock base. ☐ Insights into Anangu culture. ☐ Spiritual support.	☐	☐	☐
8. What surprises visitors about Uluru's surroundings? ☐ The absence of vegetation. ☐ The many caves, waterholes, and wildlife. ☐ The availability of tourist shops and restaurants. ☐ The lack of walking paths around the base.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

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Part 1: Listening comprehension

30 BY 30

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

sea urchin: eriçó de mar / erizo de mar
seaweed: algues / algas

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

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	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. What inspired Jordan Scala to develop a plan to protect the planet? ☐ The discovery of new underwater species in the Mediterranean. ☐ The changes in marine life he observed from childhood to adulthood. ☐ The influence of Jacques Cousteau's campaigns against overfishing. ☐ A passion for documenting marine life on film.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to Jordan Scala, what ultimately led to the destruction of Mediterranean marine life? ☐ World War II. ☐ Large scale exploitation of the sea for food. ☐ A large number of scuba diving tourists. ☐ Pollution of the sea by documentary filmmakers.	☐	☐	☐
3. Fishermen in Cabo Pulmo ☐ requested a marine reserve and later benefited from it. ☐ opposed the creation of a marine reserve but later benefited from it. ☐ catch more fish inside the reserve than before. ☐ warn divers about sharks inside the reserve.	☐	☐	☐
4. What does Jordan Scala say about the effect of human activity on wildlife and natural habitats? ☐ Wild animals have adapted well to changes caused by human activity. ☐ Land animals' habitat has been better protected than that of sea animals. ☐ More land is needed to farm pandas, tigers, and elephants. ☐ Human activity has removed 90 % of all fish from the ocean.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following does Jordan Scala NOT mention as an advantage of using trees, grasslands, and oceans to reduce carbon pollution? ☐ Their effectiveness. ☐ Their cost. ☐ Their long-term existence. ☐ Their naturalness.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following statements is FALSE? ☐ All three objectives are given the same priority everywhere. ☐ Protecting 30 % of the ocean is the minimum requirement. ☐ Protecting the most biodiverse areas will harm fishing. ☐ A new system is used to choose which areas to protect.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Jordan Scala, protecting the natural world ☐ is too expensive. ☐ requires government subsidies. ☐ requires international cooperation. ☐ requires the support of polluting industries.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which option best describes the overall tone of the dialogue between the interviewer and Jordan Scala? ☐ Optimistic and hopeful, focussing on solutions and positive outcomes for the planet. ☐ Neutral and scientific, focussing on factual explanations and technical details. ☐ Pessimistic and resigned, focussing on the destruction of nature, which is seen as inevitable. ☐ Alarmist and fearful, emphasizing the urgency of the environmental crisis.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

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Part 1: Listening comprehension

SUBTITLING AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING TOOL

In this radio programme you are going to hear a new word. Read and listen to it. Make sure you know what it means.

daunting: aclaparador, -a / abrumador, -a

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. What was the aim of the "School in Town" project? ☐ To show students how the town provides unexpected learning opportunities. ☐ To help students improve their German while doing activities in town. ☐ To give students a taste of university life. ☐ To encourage students to do cultural activities.	☐	☐	☐
2. Why did Margarita focus on German instead of English? ☐ Germany is geographically closer to Poland than the UK. ☐ Polish students are not as exposed to German as they are to English. ☐ Students are not aware that German translation is closer to Polish than to English. ☐ Schools provide better resources for learning English.	☐	☐	☐
3. How did Margarita initially engage students with the video? ☐ By showing the technical aspects of subtitling immediately. ☐ By providing them with the subtitles in both German and Polish. ☐ By asking them to analyze the protagonists and the overall mood. ☐ By translating the first part of the video for them.	☐	☐	☐
4. What strategy did Margarita use to help students given their low German proficiency? ☐ She provided a list of common German phrases which appeared underlined. ☐ She placed them in teams to work on different scenes. ☐ She asked them very easy questions in German, so they felt immediately confident. ☐ She selected a short video with simple dialogue and underlined the difficult parts.	☐	☐	☐
5. What was the main purpose of underlining certain phrases in the subtitles? ☐ To encourage students to translate individual words. ☐ To emphasize the importance of context in translation. ☐ To make the subtitles easier to read. ☐ To provide examples of Polish idioms.	☐	☐	☐
6. How did the students react when they saw their names in the credits? ☐ They felt satisfied and excited. ☐ They couldn't believe their eyes. ☐ They felt anxious and uneasy. ☐ They boasted about their work.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Margarita, why are audiovisual materials attractive for students? ☐ They help students interact with other people. ☐ They are familiar with this kind of content. ☐ They provide a relaxed learning environment. ☐ They offer more learning opportunities than traditional materials.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does Margarita hope students share with their parents? ☐ That subtitling in German can be as fun as in English but you also need technical skills. ☐ The importance of being able to translate and convey ideas in multiple languages. ☐ That subtitling involves translating concepts and that it is enjoyable. ☐ That learning unfamiliar foreign languages such as German is easier through subtitles.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

MICHAEL SMITH: A MICHELIN-STARRED CHEF FROM THE SCOTTISH HIGHLANDS

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

accolades: reconeixements / reconocimientos
larder: rebost / despensa
to go for a wander: passejar / pasear

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. In which of the following restaurants has Michael Smith NOT worked? ☐ The Three Chimneys. ☐ The Three Witches. ☐ Loch Bay. ☐ Blue Print Café.	☐	☐	☐
2. Where did Michael Smith work in a kitchen for the first time? ☐ In the capital of Scotland. ☐ On the west coast of Scotland. ☐ In a village close to the Scottish Highlands. ☐ In his hometown.	☐	☐	☐
3. Did Michael Smith work in any restaurant kitchens outside Scotland? ☐ No, although he considered moving to London. ☐ No, he always worked in the Highlands and in Glasgow. ☐ Yes, he spent four years in London. ☐ Yes, he spent a few years at a café in France.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ Shirley Spear offered Smith the opportunity to work at The Three Chimneys. ☐ Smith did not want to work on Skye, because he felt it was very remote. ☐ Smith was looking for opportunities to work on Skye and contacted Shirley Spear to get advice. ☐ Smith's wife went to check Skye out, because she was unsure about the new lifestyle for her family.	☐	☐	☐
5. How long did it take Smith to open his own restaurant after his arrival at Skye? ☐ Thirteen years. ☐ Fifteen years. ☐ Eleven years. ☐ Sixteen years.	☐	☐	☐
6. Did he open his new restaurant on Skye? ☐ Yes, because he was happy with his life on the isle. ☐ Yes, but only because his kids asked him to do so. ☐ No, because his wife and children wanted to discover new places. ☐ Yes, because it had always been his dream to open a restaurant on Skye.	☐	☐	☐
7. What does Dolores think about Smith's restaurant? ☐ She thinks it is a pity that they serve simple food, such as chips. ☐ She would prefer it to combine local products with international food. ☐ She thinks the presentation of dishes could be improved. ☐ She thinks it is appreciated by local people.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following best summarises Smith's view of his job? ☐ He prefers to get help in the kitchen to be able to enjoy the atmosphere of the restaurant. ☐ He likes to do the cooking and sees a Michelin star as the result of combining good products and a lively atmosphere. ☐ Sometimes he gets annoyed by the other people working and eating at the restaurant. ☐ He says being a chef is a rewarding profession since the job can be recognised with prizes such as a Michelin star.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 1: Listening comprehension

K-POP, MORE THAN JUST A MUSIC STYLE

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

billboard charts: llistes d'èxits musicals / listas de éxitos musicales
vacuum: buit / vacío
boot camp: camp d'entrenament / campo de entrenamiento
pervades: impregna
a bill was passed: una llei va ser aprovada / una ley fue aprobada
infringement: infracció / infracción

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following statements about K-pop is NOT mentioned in the interview? ☐ It makes a lot of money. ☐ It is usually on top of music charts. ☐ BTS, a famous K-pop band, broke a record on Spotify. ☐ Its fans prefer K-pop concerts to online music.	☐	☐	☐
2. Why does Chris think K-pop is so popular these days? ☐ K-pop leaves behind boy and girl bands. ☐ K-pop substitutes boy and girl bands. ☐ K-pop taps into ethnicity and race. ☐ K-pop is only followed by Asian Americans.	☐	☐	☐
3. When did Chris start being academically interested in K-pop? ☐ When K-pop artists appeared on the Internet. ☐ Just after lockdown, when she was on a leave. ☐ When she was studying race during the Covid lockdown. ☐ After watching some K-pop videos for entertainment.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of these aspects of K-pop is Chris investigating at the moment? ☐ The influence of K-pop artists on their fans and followers. ☐ The link between different types of music genres and K-pop. ☐ Whether K-pop fans may have a say in politics. ☐ All statements are correct.	☐	☐	☐
5. Why does Chris believe that K-pop is so influential all over the world? ☐ The press interviews K-pop artists and publishes their concert dates. ☐ K-pop followers are mainly Asian who are not racist. ☐ K-pop draws attention to Asian people. ☐ K-pop artists were against xenophobia.	☐	☐	☐
6. What has changed a lot in the last five years? ☐ K-pop fans are protecting their artists from the press. ☐ A president of the United States went to a K-pop concert. ☐ Asian artists are popular enough to appear in the news. ☐ People make fun of Asian Americans.	☐	☐	☐
7. If young people would like to become a K-pop idol, they must ☐ go for an audition and then attend training courses on diets and competition. ☐ have their pictures taken in their acting or singing classes and study a lot. ☐ criticize the classmates who are not doing well enough in their classes after tiring timetables. ☐ work extremely hard and under a lot of pressure, which is something accepted in Korean culture.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the law to protect K-pop idols? ☐ Going to school is mandatory. ☐ Training hours are limited according to age. ☐ The number of working hours per day is limited according to age. ☐ The maximum amount they can legally earn.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 1: Listening comprehension

MAKING MUSIC AFTER BRAIN SURGERY

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

garnered: va recollir, va generar / recogió, generó
put that on ice: posposar / posponer
swirling: fent voltes / dando vueltas

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Tokimonsta ☐ is the nickname for Tom Mosley. ☐ helped out at a doctor's surgery. ☐ cannot understand sound. ☐ had a turning point in her career.	☐	☐	☐
2. When did she start making music again? ☐ At the 2019 Grammy awards. ☐ Briefly after she got over her operation. ☐ Just before the Grammy awards. ☐ Immediately after her operation.	☐	☐	☐
3. Where does the name Tokimonsta come from? ☐ It was a chat name she picked when she was 16. ☐ It means 'brain surgery' in Korean. ☐ It was a name her family gave her when she was 16. ☐ It is a Korean name for a tiger monster.	☐	☐	☐
4. Does she regret having this name? ☐ Yes, because she picked it when she was too young. ☐ No, because the music she makes is always very quiet. ☐ No, because it represents the music that she makes. ☐ Yes, because it is an extremely aggressive name.	☐	☐	☐
5. How did Tokimonsta learn to make electronic music? ☐ She learned everything from a software program she downloaded in high school. ☐ She learned it through video tutorials just before getting into college. ☐ She learned how to use the production software through reading the manual. ☐ She learned it through a friend who taught her the basics of a software and video tutorials.	☐	☐	☐
6. How does she create electronic music? ☐ She only uses her piano. ☐ She only uses her computer. ☐ She mainly uses her computer. ☐ She never uses synthesizers.	☐	☐	☐
7. Why does Tokimonsta use field recordings? ☐ Because the sounds give her music a unique character. ☐ Because the sounds resemble the electronic music she makes. ☐ Because they make her music sound fresher and more natural. ☐ Because the sounds in those recordings are easy to recreate.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following best summarizes Tokimonsta's view of music after her recovery? ☐ Her hearing abilities have improved. ☐ She values music to a greater extent. ☐ Everything related to music has changed. ☐ She finds her music productions are more appreciated.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 1: Listening comprehension

THE RISE OF PREGNANT STAND-UP

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

stand-up: monòleg / monólogo
pregnant: embarassada / embarazada
stretch mark: estria / estría
booker: agent / agente
lactation: lactància / lactancia

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. How does Udane feel about being a comedian? ☐ She is disappointed with the profession. ☐ She can tell it has both advantages and disadvantages. ☐ It feels exactly the way she had imagined. ☐ It is very time-consuming, so she cannot hang out as much as she used to.	☐	☐	☐
2. Why does Udane not go to clubs or bars anymore? ☐ Because she is pregnant and does not drink alcohol. ☐ Because she does not have enough time. ☐ Because she thinks there are more meaningful ways to pass the time. ☐ Because she does not have any friends to go with.	☐	☐	☐
3. What is Udane's problem with the lights on stage? ☐ They make her feel too hot. ☐ They are blinding. ☐ They are distracting. ☐ They do not allow her to connect with the audience.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following is NOT true about Udane? ☐ She talks about her pregnancy on stage. ☐ She has a baby on the way. ☐ She watches comedy on Netflix. ☐ She lives in Los Angeles, like Kara Klenk.	☐	☐	☐
5. What happened to Joan Rivers in 1967? ☐ She was asked to keep her pregnancy a secret. ☐ She had to dress up as if she were pregnant. ☐ Some bookers asked her to hide her daughter Melissa among the audience. ☐ She was not allowed to perform on television because she was pregnant.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Udane, female comics ☐ have outnumbered male comedians recently. ☐ typically pursue other careers when they start having babies. ☐ do not tend to get pregnant. ☐ are more frequent today than they used to be.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which of the following best summarizes Amy Schumer's experience? ☐ She had a pregnancy complication on a flight to New York. ☐ She had to cancel some shows because of a medical condition. ☐ She was not allowed to fly when she was pregnant, but she did. ☐ She decided not to travel to prevent a difficult pregnancy.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does Udane think about using pregnancy on stage? ☐ She finds it hilarious and hopes the trend will last forever. ☐ She is unsure about the phenomenon lasting much because audiences complain about it. ☐ She hopes that people will normalize the image of a pregnant woman on stage. ☐ She thinks it is outrageous that people laugh at expectant moms.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 1: Listening comprehension

CHOCOLATE AND VALENTINE'S DAY: A SWEET STORY

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

whip: fuetejar /azotar
elixir: elixir

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Where and when did St. Valentine's Day celebrations originate? ☐ With the Romans before Christ. ☐ With the Spaniards in Mexico during the colonial period. ☐ In 17th century England with King Charles II. ☐ In 19th century England with Queen Victoria.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following best describes who Valentine was? ☐ A Roman Emperor from the third century A.D. ☐ A martyr who was executed in ancient Rome. ☐ A character in Canterbury Tales. ☐ The author of Canterbury Tales.	☐	☐	☐
3. Who first introduced chocolate to Europe? ☐ The Spanish. ☐ The French. ☐ Casanova, the Italian adventurer. ☐ The British.	☐	☐	☐
4. What did Europeans use to think chocolate was good for? ☐ They thought it was a medicine to make people stronger. ☐ They thought it was good as a cream to make skin softer. ☐ They thought it was an aid in sexual activity. ☐ They thought it could be used to better preserve food, like sugar or salt.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following is TRUE? ☐ In the 18th century, a very few rich Europeans drank chocolate. ☐ In the 18th century, chocolate was widely eaten as candy in Europe. ☐ In 17th century Britain, hot chocolate was a very common drink. ☐ Chocolate first became popular in Europe in France.	☐	☐	☐
6. When did chocolate candy bars first appear? ☐ In the middle of the 17th century, under King Charles II in Britain. ☐ In the middle of the 19th century, in Britain. ☐ In the middle of the 19th century, in Spain. ☐ At the beginning of the 20th century, in the U.S.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which of the following occurred first? ☐ J.S. Fry & Sons made individual, cream-filled chocolates. ☐ Cadbury sold chocolates in pretty boxes. ☐ Cadbury created heart-shaped boxes for chocolates. ☐ Americans decorated boxes of chocolates with roses.	☐	☐	☐
8. What differentiated Cadbury's chocolates from those made by others? ☐ They were sold by weight by street vendors. ☐ They were made with cream fillings. ☐ They were sold in heart-shaped boxes that could be kept. ☐ They were made with cacao butter.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 1: Listening comprehension

JUANITA. THE INCA MUMMY

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

mummy: mòmia / momia
attire: indumentària / atuendo
bundle: paquet / paquete
burial site: lloc d'enterrament / lugar del entierro
appease: apaivagar / apaciguar
coca leaves: fulles de coca / hojas de coca
docile: dòcil / dócil
blow: cop / golpe
kneel: agenollar-se / arrodillarse

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following sentences best describes Juanita? ☐ She was a rich, healthy girl who worked for the nobility. ☐ She was a young, mature girl who looked after alpacas. ☐ She was a young teenage girl who had malnutrition. ☐ She was a rich, healthy girl who belonged to the Cuzco elite.	☐	☐	☐
2. What did scientists study and analyse to find out what Juanita ate prior to her sacrifice? ☐ Her hair. ☐ Her bones. ☐ Her attire. ☐ Her tissues.	☐	☐	☐
3. What did the American anthropologist and his partner NOT find inside the parcel together with the mummy? ☐ Pottery. ☐ Shells. ☐ Llama dolls. ☐ Volcano ash.	☐	☐	☐
4. Why did doctors say that Juanita could have died a few weeks ago and not 500 years ago? ☐ The mummy was flawless because of the weather conditions at the top of the mountain. ☐ The expression of Juanita's face was one of peace and the mummy was thin and cold. ☐ Mt Ampato protected the mummy from the cold air of the Andes. ☐ The volcanic eruption of Mt Ampato shook the young girl and it became mummified instantly.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ The snow melted because of a volcanic eruption and pushed the bundle into the crater where it was found. ☐ The mummy was found where the girl was killed, on top of Mt Ampato. ☐ A Spanish soldier, who was also sacrificed, was found dead on the summit of Mt Ampato. ☐ Reinhard came back to the place where Juanita was found. He went there with two children: a boy and a girl.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of these statements is FALSE about Capacocha? ☐ Capacocha was a sacrificial rite that took place near a lake. ☐ Capacocha was carried out to stop natural disasters like earthquakes. ☐ The best and healthiest children were sacrificed in Capacocha. ☐ The Inca worshipped mountains and Capacocha was a way to please the gods.	☐	☐	☐
7. When Juanita died, ☐ she was standing up, surrounded by alpaca, and looking up at the sky. ☐ she was alone, naked, and not allowed to eat or drink except alcohol. ☐ she had eaten potatoes and vegetables as she used to do at home. ☐ she had been prepared with coca and alcohol for 6 or 8 weeks.	☐	☐	☐
8. How did Juanita die? ☐ She was hit by a baseball bat. ☐ Her feet were injured so that she could not move, and she died of cold. ☐ She had a brain haemorrhage caused by a head injury. ☐ She was left alone at the top of the mountain with no food or water and died of starvation.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió oral ☐

Part 1: Listening comprehension

AMERICA'S BEST KNOWN ARCHITECT

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

windbag: persona que pontifica
grace: honorar / honrar
flock: congregar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Why is Frank Lloyd Wright a famous American? ☐ His poetry won international prizes. ☐ His social activism earned him the Nobel Peace Prize. ☐ His designs for buildings are admired by architects everywhere. ☐ He advocated the elimination of banks and the banking system.	☐	☐	☐
2. Frank Lloyd Wright wanted people to look to architects and to consult them more because ☐ he knew he could build cheaper houses. ☐ he wanted to change the type of buildings we live in. ☐ he wanted to make money from consulting. ☐ he wanted to become the most famous architect in the world.	☐	☐	☐
3. What did Frank Lloyd Wright want to reform in the U.S.? ☐ The educational system. ☐ The type of farms and agriculture. ☐ The general way of life. ☐ The role of government.	☐	☐	☐
4. Frank Lloyd Wright liked buildings that ☐ were built in modules so that families could move their own home to another state. ☐ were tall, like those in the New York City skyline. ☐ had lots of windows and which could be seen from a distance. ☐ fit into the natural area where they were built.	☐	☐	☐
5. Why did Frank Lloyd Wright not like New York City? ☐ He thought the city was over-populated. ☐ He thought the type of buildings there represented a money-oriented view of society. ☐ He thought there was not enough space for his buildings nor for people. ☐ He thought New Yorkers didn't like him.	☐	☐	☐
6. Why is Fallingwater so famous? ☐ Because it is made entirely from local wood. ☐ Because it was the first house Wright designed. ☐ Because it is the largest single family home in Pennsylvania. ☐ Because a stream runs inside the building.	☐	☐	☐
7. The text says that in certain circumstances we can "experience a feeling of awe." Which of the following expressions is a synonym for *awe* in the text? ☐ admiration. ☐ deception. ☐ envy. ☐ fear.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to Mr. Wolf, Frank Lloyd Wright ☐ is an over-rated architect. ☐ deserves his fame. ☐ was a pretty boring person. ☐ spent too much time criticising others.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió oral	☐		

Part 1: Listening comprehension

THE SURPRISING HISTORY OF HANDWASHING

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

go delirious: entrar en un estat de deliri / entrar en un estado de delirio
ward: sala d'hospital / sala de hospital
midwife: llevadora / comadrona
puzzling: misteriós / misterioso
aisle: passadís / pasillo

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Where did Ignaz Semmelweis work? ☐ In the Emperor's palace in Vienna. ☐ In a small town in Hungary. ☐ In a large hospital in Vienna. ☐ The recording does not say where he worked.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following statements about Vienna General Hospital is NOT true? ☐ The hospital had too many patients. ☐ It was a very large hospital. ☐ It only served veterans of war. ☐ The sanitary conditions were poor by today's standards.	☐	☐	☐
3. Child bed fever was a disease affecting ☐ babies who had just been born. ☐ women who had just given birth. ☐ older children who had become delirious. ☐ anyone living in a house with small children.	☐	☐	☐
4. Why did the hospital divide the maternity ward into two clinics? ☐ Because doctors were better trained than midwives. ☐ Because rich people did not want to be in a ward with poor people. ☐ Because they needed more doctors. ☐ Because the hospital had too many maternity patients.	☐	☐	☐
5. As he tried to discover why more women were dying in one of the clinics, what did Ignaz do first? ☐ He considered solutions that others had proposed. ☐ He analyzed blood samples in a laboratory. ☐ He compared data from several hospitals. ☐ He treated patients in both clinics.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following statements is TRUE about Ignaz's work? ☐ He discovered the importance of handwashing soon after the clinics were divided. ☐ His discovery of the importance of handwashing was based on luck. ☐ He discovered the importance of handwashing because he had done controlled experiments. ☐ His friend Robert actually discovered the importance of handwashing, but he died too soon to take credit so Ignaz took the credit instead.	☐	☐	☐
7. Ignaz discovered that child bed fever ☐ was spread by the doctors' lack of personal hygiene when working. ☐ was caused by germs. ☐ was caused by contaminated water in one of the clinics. ☐ only affected women after giving birth.	☐	☐	☐
8. Once the doctors started to wash their hands after performing autopsies, ☐ the number of women dying in the clinic served by doctors increased. ☐ the number of women dying in the clinic served by doctors decreased. ☐ the number of women dying in both clinics remained unchanged. ☐ the two clinics were combined again into a single, large maternity ward.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

3, 2, 1… SLAM!: POETRY COMES TO THE STAGE

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

scribble: gargotejar / garabatear
thumb through: fullejar / hojear
be hooked on: estar enganxat / estar enganchado
open mic: micròfon obert / micrófono abierto

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. How does Anne write her poems? ☐ She always uses her laptop because her handwriting is messy. ☐ She prefers to write out her poems by hand. ☐ She first records them on her phone and then writes them down. ☐ She needs to write with dirty hands to find inspiration.	☐	☐	☐
2. How did Anne learn about poetry slam? ☐ She went to a slam competition with a friend in 2018. ☐ She read an ad about a competition. ☐ She heard about it in an open mic session. ☐ She read an interview with a slammer in a magazine.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to Anne, the best thing about slam is ☐ that poets know how to make you laugh and cry. ☐ the fact that it can be streamed online and played on any device. ☐ the strong link between the poet and the live audience. ☐ that poems are performed instead of written and read aloud.	☐	☐	☐
4. Anne's poems ☐ are based on strict mathematical patterns. ☐ search phrasing and rhyme by following patterns. ☐ usually take about five minutes to recite. ☐ intend to be messy and playful, as opposed to mathematical formulae.	☐	☐	☐
5. How long does it take Anne to write a poem? ☐ A minimum of three months. ☐ Usually three minutes. ☐ Sometimes just a couple of weeks. ☐ Much longer than before.	☐	☐	☐
6. How does Anne prepare for a performance? ☐ She recites poems aloud to become familiar with their rhythm. ☐ She reads the poem lots of times to learn all rhymes. ☐ She sings poems out loud in front of the mirror. ☐ She studies poems line by line as if they were jokes.	☐	☐	☐
7. Why is the audience important in a slam competition? ☐ Because they can decide which poems are performed. ☐ Because they can help slammers score higher. ☐ Because the panel asks for the audience's opinion. ☐ Because some members of the audience may be part of the panel.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following statements is NOT true about Anne? ☐ She started writing when she was younger. ☐ She does not like maths anymore. ☐ She is good at memorising text. ☐ She finds inspiration in other slammers.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 1: Listening comprehension

GOALBALL, A UNIQUE SPORT

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

goalball: golbol
low vision: baixa visió / baja visión
eyeshade: antifaç / antifaz

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Goalball was created ☐ as a rehabilitation activity after the First World War. ☐ as a rehabilitation activity after the Second World War. ☐ as a preparatory activity before the First World War. ☐ as a preparatory activity before the Second World War.	☐	☐	☐
2. Goalball players ☐ must all be totally blind. ☐ are all blind from birth. ☐ are both deaf and blind. ☐ may have lost vision at any point in life.	☐	☐	☐
3. The goalball court in the Paralympics ☐ is the same size as a standard tennis court. ☐ differs completely in size from any other sport venues. ☐ is the same size as a standard volleyball court. ☐ does not have a standardised size.	☐	☐	☐
4. In a goalball game ☐ three players from each team play at the same time. ☐ up to six players from each team play at the same time. ☐ there are six officials on court. ☐ six players from each team play at the same time.	☐	☐	☐
5. How do players know where the ball is while playing? ☐ By following tactile signs on the ground. ☐ By asking the other team members. ☐ By following the sound of the ball. ☐ By asking the coaches and audience.	☐	☐	☐
6. Why are players required to wear eyeshades? ☐ Because they may have different degrees of vision loss. ☐ Because they allow players to avoid flashes. ☐ Because only people with low vision can play goalball. ☐ Because they help the players to move on the court.	☐	☐	☐
7. What did Chloe do wrong in her last goalball game? ☐ She missed a penalty. ☐ She defended the goal on her own. ☐ She asked the referee a question. ☐ She touched her eyeshades.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does Chloe especially like about goalball? ☐ The fact that the game is truly fair for all players. ☐ How the game helps her to develop orientation skills. ☐ The crowd's cheering motivating her each time she scores. ☐ The fact that goalball improves her fitness.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

THE MYSTERY OF JIM THOMPSON

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

silk: seda
guild: gremi / gremio
spinner: filador / hilandero
fabrics: roba, tela / ropa, tela
legacy: llegat / legado
teakwood: teca (tipus de fusta / tipo de madera)

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of these facts is NOT true about Jim Thompson? ☐ He worked as an architect in New York. ☐ He arrived in Bangkok in the middle of the World War. ☐ His father was a rich textile businessman. ☐ He had four siblings.	☐	☐	☐
2. The Thais did not use silk because ☐ there were not many silk manufacturers in Thailand. ☐ silk from Europe was better than Thai silk. ☐ Thai silk spinners had all been sent to Europe. ☐ they used other types of cloth that were cheaper.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these statements is TRUE according to the text? ☐ Thais defended Asian art, and specially Asian architecture. ☐ Thompson did not like parties but attended international events. ☐ Thais liked Western things more than traditional Thai things. ☐ Thompson felt more Thai than American after some time in Thailand.	☐	☐	☐
4. How did Thompson disappear? ☐ He was murdered by Asian spies while he was on holiday. ☐ He was on holiday in Malaysia and did not return after leaving for a stroll. ☐ His plane was lost at sea while flying to Malaysia. ☐ He was kidnapped in Malaysia by his driver and guide.	☐	☐	☐
5. What contributed to the mystery of his disappearance? ☐ The Malaysian police did not want to investigate his disappearance. ☐ His sister was murdered not long after he went missing. ☐ The CIA admitted that Thompson was an agent and had been sent somewhere else. ☐ Truman Capote wrote a best-selling crime novel about his life.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of these things does Thompson's firm NOT have? ☐ Restaurants. ☐ Silk industries. ☐ Architecture studios. ☐ Wine bars.	☐	☐	☐
7. What can you visit in Thompson's mansion? ☐ Thompson's collection of Thai art. ☐ The houses that Thompson designed when he was an architect. ☐ Documents from Thompson's career as a spy. ☐ One of the best collections of Western art objects.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is special about Thai buildings? ☐ The buildings are never isolated but always built in groups of six. ☐ They have a special room to display a family's possessions. ☐ The houses are held together without nails. ☐ They are built partially underground.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

KAREN BLIXEN, A LIFE MADE FOR FILM

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

supplies: provisions / provisiones
spells of drought: sequera / sequía
hazardous: arriscat / arriesgado
auction: subhasta / subasta
engaged: compromesa / comprometida
breakdown: atac, crisi / ataque, crisis

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of these facts is TRUE about Karen Blixen according to the interview? ☐ She enjoyed being interviewed and gave many interviews. ☐ She did not talk much about herself and her ordinary life. ☐ Her father was a rich journalist working for *The New York Times*. ☐ She arrived in Kenya in the middle of the World War.	☐	☐	☐
2. Who gave the Blixens money to start their coffee farm? ☐ The English government. ☐ The rulers in Kenya. ☐ A British aristocrat. ☐ Their own families.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these statements is NOT true according to the text? ☐ It rained a lot and the farm was flooded often. ☐ Coffee could not be imported to Great Britain during the war. ☐ Karen Blixen's husband ran into debts. ☐ There were not enough workers for the farm because of the war.	☐	☐	☐
4. How do we know about Karen Blixen's love affair? ☐ Her husband published a book about their life in Africa. ☐ She wrote about the love affair in *Out of Africa*. ☐ She wrote a letter to her brother that he made public. ☐ A Danish journalist wrote about it in a Copenhagen newspaper.	☐	☐	☐
5. What happened to the coffee farm after the Blixens' divorce? ☐ The British government took it over and closed it. ☐ The farm went bankrupt and was sold at auction. ☐ Karen Blixen turned it into a successful business. ☐ Karen Blixen wanted to leave Kenya so she sold the farm.	☐	☐	☐
6. When did Karen Blixen first start writing? ☐ After she met Denys Finch Hatton. ☐ When she moved back to Denmark from Kenya. ☐ When she was 8 years old. ☐ In 1925, while she was in Kenya.	☐	☐	☐
7. Why did Karen Blixen stop writing when she got married? ☐ She wanted to follow the general expectations for women at that time. ☐ She and her husband worked on the coffee farm so she did not have time to write. ☐ She was ill most of the time and could not write. ☐ The first short stories she had published had been very poorly received by critics.	☐	☐	☐
8. What did she do after the publication of *Seven Gothic Tales*? ☐ She underwent several severe operations and could not write anymore. ☐ She visited several countries because she wanted to gather information for her books. ☐ She went on writing and gave lectures when her illness allowed. ☐ She changed her name and moved back to Africa.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

WE'LL BE ON MARS AGAIN!

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

spacecraft, craft: nau espacial, nau / nave espacial, nave
layer: capa
gust of wind: cop de vent / golpe de viento
shield: escut / escudo
quake: terratrèmol / terremoto
seismometer: sismòmetre / sismómetro

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The InSight mission is unique in that it will investigate ☐ the geology of the interior of Mars. ☐ Mars' surface and atmosphere. ☐ whether Mars can support human life. ☐ the early history of Mars' atmosphere.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to Dr. Halliday, this mission will help scientists understand how ☐ the activity of volcanoes developed on Earth millions of years ago. ☐ layers of different types of rocks were formed on Earth. ☐ rocks separate into different layers. ☐ long ago planets like Mars and the Earth were formed.	☐	☐	☐
3. Why does the InSight spacecraft need to stay in one place? ☐ To detect quakes. ☐ To detect wind. ☐ To avoid making noise. ☐ To avoid breaking instruments.	☐	☐	☐
4. The seismometer of the Viking spacecraft ☐ could not detect Mars quakes well. ☐ could not measure wind gusts well. ☐ was better than the one on the InSight lander. ☐ was handled by astronauts.	☐	☐	☐
5. The InSight makes use of a shield ☐ to help put the InSight instruments underground. ☐ to protect the seismometer from wind gusts. ☐ to protect astronauts while they drill holes. ☐ to protect the spacecraft from seismic waves.	☐	☐	☐
6. The choice of the InSight's landing location was partially determined by ☐ the orbit of Mars. ☐ the amount of fuel left in the rocket. ☐ the type of surface of the landing spot. ☐ the speed of the spacecraft when reaching Mars.	☐	☐	☐
7. A gentle touchdown of the spacecraft is achieved by ☐ removing all rockets. ☐ removing the heat shield. ☐ separating the craft into 2 parts to make each part lighter in weight. ☐ using a parachute to slow it down.	☐	☐	☐
8. When will Dr. Halliday and her team start receiving data from Mars? ☐ One year after InSight lands. ☐ Two years after InSight lands. ☐ Almost immediately after InSight lands. ☐ After the instruments have been placed underground.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

IS LIFE IN THE OUTBACK COMPATIBLE WITH CLIMATE CHANGE?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

drought: sequera / sequía
livestock: bestiar / ganado
well: pou / pozo

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following is true about Australia? ☐ The centre of the country has problems with its water supply. ☐ Each year the country must prepare its coastal cities for hurricanes. ☐ The government currently restricts tourism in the outback. ☐ Several rivers flood every spring, after heavy rainstorms.	☐	☐	☐
2. What is the relationship between water supply in Australia and climate change, according to Dr. Thomas? ☐ Climate change is the only cause of the lack of rainfall in the outback. ☐ There is no obvious relationship between drought and climate change. ☐ Climate change is one of the factors causing Australia's current problems. ☐ The issue needs to be studied more before any conclusion can be reached.	☐	☐	☐
3. What are some farmers and ranchers doing because of the situation described in the conversation? ☐ They are promoting the outback for tourism. ☐ They are building silver and gold mines. ☐ They are changing the crops they plant and raising sheep instead of cattle. ☐ They are quitting and leaving.	☐	☐	☐
4. Why will digging wells not meet the population's needs in the outback? ☐ Because there is very little underground water in Australia. ☐ Because digging wells is extremely difficult and expensive. ☐ Because there are so many people that a few wells will not resolve anything. ☐ Because the well water contains some elements that harm people's health.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following is NOT a problem associated with water desalination plants? ☐ They need a lot of electricity to run. ☐ They deposit salt in ocean water. ☐ They require nuclear power plants for energy. ☐ They harm wildlife in the nearby seas.	☐	☐	☐
6. Where is recycled water being used at present in Australia? ☐ In city drinking water. ☐ In city parks. ☐ On ranches, for animals to drink. ☐ In mines.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Dr. Thomas, which of the following is a possible measure to reduce the amount of water used? ☐ Cities can stop building public parks. ☐ New wells can be dug to use underground water. ☐ Firefighters can substitute sand for water. ☐ More dams can be built to better conserve river water.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following best characterizes Dr. Thomas' view of water use in Australia? He thinks that ☐ there should be more investment in the country's future requirements for water. ☐ the government is doing everything it can to reduce water consumption. ☐ farms will disappear but ranches will continue to grow in the outback. ☐ new technology will help to reduce Australia's use of water.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 1: Listening comprehension

COUNTING THE BUGS AND BACTERIA, YOU'RE 'NEVER HOME ALONE'

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

microbe: microbi / microbio
showerhead: ruixador de la dutxa / alcachofa de ducha
moist: humit / húmedo
to breed: criar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Different species ☐ move across houses hundreds of thousands of times. ☐ live in different habitats in our homes. ☐ study every building alive. ☐ include little different habitats.	☐	☐	☐
2. Professor Dunn ☐ began his career studying rainforests. ☐ started off his career studying homes in rainforests. ☐ began his career discovering jungles in Bolivia, Ghana and Australia. ☐ started off his career finding homes in jungles.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these sentences is NOT true? ☐ Traditional home conditions were similar to the conditions outdoors. ☐ Freezers and ovens in modern homes replicate extreme environment conditions. ☐ Some little structures in traditional homes create really extreme habitats for species. ☐ In modern homes, some structures duplicate extreme environments.	☐	☐	☐
4. Some microbes ☐ live in hot water heaters. ☐ are similar to hot water taps and boilers. ☐ grow on people when taking a hot shower. ☐ harm people when taking a hot shower.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to professor Dunn, ☐ taking a shower is more risky than shaking hands. ☐ people should stop shaking hands. ☐ the world is full of dangerous things. ☐ life surrounds us.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of these sentences is TRUE? ☐ Antibacterial soaps and hand sanitizers are not used by a lot of people. ☐ Antibacterial soaps work much better than soap and water. ☐ Soap and water does not save millions of lives. ☐ Soap and water destroy pathogens on our hands.	☐	☐	☐
7. Heat and air conditioning systems ☐ rarely contain microbes. ☐ grow species we know much about. ☐ can breed lots of microbes. ☐ cause an increase in bacterial diseases.	☐	☐	☐
8. Professor Dunn looks forward ☐ to creating homes with species that benefit us. ☐ to having houses with gardens to our benefit. ☐ to pushing out species that benefit us from our gardens. ☐ to filling homes with gardens that benefit us.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

'MOBY-DUCK': WHEN 28,800 BATH TOYS ARE LOST AT SEA

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

to end up: resultar
deck: coberta / cubierta
to stack: apilar
to maneuver: maniobrar, operar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Presenter: This is *Fresh Air*, our weekly program devoted to the environment. What happens when 28,000 rubber ducks and other bath toys are accidentally dumped into the ocean? Where do the ocean currents take them, and what environmental impact do the ducks and other ocean junk have on the seas? That's what our guest, the journalist Donovan Hahn, investigated in his book *Moby-Duck*: *The True Story of 28,800 Bath Toys Lost at Sea and the Beachcombers, Oceanographers, Environmentalists, and Fools, Including the Author, Who Went in Search of Them*.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Where were the lost toy ducks first found? ☐ Alaska. ☐ Canada. ☐ China. ☐ Oregon.	☐	☐	☐
2. How long did it take the first rubber ducks to surface on a beach after their container was lost at sea? ☐ Only three months. ☐ About a year and a half. ☐ Four years. ☐ Almost six years.	☐	☐	☐
3. How many containers with rubber ducks and other toys were lost at sea? ☐ 12. ☐ 407. ☐ Hundreds and hundreds. ☐ Over 28,000.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following best describes the cargo ships discussed in the conversation? ☐ They regularly go through the Panama Canal. ☐ They mainly navigate between North America and South America. ☐ They carry hundreds of containers above and below deck. ☐ They almost always drop some containers in the sea.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ Large ships are better able to navigate in storms than smaller ships. ☐ The ship lost the toys in the Graveyard of the Pacific. ☐ The weather in the North Pacific is so good that few wrecks occur. ☐ Sailing ships in the 19th century did not cross the Pacific.	☐	☐	☐
6. What do we know for certain about the accident that resulted in the loss of rubber ducks at sea? ☐ It occurred at night. ☐ It occurred during the day. ☐ It occurred because of an error by the ship's captain. ☐ It occurred when there were high waves.	☐	☐	☐
7. We can deduce from the conversation that the toys were originally ☐ packed in plastic bags. ☐ packed in cardboard boxes. ☐ not individually packed. ☐ made out of cardboard.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as an important source of plastics in the oceans? ☐ Waste from coastal cities. ☐ Fishing fleets. ☐ Garbage dumps. ☐ Cruise ships.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

DO YOU GET ON WELL WITH YOUR SMARTPHONE?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

overload: sobrecàrrega / sobrecarga
mindfulness: atenció plena / atención plena
dopamine: dopamina
boost: estimular

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Presenter: Hello. My name is Anne Smith, and on today's programme Dr. John Thomson is going to help us find out why smartphones are so addictive and how we can break our dependence on them. Can we learn how to renegotiate our relationship with our smartphone?

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to Dr. Thomson, ☐ we are very dependent on mobile phones. ☐ we are addicted to our emotions. ☐ technology harms our mind. ☐ we should not use our phones while eating.	☐	☐	☐
2. In Dr. Thomson's view, which of the following is NOT true? ☐ We need to learn to use digital devices intentionally. ☐ Mindfulness allows us to observe and reflect on our behaviour. ☐ We should change our text messaging habits to feel better. ☐ We should learn to observe consciously how we feel.	☐	☐	☐
3. In order to understand how to use technology well, we need to ☐ become aware of how devices affect our lives. ☐ have a lot of determination. ☐ learn how to carry on business with it. ☐ stop using smartphones for entertainment.	☐	☐	☐
4. Our addiction to technology is based on ☐ the high levels of dopamine in the food we eat. ☐ a neurobiological brain disorder related to eating habits. ☐ a mental condition that makes us forget what to do. ☐ a psychological system of reward related to survival.	☐	☐	☐
5. E-mails can cause a dopamine hit if they are ☐ answered intermittently. ☐ received at irregular time intervals. ☐ received at regular time intervals. ☐ answered within 30 seconds.	☐	☐	☐
6. To develop mindfulness, Dr. Thomson asks people to ☐ think about their body before thinking about their phone. ☐ take their phone out, hold it and put it away without turning it on. ☐ think about their phone and what happens in their mind and to their body. ☐ think of three questions to ask him.	☐	☐	☐
7. In mindfulness training people are supposed to ☐ stop thinking about their own emotions. ☐ avoid expressing their own feelings. ☐ develop an awareness of their own habits. ☐ pay close attention to the others in the room.	☐	☐	☐
8. When going through mindfulness training, some people ☐ feel anxious when asked to put their phone away. ☐ react violently and throw their phone away. ☐ relax when they put their phone away. ☐ create bad habits in the use of their phone.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió oral ☐

Part 3: Listening comprehension

DOES HIGH SCHOOL START TOO EARLY?

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

public policy: política governamental / política gubernamental
sleep-deprived: privat de son / privado de sueño
deprivation: privació / privación
melatonin: melatonina

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Presenter: Does high school start too early? Some experts say teens are **sleep-deprived** because of early school start times that are designed for adults. I'm Guy Raz, and today I'm talking with Dr. Wendy Troxel, Adjunct Professor of Psychiatry and Psychology at the University of Pittsburgh. Dr. Troxel's research focuses on the relationship between sleep and health, as well as the implications for **public policy**.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Studies have shown that teenagers who sleep more ☐ do better at school. ☐ have earlier start times. ☐ need treatment for insomnia. ☐ are less active at school.	☐	☐	☐
2. Approximately what percentage of American teenagers gets enough sleep? ☐ 10 %. ☐ 20 %. ☐ 50 %. ☐ 70 %.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following contributes directly to teens' sleep deprivation? ☐ Governmental policy. ☐ Hormones. ☐ Social lives. ☐ Snapchat.	☐	☐	☐
4. The text claims that for most teenagers, going to bed by 10:00 p.m. is ☐ a requirement imposed by the school system. ☐ not possible. ☐ a decision that was made years and years ago. ☐ setting them up for failure.	☐	☐	☐
5. Reasoning, problem solving and good judgment can be characterized as ☐ impulsive and risky behaviours. ☐ higher order thinking processes. ☐ a consequence of sleep deprivation. ☐ factors preventing cognitive development.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Dr. Troxel, around the time of puberty ☐ teenagers feel sleepy around 7:00 p.m. ☐ teenagers' bodies start releasing melatonin for two hours. ☐ teenagers' biological clocks undergo a change. ☐ teenagers' biological clocks wake them up at 4:00 a.m.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which of the following sentences is TRUE? ☐ School absences increase by 25 % when schools start later. ☐ Teens miss the bus more often when schools start later. ☐ Fewer students graduate on time when schools start later. ☐ Standardized test scores improve when schools start later.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to Dr. Troxel, the sleep-wake schedule that we experience during adolescence ☐ lasts for the rest of our lives. ☐ is temporary and will change in adulthood. ☐ improves our mental and physical health. ☐ increases our chances for future success.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 3: Listening comprehension

AN INTERVIEW WITH A DANCER

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

channel: conduir / conducir
put so much into something: esforçar-se molt / esforzarse mucho
demanding: exigent / exigente
rehearsal: assaig / ensayo
chill out: descansar, relaxar-se / descansar, relajarse
icon: icona / icono

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Presenter: You have probably seen our guest on ITV's new show *Dance* or maybe you have been to the theater where she is now performing *Aladdin*. After dancing with the ballet company for five years, she is starting to break into principal roles and discover what it means to be at the top of their profession. Otherwise the chances are that you follow her on Instagram… after all, she boasts over 100,000 followers. In today's program, I'm going to interview Claire Petty.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Why did Claire start doing ballet? ☐ A teacher told her she was good at it. ☐ She was a very active child. ☐ Her mother was a ballet producer. ☐ She was forced by the head teacher.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of these sentences is NOT true according to the interview? ☐ Most of Claire's teachers thought that she would not succeed in dancing. ☐ Her family supported her decision and helped her. ☐ She is motivated to do the things others think she cannot do. ☐ She liked people to tell her that she couldn't make a career out of dancing.	☐	☐	☐
3. What motivates Claire to dance? ☐ The fact that it is a very demanding job. ☐ The joy she has when she is in the studio. ☐ The happiness she feels when she is on stage. ☐ The hobbies she is able to keep thanks to ballet.	☐	☐	☐
4. How does Claire feel after rehearsals? ☐ She thinks about the following day's performance. ☐ She thinks of all the positive things in the performance. ☐ She is excited about the things that may go wrong. ☐ She reflects on the beauty of the performance.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of these things does she NOT do to relax? ☐ She watches movies. ☐ She goes out with her friends. ☐ She dances ballet. ☐ She listens to music.	☐	☐	☐
6. What's her opinion on musical stars? ☐ She would only like to work with Justin Bieber and Jennifer Lopez. ☐ She thinks dancing for them is hard work but gratifying. ☐ She can't wait to work with them as she has not worked with any yet. ☐ She has worked with Beyoncé and that was a dream came true.	☐	☐	☐
7. Why does Claire not consider herself famous now? ☐ Because only some people recognize her. ☐ Because most of her fans are five years old. ☐ Because her fan page on Instagram is new. ☐ Because five years ago she was very famous.	☐	☐	☐
8. What would Claire like to do if she were not a dancer? ☐ She would like to go to Australia to film a movie. ☐ She would like to study art and become a painter. ☐ She would like to design houses and especially her own. ☐ She would like to be an actress on a television show.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

EDUCATION IN THE 21ST CENTURY

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

disabilities: discapacitats / discapacidades
skills: habilitats / habilidades

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Interviewer: UNESCO organized the World Education Forum 2015 in the Republic of Korea, where over 1,600 participants from 160 countries adopted the Declaration for Education 2030. This declaration sets out a new vision for education for the next fifteen years. Today with us we have Ms. Ryan, an expert and researcher in education and one of the participants in the Forum.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. What is one of UNESCO's aims in the next 30 years? ☐ To provide everyone with good, lifelong education. ☐ To participate in teachers' and schools' debates on inclusive education. ☐ To promote school attendance in disadvantaged countries. ☐ To provide separate classes for disabled children.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of these things does Ms. Ryan NOT mention as a skill children will need in the 21st century? ☐ Designing new technology. ☐ Working cooperatively in groups. ☐ Investigating topics. ☐ Communicating in writing and orally.	☐	☐	☐
3. Why is education a popular topic these days, according to Ms. Ryan? ☐ Because today we all have different learning styles. ☐ Because there is a new curriculum that we have to follow. ☐ Because the way people learn today is different from before. ☐ Because nowadays we take into account different phenomena.	☐	☐	☐
4. What will classes be like in the 21st century, according to Ms. Ryan? ☐ The teacher will speak a lot so that the instructions are clearly understood. ☐ The teacher will speak a lot and students will become providers of knowledge. ☐ The students will give information to teachers and will teach each other. ☐ The students will get information which they will transform into knowledge.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of these sentences is NOT correct, according to Ms. Ryan? ☐ Children will like going to school if they see a connection to the real world. ☐ Students will work together with students in different schools or places. ☐ Textbooks will not be used at all and laptops will be the only source of information. ☐ Schools will have many different types of classrooms: labs, studios, etc.	☐	☐	☐
6. How do most students actually use the latest technological tools they have, according to Ms. Ryan? ☐ They design web pages online to show their families. ☐ They write magnificent handouts and worksheets. ☐ They produce blogs and digital stories, which they share. ☐ They talk to friends and family using chats or texts.	☐	☐	☐
7. What is Ms. Ryan's opinion of the use of mobile phones in class? ☐ She is in favour of using them as they are a useful resource. ☐ Mobile phones should only be used to look up new words. ☐ She is against using them in class as she herself can provide the information. ☐ She was in favour but now she prefers not to use them because of the students' reactions.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which is one of the main advantages of using new technologies in the classroom, according to Ms. Ryan? ☐ To be able to share experiences and ideas like in the real world. ☐ To have a nice conversation with people abroad via email or chats. ☐ To create PowerPoint presentations to collaborate with other students. ☐ To increase the use of e-books in class.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 3: Listening comprehension

U.S. NATIONAL PARKS: YELLOWSTONE

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

geyser: guèiser / géiser
bison: bisó americà / bisonte americano
elk: cérvol canadenc / ciervo canadiense
browse: pasturar / pacer
beaver: castor
dam: dic / dique
endangered species: espècie en perill d'extinció / especie en peligro de extinción
to thrive: prosperar
carcasses: carronya / carroña

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Presenter (Christopher Brown): Hello and welcome to *The real world*, our weekly programme about nature. My name is Christopher Brown, and today we travel to the western United States, to Yellowstone National Park. With me today is Dr. Catherine Smith, a professor at Montana State University and an expert on the history and development of Yellowstone.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. When was Yellowstone National Park created? ☐ Right before the Civil War. ☐ Soon after the Civil War. ☐ At the beginning of the 19th century. ☐ At the turn of the 20th century.	☐	☐	☐
2. By 1930, the number of wolves in Yellowstone was ☐ high (> 150). ☐ low (< 20). ☐ zero. ☐ unknown.	☐	☐	☐
3. In the 1950s, the number of elk in Yellowstone ☐ increased. ☐ decreased. ☐ remained stable. ☐ was unknown.	☐	☐	☐
4. In the winter, the elk in Yellowstone feed on ☐ beavers. ☐ birds. ☐ branches. ☐ nothing because they hibernate.	☐	☐	☐
5. One result of the presence of wolves in Yellowstone is ☐ fewer eagles in the park. ☐ fewer trees in the park. ☐ more elk in the park. ☐ more plants in the park.	☐	☐	☐
6. The wolves that were taken to Yellowstone in the 1990s were brought from ☐ Alaska. ☐ Canada. ☐ Montana. ☐ Wyoming.	☐	☐	☐
7. Why has the wolf population in Yellowstone gone down from 174 to about 100 in the past ten years? ☐ Because there was not enough food for the wolves in the park. ☐ Because the winters were especially hard and as a result, many wolves died. ☐ Because some wolves were killed by hunters. ☐ Because some wolves were poisoned by ranchers.	☐	☐	☐
8. Catherine Smith believes that the Yellowstone Wolf Project ☐ is a successful wildlife restoration project. ☐ is a terrible idea of the U.S. government. ☐ proves that wolves are a danger for cattle ranches. ☐ has had few effects on the park.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 3: Listening comprehension

ARE INSECTS THE FUTURE OF FOOD?

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

locust: llagosta / langosta
cricket: grill / grillo
mealworm: cuc de la farina / gusano de la harina
livestock: bestiar / ganado
gross: fastigós / asqueroso

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Presenter: Are insects the future of food? By the year 2050, the planet will be packed with 9 billion people. In low- and middle-income countries, the demand for animal products is rising sharply as economies and incomes grow; in the next few decades, we'll need to find new ways to produce enough protein for billions more mouths. I'm Jennifer Raz and today my guest is Professor Marcel Dickie, who investigates the ecology of insect-plant interactions, and researches the viability of insects as food.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Marcel Dickie and his wife ☐ usually have a rice dish with vegetables for dinner. ☐ eat insects for dinner because they taste like chicken. ☐ have insects for dinner about once a week. ☐ have three species of insects for dinner every week.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of these sentences is TRUE? ☐ The species of insects for sale in the Netherlands are freeze-dried. ☐ The species of insects for sale in the Netherlands are from farms. ☐ You can buy lots of species of insects in the Netherlands. ☐ You can buy edible insects alive in the Netherlands.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these dishes does NOT appear in Marcel Dickie's cookbook? ☐ Pancakes with mealworms. ☐ A quiche with mealworms. ☐ Chocolate topped with locusts. ☐ Chicken with bugs.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to Professor Marcel Dickie, ☐ eating insects might be a little unusual. ☐ about 30 per cent of the population eat insects on a regular basis. ☐ about 2 billion people want to eat insects regularly. ☐ about 30 per cent of the people don't know they are eating insects.	☐	☐	☐
5. Insects are the future of food because ☐ only 70 % of all agricultural land is used to produce livestock. ☐ they need much less agricultural land than livestock. ☐ the land used to produce livestock will be limited to 70 %. ☐ they are very expensive to produce on a large scale.	☐	☐	☐
6. Insects are a good alternative to regular meat because ☐ they have better quality protein. ☐ they are lower in calories. ☐ they take little time to cook. ☐ they can be eaten frozen.	☐	☐	☐
7. From a biological point of view, ☐ locusts, crickets and shrimps are closely related. ☐ a locust and a cricket are the same as a shrimp with wings and legs. ☐ locusts and crickets are nicer than shrimps. ☐ when you look at a shrimp you look at an insect.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to Marcel Dickie, if we could get over the cultural aversion in the West to eating insects, ☐ the world population would eat less meat. ☐ dinner tables would be more enjoyable. ☐ the world population would eat less animal proteins. ☐ new meats would be replaced on dinner tables.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 3: Listening comprehension

DOES HANDWRITING HAVE A FUTURE?

In this radio programme you're going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure that you know what they mean.

skill: habilitat / habilidad
evolving: en evolució / en evolución
die out: desaparèixer / desaparecer
carving: esculpir
tool: eina / herramienta
lecture: conferència / conferencia

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Interviewer: Does handwriting have a future? Finland and many American states have removed handwriting from the curriculum. But many psychologists believe writing still has an important role to play in cognitive development. So what's the truth? My name is Antony Brown and I interviewed Professor Anne Downey, author of the forthcoming book *The Uncertain Future of Handwriting*.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The younger generations ☐ use handwriting in class only. ☐ used to type or text but they don't anymore. ☐ don't text or type at all anymore. ☐ don't use handwriting anymore.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following sentences is NOT correct? ☐ Handwriting stimulates cognitive processing. ☐ Handwriting helps us develop information. ☐ Handwriting is personal. ☐ Handwriting helps us to learn.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the expert, ☐ there is no link between handwriting and teaching. ☐ there is no need to teach handwriting. ☐ if we don't teach handwriting, it will disappear. ☐ handwriting and teaching will die out.	☐	☐	☐
4. There is no evidence that tablets and computers are having an effect on ☐ handwriting. ☐ reading. ☐ typing. ☐ texting.	☐	☐	☐
5. Humans ☐ haven't changed writing for 6,000 years. ☐ haven't changed writing for 16,000 years. ☐ have been writing for 16,000 years. ☐ have been writing for 6,000 years.	☐	☐	☐
6. Romans ☐ carved on a used stone. ☐ used to look back when carving on stone. ☐ used to carve on stone. ☐ didn't carve on stone.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the expert, which one of the following practices cannot be considered as "voice writing"? ☐ Dictating an email on a mobile device. ☐ Dictating a note to a person on a mobile device. ☐ Dictating a note to yourself on a mobile device. ☐ Dictating a text message on a mobile device.	☐	☐	☐
8. When taking notes in a lecture, the research seems to suggest that it's better to ☐ type because you just transcribe and don't think about the meaning. ☐ write with your voice because it might be the best cognitive tool. ☐ type because you don't go so slowly and think about the meaning. ☐ write by hand because you think more about the contents.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

SALVADOR DALÍ'S COOKBOOK

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

gold-leaf: full d'or / hoja de oro
velvet: vellut / terciopelo
peacock: paó / pavo real
to clog: obstruir
lean: magre, sense greix / magra, sin grasa
canvas: llenç / lienzo

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

If you're of a certain age or if you love surrealist art, then you probably remember Salvador Dalí. He was widely known for his celebrity persona, his pointy mustache and his paintings filled with melting clocks and exotic deserts. But did you know that Dalí also enjoyed exotic desserts? Turns out that the artist published a cookbook in the early 1970s. It was called *Les dîners de Gala* or *The Dinners of Gala*, named for his wife. In the following interview, journalist Hank Ghazi talks to publisher Alexi Horowitz, who is preparing a facsimile of the original.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. When did Alexi find out about the book? ☐ While looking for exotic French recipes. ☐ While talking to a publisher. ☐ While she was in a 30 year-old bookstore. ☐ While looking at old books in Germany.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ The book turns the joy of eating into a form of punishment. ☐ In one of their dinner parties, they served a unicorn's head. ☐ Dalí often showed food in his paintings. ☐ Gala used to preside over the table in red velvet slippers.	☐	☐	☐
3. When he was eight years old, Dalí ☐ wanted to be Napoleon. ☐ wanted to be a cook. ☐ knew he would become a painter. ☐ didn't have any passions.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following are NOT part of the book? ☐ Drawings of exotic animals. ☐ Photographs of the painter with peacocks. ☐ Sketches of restaurants in Paris. ☐ Pyramids of lobsters and decadent dishes.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following best describes the recipes in the book? ☐ Meat is a very important ingredient in most of them. ☐ They are indicated for people who are calorie-conscious. ☐ They mix goose meat with chicken breast and salad. ☐ Avocados are served with cream sauces.	☐	☐	☐
6. In what ways do the recipes resemble Dalí's paintings? ☐ Some of his small paintings could be eaten. ☐ Interpretations of both have changed a lot in the last 40 years. ☐ They both can be adapted to more modern tastes. ☐ They both share a desire to create a visual impact.	☐	☐	☐
7. How many versions of the book will be published? ☐ One, exactly as it was published in the early 70s. ☐ Two, one with gold leaf and one without it. ☐ One, with all the recipes but cheaper than the original. ☐ Two, one with all the recipes and one with just a selection.	☐	☐	☐
8. How did Dalí view the dinner table? ☐ As a collection of hard-to-find ingredients. ☐ It was an exception to his endless creativity. ☐ As a canvas, just like the rest of the world. ☐ He thought it was a tribute to his book.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

INTERVIEW WITH A SCRIPTWRITER

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

run into: trobar-se amb / encontrarse con
weird: estrany / extraño
demand: exigir
work out: fer exercici / hacer ejercicio
shot (shoot) a film: rodar una pel·lícula / rodar una película
overcome writer's block: superar el bloqueig de l'escriptor / superar el bloqueo del escritor

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Narrator: Cliff Dorfman is a film scriptwriter who has worked in the TV series *Entourage* and the film *Warrior*. He is also an actor and a film director. He started working in the early 1990s, and has not stopped since. Right now, he also teaches writing at UCLA (University of California in Los Angeles). In this interview, he talks to a reporter of *Filmmaker* magazine.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The first story that Cliff Dorfman ever wrote ☐ was a whole novel. ☐ was handwritten. ☐ is still in a drawer. ☐ had less than fifty pages.	☐	☐	☐
2. What was Cliff Dorfman NOT inspired by? ☐ Greek mythology. ☐ Modern novels. ☐ Shakespeare. ☐ American movies.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to Cliff Dorfman, if you want your script to be read you must ☐ follow writers and directors everywhere. ☐ contact writers and directors. ☐ visit writers and directors. ☐ be active in Facebook and Twitter.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ Cliff Dorfman finds it extremely hard to write about characters. ☐ Cliff Dorfman never listens to other people talking outside his home. ☐ Everything in Cliff Dorfman's life influences his characters. ☐ Cliff Dorfman never goes out with friends during the writing process.	☐	☐	☐
5. Cliff Dorfman's characters ☐ all have strange eating habits. ☐ are constantly moving. ☐ are part of his life. ☐ appear in his dreams.	☐	☐	☐
6. What does Cliff Dorfman say about the films he likes? ☐ His favourite is *Pulp Fiction*. ☐ They all follow a chronological order. ☐ They all have the same structure. ☐ His favourite is *Goodfellas*.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which of the following is NOT part of Cliff Dorfman's routine? ☐ Yoga. ☐ Boxing. ☐ Going to the gym. ☐ Jogging.	☐	☐	☐
8. How did Cliff Dorfman overcome writer's block? ☐ He stopped using a notebook. ☐ He tried many things, but nothing worked. ☐ He spent a few days alone in the forest. ☐ He went camping with his friends.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

FOOD IN SPACE

In the following conversation you're going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

crave: desitjar / desear
sour: agre / agrio
Charlie Brown: personatge de còmic / personaje de cómic
stuffy: tapat / tapado
cramped: estret / apretado

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Interviewer: If you're planning to take a long space voyage, here's some advice: bring Tabasco or the hot sauce of your choice. That's because there's evidence that astronauts like to eat spicy food in space. And since NASA likes to keep its astronauts happy, the space agency is asking food scientists to help them create a better menu for future missions. My name is Joe Sexton and I talked to Professor Jean Hunter from Cornell University about the reasons behind this request.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. What kind of foods do astronauts crave while they are in space? ☐ Hot peppers that smell sweet. ☐ Those that have sweet and sour tastes. ☐ The ones they never liked on earth. ☐ Only sour things, not sweet.	☐	☐	☐
2. Astronauts don't like foods that rely on smell because ☐ they don't taste very good. ☐ food loses its aroma in space. ☐ their taste isn't pleasurable. ☐ our sense of taste depends on smell.	☐	☐	☐
3. Would astronauts enjoy drinking coffee while they're in space? ☐ Yes, because it is pleasurable for its smell. ☐ No, because coffee has no taste. ☐ No, you can't smell it in a weightless environment. ☐ Maybe, no one has any interesting ideas about that.	☐	☐	☐
4. In the absence of gravity ☐ aromas can go to your elbow instead of your nose. ☐ liquids tend to be pulled towards your feet. ☐ your head fills with aromas and it becomes round. ☐ astronauts' feet look like those of cartoon characters.	☐	☐	☐
5. How are scientists at Cornell University testing the stuffy nose theory? ☐ By making people feel that they have a cold or they're congested. ☐ By asking Charlie Brown to spend several weeks in a bed. ☐ By having people sleep with their heads lower than their feet. ☐ By using volunteers who sleep with their feet lower than their heads.	☐	☐	☐
6. Strange aromas were not a problem for Professor Hunter during a Mars habitat simulation in the Arctic because ☐ there was very little water. ☐ space was cramped. ☐ she had lost some ability to smell. ☐ most liquids have no smell.	☐	☐	☐
7. Dry vegetable protein is a common food in space ☐ and it is often mixed with fresh fruits and vegetables. ☐ even though it does not allow for many creative dishes. ☐ which is made from a wide variety of ingredients. ☐ because it does not go bad easily.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to Professor Hunter ☐ mozzarella made from powdered milk is better than fresh cheese. ☐ it's possible to make acceptable mozzarella from powdered milk. ☐ you can make pizza from a piece of toast. ☐ it is unhealthy to eat pizza with poor mozzarella.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

BUILDING FOR A BETTER WORLD

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

environment: medi ambient / medio ambiente
sustainable: sostenible
soil: sòl / suelo
damage: espatllar / estropear
pavements: voreres / aceras
renewable: renovable

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Interviewer: Last year a new building project located outside Amsterdam started. It's called the 20/20 Park Project. The idea is to have buildings that have a positive, beneficial impact on the **environment**. We asked the architect, Mr Zicari, to discuss the 20/20 Park Project with us.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Where did the idea of building for a better world come from? ☐ It is an evolution from his interest in green architecture. ☐ It originated in Ireland where the first solar house was built. ☐ It came from a group of students at Yale University. ☐ It came from a NASA theory when designing a solar house.	☐	☐	☐
2. What is the difference between green architecture and Mr Zicari's idea of architecture? ☐ Green architecture cares for the environment and his architecture tries to improve it. ☐ His architecture is more popular than green architecture. ☐ His architecture takes care of the materials we build with and green architecture does not. ☐ Green architecture is continuously improving and his architecture never changes.	☐	☐	☐
3. What is the most important part of a project for Mr Zicari? ☐ The location of the buildings. ☐ The time needed for construction. ☐ The person's well being. ☐ The things that are thrown away.	☐	☐	☐
4. What did Mr Zicari worry about when he started the project? ☐ He was concerned about people who put the environment in danger on purpose. ☐ He was only worried about the soil and the water. ☐ He wanted to give something back to the environment. ☐ He wanted to sell all the houses in the development.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of these sentences is NOT correct? ☐ People living in the buildings find them comfortable. ☐ All the buildings in the project are complete. ☐ Mr Zicari thinks the project is a big success. ☐ The financial crisis does not seem to have affected the whole project.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of these things about green architecture is NOT mentioned in the text? ☐ Green roofs. ☐ Permeable pavements. ☐ Green infrastructures. ☐ Green façades.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which are the most important things in the 20/20 Park Project? ☐ Quality and beauty. ☐ Beauty and energy. ☐ Biodiversity and clean energy. ☐ Business and quality.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is Mr Zicari's ultimate goal? ☐ To earn a lot of money. ☐ To build for rich people. ☐ To try to change the world a little bit. ☐ To make people rich.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 3: Listening comprehension

AN INTERVIEW WITH A CHAMPION

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

catch up with (to catch up with): retrobar-se amb, tornar-se a trobar amb / reencontrarse con, volverse a encontrar con
practice: entrenament / entreno
odd: estrany / extraño
social networks: xarxes socials / redes sociales
insight: percepció / percepción
leisure: lleure, temps lliure / ocio, tiempo libre

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Reporter: Each year at this time since 2009, tennis player Chris Jules has been coming to New York City and leaving with the US Open trophy. Jules, who is 33 and among the top tennis practitioners, has no immediate plans to retire. Last August he won the Western Open title and was in the semifinals in Wimbledon in July. In November he was in the London Masters final. In today's program, he's interviewed by our sports reporter.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
0. Chris Jules ☒ is one of the best tennis players in the world. ☐ did not play in London last year. ☐ started playing tennis in 2009. ☐ is going to retire at 33 years old.			
1. According to the interview, Chris Jules ☐ thinks he is old and not in his best shape this year. ☐ feels he's much better this year than the previous one. ☐ thinks time flies when he is in New York City. ☐ says he has not been in New York City since 2009.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of these things is the hardest for Jules when he leaves home? ☐ Being away from his home country. ☐ Leaving his children. ☐ Leaving his wife. ☐ Packing to go abroad.	☐	☐	☐
3. When did Jules start loving tennis practice? ☐ When he was between 16 and 21 years old. ☐ When he became a professional tennis player. ☐ When he decided not to play for more than 45 minutes. ☐ When a professional coach told him how to do it.	☐	☐	☐
4. Today, Jules's favorite time playing tennis is when ☐ there are a lot of people observing what he does. ☐ people are happy watching him win a game. ☐ he is alone and no one is observing what he does. ☐ people take photos of him practising.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to the interview, which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ Jules likes being alone in his hotel room, so he closes his door. ☐ Jules's wife has always travelled with him to all games. ☐ Jules's wife did not travel with him the last time he went to Barcelona. ☐ Jules's children are always alone at home so they open their house to friends.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Jules, tennis has changed in the last ten years ☐ because players are more aggressive now. ☐ but not as much as it did in the past. ☐ because players never move to the front. ☐ thanks to racket technology.	☐	☐	☐
7. What does Jules say about Facebook and Twitter? ☐ He likes to use the social media to express his own ideas. ☐ He first went into Twitter and then Facebook because it was easier. ☐ People don't like what Jules says on Facebook but he does not care. ☐ He found Facebook easy, so he quickly learnt how to use it.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does Jules like to do in his leisure time? ☐ To catch up with family and living a busy life. ☐ To listen to the waves and keeping quiet. ☐ To meet up with friends and going to the beach. ☐ To play other sports such as soccer.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

TELEPATHY

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

sensory: sensorial
phenomena: fenòmens / fenómenos
figure out (to figure out): esbrinar / averiguar
bend, bending (to bend): doblegar / doblar
guessing (to guess): endevinar / adivinar
invest (to invest): invertir
reliable: fiable

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Presenter: In today's programme *Debate* we will have two experts discussing the existence of telepathy as a paranormal activity. *Telepathy* is defined as the transmission of thoughts or feelings from one person to another without using any known sensory channel or physical interaction. Dr John Thompson is professor of Physics at university. He claims that telepathy cannot be explained by modern physics, simply because it does not exist. Dr Susan Barry runs a foundation in the United States which was established to look at the credibility of paranormal phenomena.

[Now listen to the conversation.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. Professor Thompson
- ☐ writes books on telepathy.
- ☒ teaches at univeristy.
- ☐ is a TV showman.
- ☐ is a telepathy expert.

1. Professor Thompson thinks that telepathy
- ☐ is worth investigating.
- ☐ must not be investigated.
- ☐ has not been demonstrated.
- ☐ is scientific evidence.

2. Dr Susan Barry believes that Professor Thompson
- ☐ can explain everything.
- ☐ is very open-minded.
- ☐ does not take science seriously.
- ☐ is a traditional scientist.

3. According to Professor Thompson,
- ☐ the mind is more powerful than science.
- ☐ only physics can explain the world.
- ☐ telepathy is the result of human evolution.
- ☐ telepathy is a natural phenomenon.

4. Dr Susan Barry thinks that science
- ☐ cannot explain coincidences.
- ☐ and telepathy are the same thing.
- ☐ is part of human nature.
- ☐ does not explain telepathy.

5. The book *Thoughts through Space*
- ☐ demonstrated the evidence for telepathy.
- ☐ is a collection of visualized mental images.
- ☐ is a well-known book about telepathy.
- ☐ explains how one can send mental images.

6. According to Dr Susan Barry, the bending of metal spoons can be explained by
- ☐ the power of the showman's eyes.
- ☐ a scientific experiment.
- ☐ the laws of physics.
- ☐ the power of the mind.

7. According to Professor Thompson,
- ☐ physics cannot explain what you can't see.
- ☐ telepathy can't be explained unless physics is revised.
- ☐ the bending of spoons is just a trick.
- ☐ nobody can explain why spoons bend.

8. Dr Susan Barry and Professor Thompson agree that
- ☐ a telepathy experiment is not easy to carry out.
- ☐ you need a robot to carry out an experiment on telepathy.
- ☐ scientific experiments should be watched by a conscious observer.
- ☐ making an experiment on telepathy experiment is useless.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	☐	☐	☐
2.	☐	☐	☐
3.	☐	☐	☐
4.	☐	☐	☐
5.	☐	☐	☐
6.	☐	☐	☐
7.	☐	☐	☐
8.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

HEARING DOGS

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

charity: organització benèfica / organización benéfica
deafness: sordesa / sordera
alleviate (to alleviate): alleugerir / aliviar
puppies: cadells / cachorros
allocated: assignat / asignado
hearing aid: audiòfon / audífono
struggle (to struggle): lluitar / luchar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Interviewer: Nearly 10 million people in the UK experience some degree of hearing loss. That's one person in every six. Over half a million are severely or profoundly deaf. Can dogs help them? In today's interview Julie Bradford, a dog trainer working for a charity, Hearing Dogs for Deaf People, will tell us how.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. How many people are severely deaf in the UK?
- ☐ About ten million.
- ☒ About half a million.
- ☐ About fifty thousand.
- ☐ About five million.

1. Which of the following statements is FALSE about Julie's organization?
- ☐ They train dogs for deaf people.
- ☐ They help deaf people.
- ☐ It is a large organization.
- ☐ It started about 30 years ago.

2. What are hearing dogs trained to do?
- ☐ To listen to their deaf owners.
- ☐ To respond to various sounds.
- ☐ To behave politely in social environments.
- ☐ To make their deaf owners comfortable.

3. When are hearing dogs socialized?
- ☐ As soon as they are one year of age.
- ☐ Immediately after their training finishes.
- ☐ Before they are three weeks of age.
- ☐ Not much after they have been born.

4. One of the problems of hearing loss is that
- ☐ in social situations hearing aids are necessary.
- ☐ it is hard to make this disability invisible.
- ☐ it is a disability often unnoticed by others.
- ☐ it makes deaf people behave in a rude way.

5. Why is the dark red jacket hearing dogs wear useful?
- ☐ It shows that the owner properly looks after the dog.
- ☐ It helps people notice that the dog owner is deaf.
- ☐ It shows that the dog has been trained to be in shops.
- ☐ It helps the hearing dogs behave in social situations.

6. How many dogs has Julie's organization trained?
- ☐ About 800.
- ☐ About 1,800.
- ☐ As many as possible.
- ☐ As many as needed.

7. What does Julie really like about her job?
- ☐ How much help she gets from volunteers.
- ☐ She can almost always make dogs happy.
- ☐ How much it changes deaf people's lives.
- ☐ The number of deaf people she gets to know.

8. Julie thinks that when training a hearing dog it is important to
- ☐ get them used to the sounds in trains.
- ☐ keep them busy with varied sounds work.
- ☐ adapt the training style to the dog.
- ☐ consider who the owner will be.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

DO SCHOOLS DESTROY CREATIVITY?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

smart: intel·ligent / inteligente
skills: destreses, capacitats / habilidades, capacidades
fidgeting (to fidget): no parar quiet / no estarse quieto
challenges: reptes / retos
dropout rate: taxa d'abandonament / tasa de abandono
turn on (to turn on): estimular, motivar
turn off (to turn off): desmotivar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

David Peterson: Do schools kill creativity? That's one of the ideas we'll explore in a special conversation with Professor Mila Saunders, an internationally recognized expert on creativity and education innovation. Professor Saunders has worked with governments and cultural organizations to make creativity a more integral part of education.

[Now listen to the conversation.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. Dr Mila Saunders has worked for
- ☐ governments and educational departments.
- ☐ multinational enterprises.
- ☐ TV creative programmes.
- ☒ governments and cultural organizations.

1. What memories do both the interviewer and Dr Saunders have about school when they were young?
- ☐ Both of them liked everything they did at school.
- ☐ Neither of them can recall much of their school memories anymore.
- ☐ They both disliked everything they did at school.
- ☐ Both of them feel some of the things they did were good but not all.

2. As a young teacher, Dr Saunders noticed that
- ☐ some students had little interest in learning.
- ☐ most students were never given due attention.
- ☐ some clever students thought they were not good.
- ☐ only clever students were taught properly.

3. How did Professor Saunders' interest in education arise?
- ☐ She had always planned to become a teacher.
- ☐ It was through her interest in the school theatre.
- ☐ She loved acting, and teaching was very similar.
- ☐ When she was not accepted as a theatre director.

4. Why did Dr Saunders leave her post as Arts and Education professor?
- ☐ Because she was fed up with education and university.
- ☐ Because she was no longer interested in teaching her pupils.
- ☐ Because she lost her job and looked for another place.
- ☐ Because she wanted a change in her career.

5. What did Gillian Lynn do when she was left alone in the doctor's office?
- ☐ She started fidgeting and moving around.
- ☐ She remained still, looking out of the window.
- ☐ She sat at the doctor's table doing nothing.
- ☐ She started moving to the sound of music.

6. According to the conversation, what is Dr Saunders most worried about?
- ☐ The challenging jobs teachers and principals have.
- ☐ Teachers and principals who criticize the school system.
- ☐ The students who do not want to be educated.
- ☐ The number of kids who leave school between 9th and 12th grade.

7. Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE about Dr Saunders' views on education?
- ☐ Students should be given more standardized tests.
- ☐ The problem is not in the children, but the system.
- ☐ School should be more motivating for students and teachers alike.
- ☐ The educational system is badly organized.

8. According to Dr Saunders, who can encourage the students' creative capacity?
- ☐ Good teachers who motivate the students' talents.
- ☐ Only the most talented and motivated teachers.
- ☐ Those who can plan the school of the future.
- ☐ Teachers who can invest more time educating them.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

ARE WE ALONE IN THE UNIVERSE?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

outer: exterior
findings: descobertes / descubrimientos
proof: prova / prueba
claim (to claim): afirmar
unavoidable: inevitable
coverage: cobertura informativa

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Some scientific discoveries can be fascinating, but sometimes it is hard to believe that they are true. That's the case with an article in the March issue of the *Journal of Cosmology*. In it, Richard Hoover, a scientist at NASA's Marshall Space Flight Center, says he found signs of bacterial life in a group of meteorites, and that raises the exciting possibility that life had once arrived on Earth from outer space. In the following conversation, journalist Johanna Palmer talks with George Cody, a NASA expert on meteorites. They discuss Professor Hoover's discoveries concerning the existence of life on Mars.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. Professor Hoover has discovered that
- ☐ there's no life in meteorites.
- ☒ there might be life on Mars.
- ☐ meteorites bring life to Earth.
- ☐ science raises fascinating possibilities.

1. Johanna Palmer has invited George Cody
- ☐ to talk about his scientific discoveries.
- ☐ to discuss his work at NASA.
- ☐ to talk about Prof. Hoover's discovery.
- ☐ because she wants to specialize on meteorites.

2. What does George Cody think about the possibility of life in outer space?
- ☐ He would like this to be true.
- ☐ He firmly believes in this possibility.
- ☐ If it were true, it would be like living on Earth.
- ☐ He thinks there is no evidence of it yet.

3. What is Prof. Hoover's main claim about meteorites?
- ☐ The bacteria found in meteorites prove that there is life on Mars.
- ☐ Microscopic fragments from meteorites are like those on Earth.
- ☐ Microscopic filaments in meteorites could not create new bacteria.
- ☐ The filaments found in meteorites were brought alive from Mars.

4. What is George Cody's opinion about Prof. Hoover's findings?
- ☐ He believes scientists should not manipulate contaminated meteorites.
- ☐ He thinks that Prof. Hoover's discovery is not scientific.
- ☐ He believes the meteorites may have been contaminated on Earth.
- ☐ He doesn't like experiments made on meteorites.

5. According to George Cody, scientists publish some discoveries before they have proved them because
- ☐ they want other people to know about their findings.
- ☐ they want to show their superiority.
- ☐ they are obsessive people.
- ☐ they like to play with extraordinary things.

6. When a group of scientists claimed they'd found signs of life in a meteorite from Mars in the Antarctica,
- ☐ most of the media talked about the discovery widely.
- ☐ scientists didn't want to hear anything about this theory.
- ☐ the newspapers ignored that important discovery.
- ☐ only a few scientists thought it was a false discovery.

7. According to the interview, what happens when a discovery turns out to be wrong?
- ☐ It hardly ever happens that scientific discoveries go wrong.
- ☐ It is very bad for scientists as their reputation will be damaged.
- ☐ Scientists have to wait for many years before they find a new theory.
- ☐ Scientists have to accept it and learn from what goes wrong.

8. What will happen if Prof. Hoover's theory is not proved? Choose the FALSE answer.
- ☐ George Cody will provide correct structures.
- ☐ Scientists will continue and learn from the error.
- ☐ Scientists will give a correct explanation for his findings.
- ☐ Science always progresses through correcting mistakes.

Espai per al corrector/a		
Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió oral	☐		

Part 3: Listening comprehension

THE BEST ADVICE

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

flecked: esquitxat / salpicado
lovelorn: ferit d'amor / herido de amor
uneventful: sense sobresalts, normal / sin sobresaltos, normal
slightest: mínim / mínimo
blessing: benedicció / bendición
arise (to arise): despertar, iniciar
accurate: precís / preciso

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Anthony Marra is a young American writer who grew up in Washington DC, and has lived and studied in Russia. His work has appeared in *Best American Nonrequired Reading 2012*. In 2013 Marra received the prestigious Whiting Writers' Award. His debut novel is entitled *A Constellation of Vital Phenomena* (2013). His story "Chechnya" won First Place in Narrative's Spring 2009 Story Contest and has received many prizes since then. In today's programme, Bertha Morris talks with Mr Marra about his work and his career.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. Anthony Marra is a young American writer
- ☐ who was born in Russia.
- ☐ who was born in Washington.
- ☒ who has been awarded several prizes.
- ☐ who has written many novels.

1. In the conversation we hear that Anthony Marra looks young ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ although he has quite a lot of gray hair.
- ☐ and yet he is already a classical writer.
- ☐ and old at the same time.
- ☐ although he has not finished school yet.

2. *A Constellation of Vital Phenomena* ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ is a novel about the author's personal experience.
- ☐ is based on the life of the author's family.
- ☐ is based both on research and fiction.
- ☐ was inspired by the author's first love.

3. Why isn't Anthony Marra interested in writing autobiography? ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ It would have no literary interest.
- ☐ It would cause a trauma to his family.
- ☐ He wants to keep his life private.
- ☐ His parents would not like to read about it.

4. In the interview we hear that Anthony Marra's father ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ was a professional geologist.
- ☐ convinced his son to become a geologist.
- ☐ became an amateur geologist.
- ☐ collected shark teeth and kept them by his desk.

5. In which way was the writer influenced by his father's advice? ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ He never followed his father's advice.
- ☐ He remembers his father's words as encouragement.
- ☐ He decided to choose a very different route.
- ☐ He always felt lucky enough without his father's help.

6. Which of the following statements about the author's interest on Chechnya is FALSE? ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ It arose during a visit in Russia as an undergraduate student.
- ☐ It was inspired by watching Russian veterans beg for money in the streets.
- ☐ It came after watching the Boston Marathon bombings.
- ☐ It was influenced by reading about the Russian actions in the Chechen wars.

7. According to Anthony Marra, what is most important in order to make his books convincing? ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ To have the exact details about the trees and the place.
- ☐ To be able to make the story ring true.
- ☐ To make the setting as realistic as possible.
- ☐ To be able to capture the character's feelings.

8. The interviewer thinks that Marra has succeeded in his novel because ☐ ☐ ☐
- ☐ of the humanity in his characters.
- ☐ Sarah Jessica Parker liked the book.
- ☐ the critics praised its intellectual ambition.
- ☐ many readers were identified with the story.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

SMILING INDIANS

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

proud: orgullós, satisfet / orgulloso, satisfecho
lopsided: esbiaixat, parcial / sesgado, parcial
to break into a grin: fer un somriure burlaner / hacer una sonrisa burlona
stray: perdut / perdido
gunshot: tret / disparo

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

In the early 1900s, photographer Edward Sheriff Curtis traveled around the United States photographing North American Indians from eigthy tribes. Those 2,000 or so black and white images show Native Americans in tribal dress: serious, facing the camera straight on and mostly all not smiling. Well, now, a century later, comes a video in response to Curtis's photos. It's titled *Smiling Indians*, and it's exactly that, four minutes of video of Native Americans, young and old, smiling and laughing. It was co-created by Ryan Red Corn, an Osage Indian from Oklahoma. Journalist Edward Block is chatting with Mr Red Corn today to find out more about the video and why he decided to make it.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. How many photographs did Edward Sheriff Curtis take?
- ☐ eigthy or so.
- ☒ approximately 2,000.
- ☐ about 1,900.
- ☐ 2,000 or so from each tribe.

1. What problem does Mr Red Corn have with Curtis's pictures?
- ☐ They never appear in history books.
- ☐ They are only shown in documentaries.
- ☐ They give people the impression that Indians never smile.
- ☐ They are the dominant image when you enter grade school.

2. According to the conversation, why didn't most people smile in old photographs?
- ☐ Because they wanted to look like Indians.
- ☐ Because people in the 1900s were very serious.
- ☐ Because smiling was not considered a good business.
- ☐ Because having your picture taken was a serious thing.

3. How did Mr Red Corn get people to smile in his video?
- ☐ He told them to look very serious and then break into a grin.
- ☐ He simply told them he was doing a video about smiling Indians.
- ☐ He told them to look ridiculous and lopsided for the video.
- ☐ He showed them pictures of smiling babies.

4. According to the interview, humor in Indian country is present
- ☐ everywhere all the time.
- ☐ wherever there are old-fashioned Indians.
- ☐ only on the surface.
- ☐ only in some communities.

5. The interviewer thinks it's difficult for Indians to smile because
- ☐ they can never find a reason to be positive.
- ☐ they don't like to say that they're enjoying themselves.
- ☐ many of them live in very tough conditions.
- ☐ they don't get a chance to enjoy themselves.

6. Mr Red Corn couldn't stop smiling while making the video because
- ☐ there were so many people laughing.
- ☐ the indians were making fun of him.
- ☐ he was trying to give a message.
- ☐ the older people were having too much fun.

7. When Mr Red Corn was editing the video he
- ☐ thought about poetic ways to end his days.
- ☐ was afraid that a stray bullet had come in.
- ☐ heard gunshots across the street.
- ☐ couldn't remember anything else.

8. How did the video end?
- ☐ With a message about what happened across the street.
- ☐ With a message that spoke to the heart of the video.
- ☐ With Mr Red Corn typing a message on his cell phone.
- ☐ With Mr Red Corn smiling.

Espai per al corrector/a		
Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió oral ☐

Part 3: Listening comprehension

NORWICH

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

mayor: batlle, alcalde / alcalde
keep: torre / torreón
spire: pinacle d'una torre / aguja de un torreón
cloister: claustre / claustro
Olympic Torch Relay: relleu de la torxa olímpica / relevo de la antorcha olímpica
banner: cartell / cartel

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Norwich is a city on the River Wensum in England and the regional administrative centre of Norfolk. With a population of more than 195,000 people, Norwich is an ideal destination for family and individual outings due to its proximity to London and its historical and cultural offer. With us today in our programme *Cities of the World*, is its mayor, Mr Johnston.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. Norwich
- ☐ has more than 200,000 inhabitants.
- ☒ is in Norfolk.
- ☐ is far from London.
- ☐ doesn't have many historical buildings.

1. When did Mr Johnston decide to run for Norwich mayor?
- ☐ Approximately ten years ago.
- ☐ Three years ago.
- ☐ Since he started working for the Labour Party.
- ☐ Since he organized city events.

2. Which of the following statements about Mr Johnston is FALSE?
- ☐ He has a degree in law.
- ☐ He studied at Harvard University.
- ☐ He lived away from Norwich for seven years.
- ☐ He was a member of Parliament.

3. When was Norwich the second largest city in England?
- ☐ From the Industrial Revolution to the present day.
- ☐ Only in the Medieval Age.
- ☐ From the 11th century till the Industrial Revolution.
- ☐ Only in the 11th century.

4. Norwich Castle
- ☐ keeps a model tower full of computers.
- ☐ used to be a palace for the Norman kings.
- ☐ was destroyed by the Normans.
- ☐ is now an archeological site.

5. Norwich Cathedral is
- ☐ surrounded by a cemetery.
- ☐ the tallest in England.
- ☐ Romanesque and has a tall spire.
- ☐ beautiful but has no cloister.

6. How long did the celebrations for the Olympic Torch Relay last?
- ☐ One evening.
- ☐ Two days.
- ☐ Three days.
- ☐ One day.

7. Which activities were organized to celebrate the Olympic Torch Relay?
- ☐ There were bands and people drawing in the streets.
- ☐ There were shows and animals parading in the streets.
- ☐ There was just a spectacular video projection in the city centre.
- ☐ There were video projections, shows and bands in the city centre.

8. Which of these things was NOT used in the city centre celebrations?
- ☐ Human pyramids.
- ☐ Giant puppets.
- ☐ Flags in lamp posts.
- ☐ Olympic colours in trees.

Espai per al corrector/a		
Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió oral			

Part 3: Listening comprehension

VEGETARIANISM

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

slaughter: sacrificar
slaughterhouse: escorxador / matadero
trust: confiar
bred (past participle of *breed*): criat / criado
shortage: escassetat / escasez
stuffed: fart /atiborrado

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

According to an opinion poll recently published in the press, vegetarianism is on the increase. In today's programme Michael Thomson, chef and owner of a restaurant famous for the quality of the meat it serves, and Mary Stone, TV actress and a committed vegetarian, will present their views on vegetarianism.

Text adapted from a BBC Radio 4 interview

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.
[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. Michael Thomson is
- ☐ a journalist.
- ☒ a chef.
- ☐ a businessman.
- ☐ a vegetarian.

1. Mary thinks that many people become vegetarian because they
- ☐ become anxious when they eat meat.
- ☐ are committed to their beliefs.
- ☐ are impressed by images in the media.
- ☐ are convinced by other vegetarians.

2. What does Michael think is important in a person's diet?
- ☐ Avoiding bad food.
- ☐ Eating meat.
- ☐ Eating at a restaurant.
- ☐ Eating fish.

3. In Michael's restaurant fish dishes are more popular now
- ☐ than meat dishes.
- ☐ than they used to be.
- ☐ because they are cheaper.
- ☐ because people eat out more.

4. What should be done in order to improve the quality of meat, according to Michael?
- ☐ Animal suffering should be stopped.
- ☐ There should be more investment in farms.
- ☐ Better slaughterhouses should be built.
- ☐ Animals should be fed with healthier food.

5. Mary and Michael both agree that
- ☐ factory farming methods are bad.
- ☐ animals have been bred to eat.
- ☐ animals should not be bred in farms.
- ☐ factory farms should be closed down.

6. In order to stop animal suffering, Mary thinks we should
- ☐ build larger factory farms.
- ☐ stop eating meat.
- ☐ adopt healthy eating habits.
- ☐ stop building modern farms.

7. Michael thinks that vegetarians should let other people
- ☐ eat red meat.
- ☐ eat more fish dishes.
- ☐ eat veggie-burgers.
- ☐ eat what they want.

8. Which of the following statements is correct?
- ☐ Eighty-seven per cent of the population are not vegetarians.
- ☐ Many meat-eaters also eat veggie-burgers.
- ☐ Famous people like Verdi enjoyed eating meat.
- ☐ Veggie-burgers sell better than meat-burgers.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Part 3: Listening comprehension

IS HOLLYWOOD IN CRISIS?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

to market: promocionar
brand: marca
appeal: atraure / atraer
neglected: desatès / desatendido
garbage: brossa / basura
assume: donar per fet / dar por sentado

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

According to writer Mark Harris, Hollywood is in deep crisis. He says that the atmosphere in the movie-making capital of the world is so cautious that most executives are afraid to try new formulas. So moviegoers are left with a continuous repetition of the same titles. This year alone, Hollywood has produced *Spy Kids 4*, *Final Destination 5*, more *Harry Potter*, more *Pirates of the Caribbean*, more and more of what we've seen before. There are common themes that both filmmakers and **brands** return to, time and time again. In his book, Mark Harris asks: How did we get here? Today he has been invited to talk to reporter Barbara Walker about his recent article "The Day the Movies Died" and maybe he will be able to answer that question for us.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. Mark Harris thinks Hollywood is in trouble because…
- ☐ moviegoers are cautious to try new repetitions.
- ☒ executives don't want to risk new formulas.
- ☐ there will not be any more *Pirates of the Caribbean*.
- ☐ the atmosphere is in continuous repetition.

1. How much does it cost to market a movie?
- ☐ Over $50 million.
- ☐ Up to $40 or $50 million.
- ☐ Under $40 million.
- ☐ Between $40 and $50.

2. Who decides what movies get made?
- ☐ The people who make adult dramas.
- ☐ The studios who make big adventure movies.
- ☐ The studios that want quality stories.
- ☐ The people who pay for the marketing.

3. Mark Harris considers *Top Gun* an important movie because…
- ☐ it was one of Tom Cruise's greatest successes.
- ☐ it had the right kind of soundtrack.
- ☐ it represented a change from content to image.
- ☐ it was made for a large audience.

4. Mark Harris thinks that a movie like *The Godfather* would probably not be made today because…
- ☐ it might cost less than $40 million.
- ☐ it was less successful than *Taxi Driver*.
- ☐ it would probably cost too much money.
- ☐ it's not good business to make adult dramas.

5. According to Mr Harris, the audience nowadays is divided into…
- ☐ one group for age and one for gender.
- ☐ four groups, based on age and gender.
- ☐ two groups: over 25 and under 25.
- ☐ four groups, based on marketing.

6. According to the interview, which group is the most neglected?
- ☐ Basically, Hollywood women.
- ☐ Women who are over 25 years old.
- ☐ Women who are under 25 years old.
- ☐ Adult women who stay at home.

7. Movie producers believe that a lot of people would stay at home unless…
- ☐ the movie shows a vicious circle.
- ☐ the movie is made for adult moviegoers.
- ☐ Sandra Bullock plays a woman under 25.
- ☐ there's a movie with Sandra Bullock in it.

8. Will there be a continuation of *Top Gun*?
- ☐ No, because the bosses in the studios are not interested.
- ☐ Yes, and it is very good news for kids and teenagers.
- ☐ Yes, and that's bad news for those who love other kind of movies.
- ☐ Maybe, because the kids who loved *Top Gun* are now bosses.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Etiqueta del corrector/a

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

L'Institut d'Estudis Catalans ha tingut cura de la correcció lingüística i de l'edició d'aquesta prova d'accés

Part 3: Listening comprehension

LIVING IN GREENLAND

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

ice sheet: capa de gel / manto de hielo
snowplow: màquina llevaneu / máquina quitanieves
dog sleds: trineus tirats per gossos / trineos tirados por perros
stink: fer pudor / apestar
sniff: ensumar / oler
spare change: xavalla / calderilla
Northern Lights: aurora boreal
whistle: xiular / silbar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

JOURNALIST: With us today is Chris Ryan, a student of Spanish Studies at the University of Lleida, who grew up in one of the world's remotest nations, Greenland. Today we will have the chance to learn more about Greenland and Greenlandic life.

[Now listen to the rest of the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. How much of Greenland is covered on ice?
- ☐ 20 %
- ☒ 80 %
- ☐ The size of Spain.
- ☐ Half its surface.

1. What makes Chris uncomfortable about the hot weather?
- ☐ He's never hot in Greenland.
- ☐ The way he has to dress for hot weather.
- ☐ He doesn't like wearing shorts or t-shirts.
- ☐ He doesn't know: he's never been in Lleida in July.

2. According to Chris, what's the main difference between winters in Greenland and in Spain?
- ☐ Everything stops in Spain if there's 5 cm of snow.
- ☐ There are no snowplows in Spain to take snow away.
- ☐ In Greenland, people go wild when driving in the snow.
- ☐ Most shops close in Greenland when it snows.

3. Why did Chris like to go to Spain on holidays? Because…
- ☐ it was almost as if he had always lived there.
- ☐ he found Greenland boring.
- ☐ films and clothes in Spain were more updated.
- ☐ he could meet her grandparents.

4. Why are you NOT allowed riding dog sleds in Nuuk?
- ☐ Because dogs are dangerous; they are not pets.
- ☐ Because dogs are kept as pets.
- ☐ Because a child was killed by a dog once.
- ☐ Because dog owners do not respect them.

5. How do people travel from town to town in Greenland?
- ☐ People have cars and bicycles.
- ☐ People fly by helicopter.
- ☐ People ride on dog sleds.
- ☐ People ride on reindeer sleds.

6. Why do Danish teachers and doctors go to work in Greenland?
- ☐ It's only a four-hour flight to Denmark.
- ☐ It's compulsory practice before working in Denmark.
- ☐ The pay is not very high but life is not expensive in Greenland.
- ☐ They are very well paid even if life in Greenland is expensive.

7. Which two things does Chris mention as strange habits on your birthday in Greenland?
— On your birthday, you…
- ☐ are sniffed and you throw coins in the air.
- ☐ have a *piñata* with coins instead of sweets.
- ☐ are sniffed and you are said to stink.
- ☐ throw coins in the air which the children collect.

8. Which is the local story behind the Northern Lights?
- ☐ The lights are spirits who take you if you whistle while they play.
- ☐ The lights are heads playing football.
- ☐ The lights are whistles that play with balls.
- ☐ People should whistle when the lights die out.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	☐	☐	☐
2.	☐	☐	☐
3.	☐	☐	☐
4.	☐	☐	☐
5.	☐	☐	☐
6.	☐	☐	☐
7.	☐	☐	☐
8.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió oral ☐

Etiqueta del corrector/a

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

L'Institut d'Estudis Catalans ha tingut cura de la correcció lingüística i de l'edició d'aquesta prova d'accés

Part 3: Listening comprehension

INTERVIEW WITH STEVEN SPENCER (DETECTIVE DAVID JONES)

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

scary: que fa por / que da miedo
stunt: escena perillosa / escena peligrosa
wire: cable
bruise: contusió / contusión
scar: cicatriu / cicatriz
weird: estrany / extraño

Ready?

Now read the questions on the next page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Steven Spencer made his acting debut at age 16 in BBC 2's television action film called *Life or Death,* and playing the role of detective David Jones at age 23. Jones has starred in five *David Jones*' films since 2001, the final one being released in July 2011.

Text adapted from a BBC Radio Interview

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. Steve Spencer is…
- ☐ a writer.
- ☒ an actor.
- ☐ a singer.
- ☐ a musician.

1. Steve is apparently nervous because he…
- ☐ doesn't like being interviewed.
- ☐ always gets excited when being interviewed.
- ☐ has never been interviewed on the radio before.
- ☐ doesn't know what to say.

2. The last *David Jones* film is different from the previous films because…
- ☐ it is Steve's favourite *David Jones* film.
- ☐ there's a lot more stunts.
- ☐ you never know what's coming next.
- ☐ it is more sophisticated and scary.

3. Steve likes doing his own stunts. In his latest film…
- ☐ he almost killed himself.
- ☐ he had to climb up a statue.
- ☐ he got a few scars in a sword fight.
- ☐ he was on a wire and got injured.

4. Why was Steve scared when the director asked him to write about his character?
- ☐ Because he was terrified, just to think about it.
- ☐ Because Steven doesn't like to work.
- ☐ Because the director asked him to write parts of the film.
- ☐ Because he found out how much like David Jones he himself was.

5. Which of the following statements is true?
- ☐ Steve went to see the Chilli Peppers in Hyde Park.
- ☐ Steve went to his first concert last year.
- ☐ Steve will be seeing The Drixies in December.
- ☐ Steve never gets to see any concerts.

6. How did Steve learn about The Drixies?
- ☐ He heard one of their songs in a film soundtrack.
- ☐ He saw a compilation of their records in a music store.
- ☐ He downloaded a compilation of their greatest hits record.
- ☐ He saw a film about the band playing at a club.

7. According to the interview, Steve
- ☐ gets obsessed with films.
- ☐ goes to too many festivals and concerts.
- ☐ doesn't like film soundtracks.
- ☐ is crazy about The Drixies.

8. Steve would like to have the time to…
- ☐ go to more film festivals.
- ☐ listen to the kind of music he likes.
- ☐ play the guitar in a band.
- ☐ go to music concerts.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Etiqueta del corrector/a

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

L'Institut d'Estudis Catalans ha tingut cura de la correcció lingüística i de l'edició d'aquesta prova d'accés

Part 3: Listening comprehension

LOST… OR MAYBE NOT?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

crew: equip / equipo
sequel: continuació / continuación
clue: pista
source: font / fuente
huge: enorme
stage: etapa
thread: fil / hilo
to wrap up: concloure / concluir

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the interview.

Since *Lost*, one of the most successful TV shows in recent times, came to a dramatic finish at the end of the sixth season, many fans have been wondering whether the last episode could have possibly left any options for a sequel. In the following interview, Pat Lawson chats with Matthew Fox, Dr. Jack Shepard in the show, and tries to find out how truly final the end was.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. *Lost* was a TV show that…
- ☐ had a successful sequel in recent times.
- ☒ was one of the most successful shows in recent times.
- ☐ finished at the beginning of the sixth season.
- ☐ not many fans have been wondering about.

1. Matthew Fox is surprised that…
- ☐ people have lost interest in the show so soon.
- ☐ so many people are still interested in the show.
- ☐ people's interests have moved to other shows.
- ☐ speculation about the show lasted for one month.

2. About the show's end…
- ☐ everybody was happy with it.
- ☐ everybody was disappointed with it.
- ☐ people were neither happy nor disappointed.
- ☐ some people liked it a lot, some didn't like it at all.

3. What are some fans looking for in the last episode?
- ☐ Hidden secrets about the last episode.
- ☐ The presence of a hidden message.
- ☐ Hidden cues about the possibility for a sequel.
- ☐ Evidence of extraterrestrials.

4. Matthew Fox finds it fascinating that…
- ☐ they were all abducted by aliens but didn't know it.
- ☐ the show was a source of aliens.
- ☐ so many people discussed the show.
- ☐ the aliens helped to create the source of discussion.

5. How does Matthew Fox feel about the possibility of a sequel?
- ☐ He will know if there will be one as soon as the interview is published.
- ☐ He's convinced that there will not be one.
- ☐ He thinks the other actors disagree with him.
- ☐ He thinks a sequel would be a turning point in his career.

6. A sequel without Dr. Shepard or Hurley wouldn't be the same because…
- ☐ these characters did not generate a lot of interest in the forums.
- ☐ *Lost* was a unique thing that can't be repeated.
- ☐ they weren't interested in serious time travel.
- ☐ it would ruin the theories about the island.

7. According to Matthew Fox, the last episode is…
- ☐ appropriate because it is so complicated.
- ☐ appropriate because it concludes a very complicated story line.
- ☐ inappropriate because it finished all the open threads.
- ☐ inappropriate because all questions were answered.

8. Was *Lost* a realistic show?
- ☐ Yes, because the people in the island lived for hundreds of years.
- ☐ No, because polar bears and smoke monsters don't live hundreds of years.
- ☐ Yes, because tropical islands are usually inhabited by polar bears.
- ☐ No, because it showed a tropical island inhabited by polar bears and smoke monsters.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	☐	☐	☐
2.	☐	☐	☐
3.	☐	☐	☐
4.	☐	☐	☐
5.	☐	☐	☐
6.	☐	☐	☐
7.	☐	☐	☐
8.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió oral ☐

Part 3: Listening comprehension

JOHN CRAVEN: THE BEST-LOVED PRESENTER ON BRITISH TELEVISION

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

to miss: faltar
apprentice: aprenent / aprendiz
eye-catching: que crida l'atenció / que llama la atención
push the boundaries: portar al límit / llevar al límite
AIDS: sida
rewarding: gratificant / gratificante

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Famous for his jumpers and his relaxed behaviour, John Craven is one of the best-loved presenters on British television. He has been the presenter of the BBC television programmes *Newsround* and *Countryfile*, and in 1996 the Royal Television Society made John Craven a member of its Hall of Fame.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. John Craven is a…
   - ☐ TV producer.
   - ☒ TV presenter.
   - ☐ cinema star.
   - ☐ member of the British royal family.

1. John Craven first missed an episode of *Newsround* because…
   - ☐ his wife was ill.
   - ☐ his daughter was born.
   - ☐ he was on holiday.
   - ☐ his daughter was ill.

2. John Craven started out in journalism as a…
   - ☐ commercial apprentice.
   - ☐ company secretary.
   - ☐ student of journalism at university.
   - ☐ reporter on a local newspaper.

3. John Craven thinks that computer graphics are…
   - ☐ absolutely necessary nowadays on television.
   - ☐ useless to help the audience understand a story.
   - ☐ only needed on television if they are really eye-catching.
   - ☐ changing the way stories are presented on television.

4. After an edition of *Newsround* entirely devoted to AIDS, John Craven…
   - ☐ regretted having pushed the boundaries.
   - ☐ believed he had not gone far enough.
   - ☐ received lots of complaints.
   - ☐ did not have any regrets.

5. John Craven accepted presenting the programme *Countryfile* because…
   - ☐ he was fed up with the daily news business after 17 years.
   - ☐ it was the only choice he had after 17 years on *Newsround*.
   - ☐ he felt like changing directions and doing something new.
   - ☐ he wanted to contribute to the conservation of the environment in Britain.

6. In the future, John Craven would like to present a TV programme…
   - ☐ about travelling in the countryside.
   - ☐ about the environment and sightseeing.
   - ☐ for people living in the countryside.
   - ☐ for teenagers and children in general.

7. According to John Craven, children and teenagers…
   - ☐ are interested in many different things.
   - ☐ have too many problems.
   - ☐ think adults are destroying the world.
   - ☐ are only interested in quiz shows and pop stars.

8. John Craven…
   - ☐ has been the lead presenter of *Newsround* since 1989.
   - ☐ is very proud of his job in *Newsround* and *Countryfile*.
   - ☐ has been the lead presenter of *Countryfile* for 17 years.
   - ☐ would not mind retiring from the broadcasting business.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Etiqueta del corrector/a

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

L'Institut d'Estudis Catalans ha tingut cura de la correcció lingüística i de l'edició d'aquesta prova d'accés

Part 3: Listening comprehension

THE END OF THE WORLD TRAIN

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

bay: badia / bahía
timber: fusta per a la construcció / madera para la construcción
bounded: delimitat / delimitado
convict: pres / preso
woodcutting site: serradora / serrería
mainland: terra ferma / tierra firme

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the interview.

Ushuaia in Argentina is the southernmost city in the world. No other place gives us the opportunity to make a trip on the Southern Railway, proudly advertised as *The end of the World Train*. Today in our programme *Round the World*, we're pleased to introduce Chris Van Gils, a keen traveller. Hi Chris, and welcome to our programme.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

0. Ushuaia is the…
   - ☐ northernmost city in Argentina.
   - ☒ southernmost city in the world.
   - ☐ name of a train.
   - ☐ name of a railway station.

1. Where is Ushuaia located? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ On the mountainous island of Antarctica.
   - ☐ On an island by a channel.
   - ☐ On the mainland near Beagle Channel.
   - ☐ On mainland Argentina.

2. What type of prison was built in Ushuaia? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ A prison for first-time convicts.
   - ☐ A prison for people sentenced to death.
   - ☐ A prison for Australian and English prisoners.
   - ☐ A maximum security prison.

3. When did the first prisoners arrive in Ushuaia? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ At the end of the 18th century.
   - ☐ At the beginning of the 19th century.
   - ☐ At the beginning of the 20th century.
   - ☐ At the end of the 19th century.

4. Which of the following sentences is TRUE? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ The Yamanas gave the name to the prison.
   - ☐ *Yamana* is the name of the prison in Ushuaia.
   - ☐ The name *Ushuaia* comes from the indigenous people.
   - ☐ There were no indigenous people in Tierra del Fuego.

5. Who built the prison? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ It was built by the people of Ushuaia.
   - ☐ It was built by all the prisoners.
   - ☐ It was built only by the prisoners sentenced to death.
   - ☐ We do not know exactly who built the prison.

6. What other name did the train have? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ The Wooden Train.
   - ☐ The Convict Train.
   - ☐ The Prison Train.
   - ☐ The Transport Train.

7. Which route did the train cover when it was used by the prisoners? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ It started in the jail and ended in the city.
   - ☐ It ran from the waterfront to the prison.
   - ☐ It went from Ushuaia to the National Park.
   - ☐ It started in the prison and ended in the forest.

8. Why did the train stop running in 1949? ☐ ☐ ☐
   - ☐ The government closed it down.
   - ☐ The National Park opened.
   - ☐ The prison was closed and it was no longer needed.
   - ☐ It was destroyed by an earthquake.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Etiqueta del corrector/a

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

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Part 2: Reading comprehension

WHAT'S AFTER UMAMI? SCIENTISTS ARE HUNTING FOR THE SIXTH BASIC TASTE

In 1908, Japanese chemist Kikunae Ikeda was studying the active substances in **seaweed**, when he made a discovery that would change food science forever. Ikeda realized that a compound called *glutamic acid* was what gave seaweed its distinctive taste—nothing like the existing basic tastes of sweet, salty, sour, and bitter. He named that taste *umami*.

Yet even though people have been eating seaweed, mushrooms, miso, cheese, and fermented foods for ages, it took nearly a century of scientific debate for umami to be recognized worldwide as the fifth basic taste. It wasn't until the 1990s that it gained universal recognition, and only after extensive scientific studies confirmed that it was unlike any other existing taste.

Is it time to add a sixth taste to the list? Some scientists argue that the answer is yes, though there is still debate about what it should be. Scientists have not been intentionally searching for a sixth taste. Rather, "there's a fundamental science-based search for different ways we can experience the world in terms of taste and how it's detected," explains neuroscientist Emily Liman.

Advances in understanding the science of taste would allow food scientists to create more delicious foods—and could also help doctors diagnose and treat related disorders that involve a loss of your sense of taste. But getting the scientific community to agree on a sixth sense is not easy. To qualify as a basic taste, any competitor must be proven to be as distinct as the sweetness of berries or the bitterness of kale.

First, it's important to note that "there's a difference between taste and flavor," says Marisa Moore, a dietitian in culinary nutrition from Atlanta. "Taste begins on the tongue when food molecules we eat mix with saliva and activate our **taste buds**, which then send signals to the brain and cause the perception of distinct tastes." Contrary to popular belief, the tongue does not have specific areas that detect each type of taste. Instead, basic tastes can be picked up by taste buds on various parts of the tongue, though different cells may have varying levels of sensitivity to sweet, sour, salty, bitter, and umami.

While taste begins in the mouth, flavor is what registers in the brain when it combines the entire experience of taste, texture, temperature, and aroma. "Taste and other senses do interact in the brain to put together flavor," says Richard Mattes, professor of nutrition science at Purdue University, "but that's different from taste."

Various criteria have been proposed over the years to define a new taste. For starters, a taste needs to have a "chemical signature"—a set of chemical components that are distinct from that of other substances. Then, Mattes says, "you need to have a receptor anywhere on the tongue, **palate**, or throat where the chemical component can interact with a cell in a taste bud." That cell in the taste bud must then have a mechanism "to change the component's chemical signal to an electrical signal that is then transmitted through nerves to the brain," Mattes adds. The electrical signal carried by taste nerves must activate regions in the brain that are associated with taste, and it needs to generate a unique taste perception in the brain that is independent from other tastes. Finally, there needs to be a response in the body that results from these effects. For example, Mattes says, "the perception of sweetness triggers the release of insulin throughout the body."

In short, a major challenge to getting the scientific community to accept a new taste has to do with the complexity of the research that needs to be conducted. "You have to go through a lot to prove a taste exists," says Dawn Jackson Blatner, a dietitian nutritionist in Chicago. None of the candidates for a sixth basic taste have passed all experimental tests yet—but some of them are closer to doing so than others. Despite all these complications, scientists continue to study taste—and debate what the next big one might be—because taste is important, as it is about what we **crave**, how we cook, and how satisfied we feel after eating.

Text adapted from an article by
Stacey Colino. *National Geographic* [online] (November 25, 2025)

seaweed: alga
taste bud: papil·la gustativa / papila gustativa
palate: paladar
crave: tenir desig de / tener antojo de

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. How did umami become recognized as the fifth basic taste? USE YOUR OWN WORDS TO ANSWER THE QUESTION. You may keep the words in the question.

2. Complete the following sentence:

Improving the diagnosis of taste-related illnesses and permitting researchers to make food tastier are…

3. Find a phrase in the text that means the following: "Unlike what people usually think".

4. According to the text, what is flavor the result of?

5. Name TWO of the different criteria that have been proposed over the years to define a new taste.

6. In what sense does the study of taste continue to be important? In your answer, mention the THREE reasons given in the text. USE YOUR OWN WORDS.

1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	
6.	
Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

THE SCIENCE OF FEAR: HOW IT AFFECTS YOUR BODY AND MIND

Fear is a natural response that has helped humans survive dangerous situations for centuries. While, unlike those faced by our ancestors, today's threats are less likely to involve sabre-tooth tigers, haunted houses, scary movies, and harmless **pranks** still trigger the same physical and emotional reactions. The body's fight-or-flight response releases stress hormones and prepares us to either face the challenge or escape it. But how exactly does fear work, and what happens when it is activated too often?

The amygdala is a part of the brain that handles the processing of emotions and detection of danger. The fear response originates from it; upon detecting an apparent peril, signals are sent to the hypothalamus. The hypothalamus is an organ that initiates nervous and endocrine systems. Further, it encourages the release of stress hormones like cortisol, adrenaline, and noradrenaline. These chemicals cause a chain reaction in the body: your heart beats faster to pump oxygen-rich blood to your muscles and brain, your breathing quickens, your pupils dilate for better vision, and your muscles tense up ready for action. Adrenaline also reduces pain and heightens focus, allowing you to respond effectively to a threat. Interestingly, the release of dopamine, another hormone, can create a feeling of happiness during fear-inducing situations, which explains why some people enjoy being scared.

Your brain doesn't instantly distinguish between actual and imagined dangers. When an actor in a haunted house jumps out wearing a scary mask, for example, your body automatically behaves as if the danger were real. This is the automatic and brief initial phase of the fear response. However, the prefrontal cortex, the part of the brain that is responsible for reasoning, quickly weighs this event. It confers with the hippocampus, an organ that **retrieves** the memories of similar events from storage to determine if there really is any danger. If you have been through a haunted house before, your brain knows the threat is not real, and the fear response turns off. But when the situation is unfamiliar—say, some terrifying scene in a horror movie—your body may release stress hormones, and physical effects—such as a racing heart or sweaty palms—may be more obvious.

While the fear response is necessary for survival, frequent activation can damage the body. Continuous release of stress hormones may lead to high blood pressure, heart problems, digestive issues and immune system dysregulation because your body is constantly in "high alert" mode. Chronic exposure to jump scares can also desensitize the brain to real threats, potentially dulling critical survival instincts.

Some groups should take more care with scary activities. For instance, people with heart diseases, chronic pain, and anxiety disorders are more sensitive to the negative side effects of scares. According to experts, scary activities are not recommended in order to protect mental and physical health.

Controlled scares—the ones in haunted houses or elsewhere—are enjoyable to many. The temporary flash of stress hormones followed by relief creates an **exhilarating** sensation. But just like with any other activity involving health risks, moderation must be observed. When you become aware of what fear is, you can appreciate its role in survival and entertainment but also treat its impact on your health with respect.

Text adapted from an article by
Daryl Austin. *National Geographic* [online] (October 2, 2024)

prank: bretolada, broma / gamberrada, broma
retrieve: recuperar
exhilarating: emocionant, excitant / emocionante, excitante

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. According to the text, which threat is not usually encountered today?

2. Paraphrase the following sentence: "The release of dopamine […] can create a feeling of happiness during fear-inducing situations" (lines 14-15). You may keep the word *dopamine*.

3. How does the hippocampus help in distinguishing real threats from fake ones? DO NOT COPY DIRECTLY FROM THE TEXT. You may keep the words *hippocampus*, *brain*, and *past*.

4. How can frequent exposure to scary experiences affect someone's reaction to real danger?

5. Find a synonym in the text for *consider* in the sense of "assess, evaluate, and analyze."

6. Complete the following sentence:

It's important to understand what fear is so that you…

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

YOU MIGHT BE A LATE BLOOMER

Today we live in a society structured to promote early bloomers. Our school system has sorted people by the time they are 18, using grades and university entrance exam scores. Some of these people zoom to prestigious academic trajectories while others get left behind. Many of our most prominent models of success made it big while young—Bill Gates, Mark Zuckerberg, Elon Musk, Taylor Swift, Michael Jordan. Magazines publish lists to glamorize youthful superstars on the rise. Age discrimination is a fact of life. But for many people, the talents that bloom later in life are more consequential than the ones that bloom early. Even brilliant people apparently need at least a couple of decades to master their field.

Successful late bloomers are all around us. Morgan Freeman had his first key roles in *Street Smart* and *Driving Miss Daisy* in his early 50s. Colonel Harland Sanders started Kentucky Fried Chicken in his 60s. Isak Dinesen published the book that established her literary reputation, *Out of Africa*, at 52. Morris Chang founded Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing, the world's leading chipmaker, at 55. If Samuel Johnson had died at 40, few would remember him, but now he is considered one of the greatest writers in the history of the English language. Copernicus came up with his theory of planetary motion in his 60s.

Why do some people **hit their peak** later than others? In his book *Late Bloomers*, the journalist Rich Karlgaard points out that late bloomers are not simply early bloomers on a delayed timetable—they didn't just do the things early bloomers did but at a later age. Late bloomers tend to be *qualitatively* different. They possess a different set of abilities that are mostly invisible to or discouraged by our current education system. They usually have to invent their own paths. Late bloomers "fulfill their potential frequently in novel and unexpected ways," Karlgaard writes, "surprising even those closest to them."

If you survey history, a taxonomy of achievement emerges. In the first category are the "early bloomers," the precocious geniuses. These are people like Picasso or Fitzgerald who succeeded young. As the University of Chicago economist David Galenson has pointed out, these high achievers usually made a conceptual **breakthrough**. They came up with a new idea and then executed it. Then there are the "second-mountain people," exemplified by, say, Albert Schweitzer. First, they conquer their career mountain; Schweitzer, for instance, was an accomplished musician and scholar. But these people find their career success unsatisfying, so they leave their career mountain to serve humanity—their whole motivational structure shifts from acquisition to altruism. Schweitzer became a doctor in the poorest parts of Africa, and won the Nobel Peace Prize for his work in 1952. Finally, there are the people Galenson calls "the masters." These are people like Cézanne or Alfred Hitchcock or Charles Darwin, who were not all that successful—and in some cases just not even very good at what they did—when they were young. This could have been discouraging, but they just kept improving.

Late bloomers don't do as much advance planning as the conceptual geniuses, but they regard their entire lives as experiments. They try something and learn, and then they try something else and learn more. Their focus is not on their finished work, which they often throw away **haphazardly**. Their focus is on the process of learning itself, which they enjoy. They live their lives as a long period of trial and error, trying this and trying that, a slow process of accumulation and elaboration, so the quality of their work peaks late in life. They are the ugly ducklings of human achievement, who, over the decades, turn themselves into swans. Slow at the start, late bloomers are still sprinting during that final lap—they do not slow down as age brings its decay. They are seeking. They are striving. They are in it with all their heart.

Text adapted from an article by
David Brooks. *The Atlantic* [online] (June 26, 2024)

hit their peak: assolir el cim / alcanzar la cima
breakthrough: descobriment / descubrimiento
haphazardly: de qualsevol manera / de cualquier manera

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. What evidence does the author of the text use to claim that our society is structured to promote early bloomers? Mention ONE piece of evidence.

2. Explain what the examples of late bloomers in the second paragraph have in common (besides being well-known figures).

3. Explain IN YOUR OWN WORDS the consequence of late bloomers' invisibility to the current education system.

4. What is meant by the term *second-mountain people* (line 27)?

5. Rewrite the following sentence: "They possess a different set of abilities that are mostly invisible to or discouraged by our current education system" (lines 19-20). You may keep grammatical words (i.e. articles, pronouns, conjunctions, etc.) and the word *education*.

6. Mention TWO characteristics of late bloomers.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

TIPPING IS MORE CONFUSING THAN EVER. HERE'S HOW TO HANDLE IT

Tipping has never been more confusing. Americans might always have disagreed on exactly how much to tip—20, 15, 10 percent?—but they generally knew where to do it. Now, tipping screens are popping up on iPads practically everywhere, and politicians are making things even harder by trying to adjust the laws around tipping.

Americans have been leaving a little extra with the bill for pretty much as long as the country has existed. But the practice really only took off after the Civil War, when travelers abroad brought the custom home to pay formerly enslaved black people, many of whom worked for a **pittance** as porters for the Pullman Company. Eventually, when restaurants took off as an industry separate from hotels and boarding places, gratuity became popular there, too. When minimum wage laws arrived with the New Deal, it made sense to legislators to exempt workers in professions where the expected tips would account for the difference. Similar thinking held when Congress created the "tip credit" system in the 1960s: allowing businesses to pay tipped personnel a subminimum wage only as long as tips brought their earnings to or above the minimum.

From there, tipping culture perpetuated itself. Americans know restaurant workers or, to a lesser extent, carwashers and hairdressers, legally don't take home enough money without tips, so the expectation that people will tip them has become customary. And as long as Americans keep tipping, the law can stay the same. Only recently, this status quo has become unstable. The laws started to change in the 2010s, when some cities, including D.C., and several states decided to experiment with cancelling the tip credit. Meanwhile, Congress passed legislation in 2018 allowing restaurants that pay servers the statutory minimum to redistribute any tips those employees *do* receive to back-of-house staff. Norms have changed, too, in more recent years—but in the opposite direction. Seventy-two percent of Americans said in a 2023 survey that they believe tips are expected in more places. That's thanks in part to the dawn of the digital payment era: pressing "no" on an iPad tip screen feels a lot ruder than neglecting to **toss** a dollar in a glass jar.

There's plenty of reasons to wish tipping would disappear altogether. People's tips might depend on how they look rather than the quality of their service. The unpredictability of pay—a rainy night likely means a lighter wallet—means undue financial stress for the tipped worker. Cooks and dishwashers also end up worse off than servers, especially at higher-end establishments, regardless of skill. On the other hand, research suggests the existence of tipping may yield better service, at least here in the United States. And many restaurants have struggled to support themselves without the flexibility the system allows them. In short, tipping probably isn't going to disappear anytime soon, and something like the status quo is not necessarily bad.

Where does that leave customers? One principle is simple: Where there's a subminimum wage, tip. The second factor to consider is more complicated and more personal: tip when someone is doing you a service that's worth more to you than the person serving you is getting for it. Maybe that is someone doing an average job in an above-average way—a locksmith who spends hours in the cold to let you in your house, or a barista with a flair for latte art. Or maybe it's someone doing unpleasant work for very little—hotel cleaning staff remedying a big mess. What kind of tipper are you?

Text adapted from an article by
David Shipley. *The Washington Post* [online] (September 23, 2024)

pittance: misèria / miseria
toss: llençar / lanzar

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. When and how did the practice of tipping start in America?

2. Find a sentence in the text that corresponds to the following rewritten/paraphrased sentence: "Since the early days of the United States, people have routinely added a small bonus to their payments."

3. Explain the tip credit system that was created in the 1960s IN YOUR OWN WORDS. You may use the words *pay*, *minimum* and *businesses*.

4. Why are tips believed to be expected in more places now?

5. Rewrite/paraphrase the sentence: "People's tips might depend on how they look rather than the quality of their service" (lines 27-28). You may keep grammatical words (i.e. *the*, *might*, *their*, *how*, etc.) and the following words: *tips*, *service*.

6. Explain IN YOUR OWN WORDS the second factor customers should consider when deciding whether to tip or not.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW TO MAKE PIZZA LIKE A NEAPOLITAN MASTER

When you think of Italy's most memorable dishes, its beloved pizza will most likely be among your top three favourites. It's a comfort food that has become an obsession around the world. But what makes pizza from Italy so special, and where do you find the very best?

Like so many of the country's most prized gastronomic delights like wine, olive oil and cheese, the quintessential pie from Naples, where pizza was born, is now worthy of its own Designation of Controlled Origin (DOC). The city's pizza-making tradition even received Unesco recognition in 2017 as an **intangible cultural heritage** item. Naples is the hub of the *pizza napoletana*, with generations of the same family groomed in the art of being a *pizzaiolo* (pizzamaker). And each family carefully guards its recipe variations with a passion that's matched perhaps only by the city's love for its football team. There are three basic types of Neapolitan pizza: the Margherita, topped with tomato sauce, mozzarella cheese and fresh **basil**; the marinara, with no cheese and oregano and garlic instead of basil; and the "DOC", made with *mozzarella di bufala* instead of the usual *fior di latte* made from cow's milk.

Pizza is said to have originated in the city in the 1700s, after one of the essential ingredients, the tomato, was brought from Peru. But even before that, Neapolitans had been eating a version of the pita, a kind of flatbread brought from Arabic immigrants, and which eventually evolved into "pizza" in the local dialect. Most upper-class Europeans originally considered tomatoes to be poisonous, but at a time of almost famine, local Neapolitans started topping their humble flatbreads with tomatoes, and soon the creation became a staple of the city's cuisine. Today, there are more than 500 pizzerias in Naples, but only a fifth of them are certified by the True Neapolitan Pizza Association, an organisation created in 1984 to protect and distinguish authentic pies from the wannabes. Its criteria are based not only on the ingredients that go into the pie—including everything from the type of flour in the dough to the provenance of the cheese—but also the preparation, from the dough fermentation style to oven temperature. The Association now even holds an annual contest to judge which pizza makers are the best in the world.

So, how does one make an authentic Neapolitan pizza? To begin with, the dough must be made with Italian wheat flour, fresh brewer's **yeast**, water and salt. The dough must be rolled by hand or with a slow speed mixer; never using a **rolling pin**. However, twirling it in the air to oxygenate the dough might be best left to the professional *pizzaioli*. Pureed tomatoes are another necessary ingredient for a great pie—preferably San Marzano, which grow on the volcanic plains of Mount Vesuvius and are required for pizzas with DOC designation. Only two types of mozzarella should be used to get the designation: *fior di latte* made from cow's milk; or *mozzarella di bufala*, made from the milk of the water buffalo that live in the Campania and Lazio regions.

Of course, part of Neapolitan pizza's fame comes from how it's cooked. The dough must be no more than 3 mm thick and must bake for 60 to 90 seconds at a very high temperature inside a wood-burning oven, resulting in a pizza that's crispy but not burnt. It all sounds easy enough, but there is a reason why some pizzamakers are considered true masters: that moment just before a pie becomes a burned mistake often lies in an expert's eye. But even if you don't have DOC-qualified ingredients or a wood-burning oven, all you really need to make a good pie is flour, yeast, a can of tomatoes and cheese. Whatever ingredients you use, hopefully, the final result will be delicious.

Text adapted from an article by
Ondine Cohane. *BBC* [online] (April 17, 2020)

intangible cultural heritage: patrimoni cultural immaterial / patrimonio cultural inmaterial
basil: alfàbrega / albahaca
yeast: llevat / levadura
rolling pin: corró / rodillo

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. Why is Naples's football team mentioned in the text?

2. Find a sentence in the text that means the following: "The new dish rapidly gained popularity, becoming an essential element of Naples' gastronomy."

3. What is a *wannabe* (line 22)?

4. How does the True Neapolitan Pizza Association regulate Neapolitan pizzas? DO NOT COPY DIRECTLY FROM THE TEXT.

5. Finish the following sentence:

For a Neapolitan pizza to be considered DOC, it must have…

6. Explain IN YOUR OWN WORDS what the author means by "that moment just before a pie becomes a burned mistake often lies in an expert's eye" (lines 38-39).

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

GIVE YOURSELF A BREAK: WHY SMALL BUSINESS OWNERS NEED TO REGAIN A SENSE OF BALANCE

If we are honest, most of us could use a little more balance at some points in our busy lives. Getting the right mix between work and leisure time can have benefits for our physical and mental health. It can also improve the performance of a business, research has suggested. The pandemic saw the biggest change in working patterns for decades, perhaps centuries. There was a **surge** in home working and flexible, "hybrid" working, blending work in the office with remote work. But despite this increased flexibility, work-life balance is far from standard. This is especially true among small business owners, who often feel **compelled** to check emails outside traditional work hours or work over the weekend.

Given the fact that small and medium-sized businesses (SMEs) account for 99 % of all UK businesses, that's a lot of people who aren't switching off when perhaps they should. However, there is some encouraging news here. According to a recent survey of UK small business leaders by American Express, there is certainly a widespread understanding of the importance of work-life balance and a desire to improve it. The research is based on responses from 500 business leaders in companies with fewer than 50 employees. Eight in 10 of the executives agree that regular time off from work is important to their wellbeing. However, there is often a gap between intention and action, the research found. Almost half of those surveyed admit to feeling guilty about not spending enough time with family or friends. And one-third say that they stopped their hobbies altogether when they started running their own business. While small business owners recognise the importance of frequent breaks in improving their work-life balance and the success of their business, many of them **struggle** to find room for **downtime**.

Someone who is well aware of this pressure is Michelle Ovens, director of Small Business Saturday UK, a campaign to celebrate small business success and encourage consumers to "shop local" to support businesses in their communities. People often start a business because they want more freedom and flexibility, she says, but that freedom can be reduced by them trying to do everything in the business and running out of time in the day and gas in the tank.

There's no one-size-fits-all approach to a good work-life blend. Some may need to spend more time supporting elderly parents or young children, for example. Others may want more time for hobbies. There are also benefits for the business itself. The American Express survey found that almost eight in 10 respondents agree that regular breaks are important to being a good leader and more than half think they and their business would benefit from them spending more time away from the workplace. Time away, especially travelling abroad or getting a change of scenery, can even offer new and different perspectives that entrepreneurs can bring back to their businesses. Tips for improving your work-life balance? Set firm boundaries between work and leisure time; for yourself, colleagues, **suppliers** and customers. Also, book time off work to recharge your batteries and reduce the risk of "burnout".

Ultimately, however, what constitutes the right work-life balance will vary over time and be different for each small business owner. There isn't a magic formula and therefore we shouldn't be too hard on ourselves if our messy lives fall short of our ideals. Balance in life is a constant work in progress. It might mean work sometimes; sometimes it might mean sport, or family, or community, or rest. The key thing is to give yourself a break—we are all a work in progress here.

Text adapted from an article by
Nick Huber. *The Guardian* [online] (September 19, 2023)

surge: augment / aumento
compelled: obligat / obligado
struggle: lluitar, esforçar-se / luchar, esforzarse
downtime: temps per a desconnectar / tiempo para desconectar
supplier: proveïdor / proveedor

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. Using information from the first paragraph, complete the following sentence IN YOUR OWN WORDS. You can keep the word *business*.

Balancing work and leisure time…

2. Why does the author say there is a gap between intention and action?

3. What seems to be the paradox in setting up one's own business?

4. Find a sentence in the text that means the following: "Everyone has their own way of finding how to balance work and personal life."

5. How can businesses benefit from leaders spending time away from work?

6. Explain the message in the last paragraph of the article IN YOUR OWN WORDS.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

STONE AGE BABIES HAD BETTER PARENTING THAN TODAY!

Modern life may have made many things easier, but scientists say that raising a child is certainly not one of them. A study of modern **hunter-gatherer** groups that has been recently published in the journal *Developmental Psychology* suggested that our Stone Age ancestors gave their children better childcare than we do today. Researchers from Cambridge University found that children among the Mbendjele BaYaka in the Republic of Congo not only received nine hours of care a day from up to 15 different caregivers, but also that crying children were attended to by either the mother or some individual in the mother's support network more than half of the time, this way giving the mums more time to rest. The study's authors say that these findings suggest that modern parenting methods may **be at odds** with children's evolutionary programmed needs.

Dr Nikhil Chaudhary, lead author of the study, says that **insights** into these modern hunter-gatherer societies can give us a lot of detail about how humans lived in the Stone Age, which is the period in human prehistory that covers 95 % of human technological prehistory. "For most of our evolutionary history, humans have lived as hunter-gatherers," said Dr Chaudhary. "Therefore, contemporary hunter-gatherer communities such as the Mbendjele BaYaka can offer valuable clues as to whether there are certain **childbearing systems** to which infants, and their mothers, may be psychologically adapted."

The Mbendjele BaYaka are a nomadic group who live in the jungles in the North of the Central African Republic and the Republic of Congo. They are a traditional hunter-gatherer society that practices hunting, fishing, **foraging**, and honey collection for sustenance. While some Mbendjele communities have become settled and integrated with local economies, many remain mobile and continue to inhabit the forest. Those that are still nomadic live in multifamily camps of between 20 to 80 individuals, consisting of a number of huts in which families live.

Evolutionary anthropologists stayed with the Mbendjele BaYaka between March and July 2014, observing children for 12 daylight hours and recording how often they were cared for and by whom. The researchers found that between 10 and 20 different caregivers would be involved in looking after a child and that a mother's support system would respond to more than half of their baby's crying episodes. Furthermore, children were almost never left alone and spent long periods of time in physical contact with adults or receiving close care from them. When children cried they were attended to in under 10 seconds in half of cases and in under 25 seconds 90 % of the time.

Older infants and adolescents were also often involved in caregiving, which the report's authors suggest gives them experience and helps reduce anxiety around parenting. This seems to point to the fact that children may be evolutionarily prepared to expect high levels of attention and physical contact from several different caregivers. However, in Western countries the provision of high-quality child support is limited, with parenting manuals often expecting babies to spend extended periods of time playing alone.

The study also notes that Stone Age societies may have better prioritized giving mothers a rest. In Western societies, the authors write, it is common for childcare to be used only to give parents time to go to work rather than time for themselves. This means that parents have no time to rest or recover, in total contrast to the parenting practices of both modern hunter-gatherers and our Neolithic ancestors. Co-author and child psychologist Dr Annie Swanepoel says that "support for mothers also has numerous benefits for children such as reducing the risk of neglect and abuse and improving maternal wellbeing, which in turn improves maternal care." And yet, throughout the whole of human history, it seems that parents have never been under such intense pressure and faced such a lack of support as they do in modern times.

Text adapted from an article by
William Hunter. *The Daily Mail* [online] (November 13, 2023)

hunter-gatherer: caçador recol·lector / cazador-recolector
be at odds: estar en desacord / estar en desacuerdo
insight: perspectiva
childbearing system: sistema de criança / sistema de crianza
forage: recol·lectar al bosc / recolectar en el bosque

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Espai per a la correcció

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

1. According to a recently published article in the journal *Developmental Psychology*, the Mbendjele BaYaka's parenting habits
- ☐ are against children's evolutionary needs.
- ☐ involve helping mothers with childcare.
- ☐ do not allow mothers much time to rest.
- ☐ put children's evolutionary needs to test.

2. The behavior of modern hunter-gatherer societies such as the Mbendjele BaYaka
- ☐ can be used to understand better how our ancestors lived in the Stone Age.
- ☐ is not representative of how humans lived during prehistory.
- ☐ is the only possible way in which we can understand how humans lived in the Stone Age.
- ☐ cannot help us understand how humans have lived during 95 % of human prehistory.

3. Which of the following statements is TRUE according to the text?
- ☐ All Mbendjele communities live isolated from the rest of civilization.
- ☐ No Mbendjele families live with other families.
- ☐ Some Mbendjele communities have stopped being nomadic.
- ☐ All Mbendjele families continue to be nomadic.

4. Evolutionary anthropologists that stayed with the Mbendjele BaYaka found that
- ☐ only mothers would take care of babies when they cried.
- ☐ it would take caregivers a long time to react to baby's crying episodes.
- ☐ no one would respond to baby's crying episodes.
- ☐ several caregivers would quickly take care of babies when they cried.

5. In comparison to the Mbendjele BaYaka childcare practices, parenting in Western countries
- ☐ does not involve spending a lot of time with babies.
- ☐ always involves older infants and adolescents in caregiving.
- ☐ increases older infants and adolescents' anxiety around childcare.
- ☐ is based on employing more than ten caregivers for every child.

6. In Western societies, childcare
- ☐ is exclusively used to ensure that parents have free time.
- ☐ is often used to ensure that parents can work.
- ☐ is never used to ensure that mothers can go back to work.
- ☐ is always used to ensure that mothers have time to rest.

7. Providing mothers with support
- ☐ improves maternal care but has no effect on children.
- ☐ has very little effect on the mother's wellbeing.
- ☐ has positive effects both on mothers and children.
- ☐ is beneficial for children but does not improve maternal care.

8. Which of the following statements is FALSE?
- ☐ In the present day, parents have more childcare pressure and less support than ever.
- ☐ Parents have never been less supported and felt more childcare pressure than in modern times.
- ☐ As regards childcare, there is more pressure and less support in modern times than in any other historical period.
- ☐ Parents have had more support and less pressure for childcare in modern times than in any other historical period.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

WHAT YOUR JEANS CAN (AND DO) HIDE

Paris, Milan, New York… These are some of the world's most prestigious fashion **catwalks**. There, young women and men graciously parade to impress elite guests and TV watchers with the surprising, fabulous creativity of the most renowned fashion designers. Yet, regardless of the amazing costs of such shows, there is a hidden price that Mother Nature pays (and which is not included in the price tag).

Let's start with the case of innocent blue jeans: it takes around 7,500 litres of water to make just one single pair. Know what this means? It is equivalent to the amount of water the average person drinks over a period of seven years. That's just one of the many startling facts that emerge from recent environmental research, and which show the real cost of staying fashionable.

When we think of industries that have a harmful effect on the environment, manufacturing, energy, transport and even food production come to mind. But the fashion industry is considered by the UN Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) to be the second most polluting industry in the world. In fact, according to UNCTAD, some 93 billion cubic metres of water—enough to meet the needs of five million people—are used by the fashion industry annually, and around half a million tons of microfibre, which is the equivalent of 3 million barrels of oil, are now being dumped into the ocean every year.

As for carbon emissions, the industry is responsible for more than all international flights and maritime shipping combined. "The dominant business model in the sector is that of 'fast fashion', whereby consumers are offered constantly changing collections at low prices, and encouraged to frequently buy and discard clothes," UNCTAD further explains. And it warns that the trend is responsible for "a plethora of negative social, economic and environmental impacts and, with clothing production doubling between 2000 and 2014, it is crucially important to ensure that clothes are produced as ethically and sustainably as possible."

For its part, UN Environment provides more conservative figures. It says that considering cotton production, manufacture, transport and washing, it takes 3,781 litres of water to make one pair of jeans. Furthermore, the process equates to around 33.4 kilograms of carbon equivalent emitted, like driving 111 kilometres or watching 246 hours of TV on a big screen. Even just washing our clothes releases plastic microfibres and other pollutants into the environment, contaminating our oceans and drinking water, and entering the food chain, UN Environment warns, and adds that around 20 % of global industrial water pollution is from **dyeing** and textile treatment.

Some studies estimate that the average garment is worn ten times before being discarded. Demand for clothing is projected to rise 2 % a year—but the number of times we wear a garment has dropped one third compared to the early 2000s. This waste costs money and the value of natural resources. Of the total fibre input used for clothing, 87 % is incinerated or sent to **landfill**. Overall, one garbage truck of textiles is landfilled or incinerated every second. The issue is so alarming that 10 different UN organisations joined forces through an Alliance for Sustainable Fashion, which seeks to halt the environmentally and socially destructive practices of fashion. Elisa Tonda, from UN Environment, explained this urgency: "The global production of clothing and footwear generates 8 % of the world's greenhouse gas emissions and, with manufacturing concentrated in Asia, the industry is mainly reliant on hard coal and natural gas to generate electricity. If we carry on with a business-as-usual approach, the greenhouse gas emissions from the industry will rise by almost 50 % by 2030."

Fashion today is about obsession with outward image and appearance. Rarely do we as consumers consider what's on the inside: the environmental cost. Now that we know, who will dare to take the bull by the horns?

Text adapted from an article by
Baher Kamal. *Meer* [online] (1 April, 2019)

catwalk: passarella / pasarela
dye: tenyir / teñir
landfill: abocador / vertedero

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. What is NOT included in the price tag in fashion? ☐ The environmental cost of the clothes. ☐ The cost of the fashion show. ☐ The salary of the designers and models. ☐ The creativity of the designer clothes.	☐	☐	☐
2. The fashion industry is considered highly polluting ☐ because of its high consumption of water. ☐ because it spills tons of petrol into the oceans. ☐ and so, five million people cannot have access to clean water. ☐ because of its energy consumption.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to UNCTAD, fast fashion ☐ has changed the way we buy and use clothes. ☐ clothes are being manufactured in a sustainable way. ☐ has no impact on the economy or the environment. ☐ produces more carbon emissions than planes or ships.	☐	☐	☐
4. The meaning of *plethora*, in "a plethora of negative social, economic and environmental impacts," is ☐ a large amount of. ☐ an indefinite quantity. ☐ a small number of. ☐ a group of.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following is NOT true? ☐ Most water pollution all over the world comes from the textile industry. ☐ Water plays an important role in the process of making a pair of jeans. ☐ Making one pair of jeans pollutes as much as driving over 100 km. ☐ Microfibres enter the water we drink every time we wash our clothes.	☐	☐	☐
6. In the early 2000s, ☐ people wore their clothes many more times than they do now. ☐ people disposed of their clothes after wearing them ten times. ☐ sending one lorry full of textiles to the landfill cost a lot of money. ☐ there was a higher production of new clothes.	☐	☐	☐
7. The main aim of the Alliance for Sustainable Fashion is ☐ to end the negative social and environmental effects of the fashion industry. ☐ to prevent Asian countries from using fossil fuels in the fashion industry. ☐ to increase the global production of clothing and footwear. ☐ to continue with the same fashion business model we have now.	☐	☐	☐
8. With the final paragraph, the author suggests that ☐ it is very difficult to solve the environmental problem associated with fashion. ☐ consumers should take direct action to protect the environment. ☐ for some people, their appearance is more important than the environment. ☐ the environmental cost of fashion needs to be known more widely.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW AI CAN MAKE CANCER TREATMENT MORE EQUITABLE

Many are aware of the Cancer Moonshot—an ambitious and hopeful initiative of the US government to reduce cancer-related death rates by 50 % by the year 2047. It will take an army to achieve this goal, composed of the brightest minds and biggest hearts in healthcare, science, and technology. Many parties will be involved—the federal government, healthcare providers, researchers, patients, caregivers, and advocates, among others in both the public and private sectors. One of the most pivotal tools that can help **propel** us toward this high-minded goal is artificial intelligence (AI), which is poised to revolutionize cancer treatment.

The Moonshot plan identifies five priority areas, all of which AI has the potential to **enhance**. Two areas in particular lend themselves to AI: the call to deliver the latest cancer innovations to patients and communities and the aim of enhancing the oncology model to place cancer patients at the center of decision-making.

The history of cancer care has been a continual process of refining treatments through innovative processes and solutions. While these advancements represented significant **strides** toward personalizing cancer care, it has been a slow and historically inequitable process, with minority populations not having as much access to advanced diagnosis or care tools. AI has many distinct advantages over prior technologies. It continuously improves when trained on enormous datasets, making it both more accurate than prior methods and enabling it to distinguish subtleties across demographics, age, race, etc. It is relatively low-cost to **deploy**, runs instantly, and can be made accessible via cloud computing, which is now available in all populated continents. These advantages make AI a scalable solution that can uniquely optimize patients' treatment plans across the globe, delivering efficient and personalized cancer care to a substantially larger population than prior technology.

One of the most promising developments is the rise of AI-enabled tests that can simultaneously prognosticate how tumors will progress and predict treatment benefits. These tests use unique deep-learning algorithms that assess digital images from patient biopsies and couple them with the patient's clinical data. Clinicians can then take this information and build a personalized treatment plan; in some cases, this even means avoiding unnecessary treatments where the side effects outweigh the benefits for the patient.

The Moonshot initiative to deliver innovation to patients and communities is intended for *all* patients, not a select few. The generalizability of AI relies on the amount and variety of data that is used to build it. When AI is trained on datasets that properly represent diverse patient populations, it has the potential to provide greater insights for all, including historically underrepresented populations. In addition to helping bridge the gap in health disparities, AI can also serve as a conduit for increased communication between patients and clinicians by positioning patients at the center of decision-making about their care. How? By providing patients with more information about their illness, and therefore increasing confidence in their treatment plan. This confidence is a cornerstone of effective cancer treatment.

Patients must live with treatment decisions, both physically and mentally. Studies show that one key to treating cancer is for clinicians to create a patient-centered plan that incorporates multifaceted aspects of a person's life. With AI-enabled tests, the patient and clinician can review the data together to align on whether the therapy selected is worth the adverse effects that could influence the patient's lifestyle. In contrast, a lack of understanding of the options and benefits of the therapy can leave patients overwhelmed and under-committed to the treatment. This can decrease adherence to treatments and have detrimental effects on survival rates.

Text adapted from an article by
Andre Esteva. *Time* [online] (October 18, 2023)

propel: impulsar
enhance: millorar / mejorar
stride: avenç / progreso
deploy: utilitzar / utilizar

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Espai per a la correcció

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

1. The Cancer Moonshot
- ☐ is a project that will definitely reduce cancer-related death rates by 50 %.
- ☐ is a project that will involve the army and the brightest minds.
- ☐ is a US government-led project to reduce cancer death rates.
- ☐ is a project that will only involve brilliant scientists.

2. According to the text, artificial intelligence (AI)
- ☐ will help the private cancer treatments.
- ☐ will help reach a modest objective.
- ☐ can help researchers find a cure.
- ☐ can help improve cancer treatments.

3. The two areas of the Cancer Moonshot plan that the article focuses on are:
- ☐ reaching all kinds of patients and empowering them to make decisions.
- ☐ prioritizing specific communities and placing cancer patients first.
- ☐ enhancing cancer treatments and using artificial intelligence to a lesser extent.
- ☐ implementing innovative treatments and prioritizing elderly patients.

4. Although cancer care has witnessed important scientific advancements,
- ☐ treatments have been personalized among minority populations.
- ☐ not everyone has had access to proper diagnosis to the same extent.
- ☐ they have considerably slowed down certain types of treatments.
- ☐ all patients have had the chance to receive personalized treatments.

5. Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the text?
- ☐ AI is fast and available through cloud computing.
- ☐ AI can explore large sets of data to find patterns.
- ☐ AI can offer personalized plans to more patients.
- ☐ AI cannot be trained with large patient datasets.

6. According to the text, why are AI-enabled tests a promising development?
- ☐ Because they can prevent cancer treatment side effects.
- ☐ Because they can predict patients' clinical data.
- ☐ Because they can diagnose tumors more effectively.
- ☐ Because they can predict how tumors might develop.

7. How does Cancer Moonshot increase patients' confidence in their treatment plan?
- ☐ By ensuring patients receive more information.
- ☐ By providing patients with innovative treatments.
- ☐ By analyzing data from underrepresented populations.
- ☐ By controlling patients' access to AI-generated tools.

8. According to the text, patient-centered plans
- ☐ overwhelm the majority of patients.
- ☐ make patients commit to treatment.
- ☐ make certain treatments less effective.
- ☐ allow clinicians to influence patients' life.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

DANCE LIKE YOU'RE IN *BRIDGERTON*, PLAY *SQUID GAME*: WHY ARE IMMERSIVE EXPERIENCES BOOMING?

Welcome to the age of immersion. Last summer saw the launch of *Stranger Things* and *Tomb Raider* "experiences" in London, and an *Alice in Wonderland* "immersive cocktail experience" in Sheffield. By September, fans were able to re-enact Netflix's *Squid Game* at Immersive Gamebox venues in London, Essex and Manchester. In the coming weeks, London will also host an experience based on the horror franchise *Saw*, while Cheshire will see thousands visit *Harry Potter: A Forbidden Forest Experience*. And that's without mentioning the boom in immersive art experiences, the most recent of which — *Frameless* — has just opened in central London.

The **buzzword** everyone will tell you is *immersive-interactive*. As a small number of companies dominate the cultural landscape, it seems that each wants to build its own mini-Disneyland. But why are we suddenly obsessed with stepping into the screen? In an increasingly dark world, are we seeking escapism? Or do we just want loads of cool Instagrammable pictures?

"It's really driven by a desire to find new ways to connect with our members and fans around the world," says Greg Lombardo, head of live experiences at Netflix. The streaming service lost almost a million subscribers between April and July last year after subscription fees increased by £1 a month. The company is seemingly diversifying its income — tickets to *Stranger Things: The Experience* cost £52 per person, £62 on a Saturday. "We really wanted to offer people a chance to feel like they were the hero of that story, that they had the powers," Lombardo says. Guests are divided into different coloured teams and allocated a hand gesture they can use to remotely crush cans, unlock doors and battle monsters as they wander *Stranger Things*-inspired sets. The experience features exclusive **footage** from the show's actors as well as live actors who interact with the audience. Why do more and more people seek this out? Lombardo says the *Stranger Things* experience attracts all ages, while guests of *The Queen's Ball* — a party based on Netflix's hit show *Bridgerton* — are 87 % women aged 18-45. It is a prom for adults and some people even join fan-created social media groups to discuss how to prepare for the event.

Elizabeth Cohen is a communications professor at West Virginia University who studies audience responses to different types of media. She says fans have always wanted to enter fictional worlds but the internet allowed them to get their voices heard. "I think the internet made 'geeking out' more mainstream," she says. "And what is mainstream is also more profitable." Cohen says immersion is psychologically gratifying because people connect with others, relieve stress and get creative. Just as we can both watch and play sports, Cohen says we can now watch and play with shows. Does this mean we're big babies? "Sports fans often go to great lengths to dress up in support of their team, put on face paint, collect memorabilia," Cohen says. "But I've never heard anyone suggest that sports fandom was infantilising, so why is there a double standard for pop culture?"

Millions have been invested into immersion, but some experiences are rougher around the edges than others. Many last an hour — meaning prices seem high when you consider a whole day ticket to Disneyland Paris can cost just £50. It remains to be seen whether they will attract repeat customers, or if they'll quickly become associated with the forced fun of work socials and first dates. Or perhaps high inflation will only increase the desire to step into the screen. If you think about shows like *Stranger Things* or *Bridgerton*, they are escapist stories. They allow us to forget, for a moment, things that might be more challenging in our lives.

Text adapted from an article by Amelia Tait.
The Guardian [online] (October 14, 2022)

buzzword: paraula de moda / palabra de moda
footage: escenes filmades / escenas filmadas

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. In this text, the word *immersion* (and *immersive*) refers to ☐ social gatherings where people can meet famous pop culture Instagrammers. ☐ leisure experiences where people can interact with series or movies scenes. ☐ social experiences where people can meet and talk to Disney characters. ☐ leisure experiences where people can go on spectacular roller-coasters.	☐	☐	☐
2. In the second paragraph, the author of the text ☐ wonders why Disneyland is opening new franchises for adolescents. ☐ wonders why adolescents are obsessed with movies and series. ☐ wonders if immersion experiences make young adults become childish. ☐ wonders why immersion experiences are popular now.	☐	☐	☐
3. Netflix ☐ has incorporated new ways of making profits. ☐ is making profits only through subscriptions. ☐ is offering its subscribers monthly discounts. ☐ is contacting *Stranger Things* fans around the world.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following is NOT true about the *Stranger Things* experience? ☐ Entrance fees are cheaper on weekdays. ☐ Guests can walk around sets inspired by the series. ☐ Only the show's actors take part in it. ☐ Guests can pretend to fight against monsters.	☐	☐	☐
5. *The Queen's Ball* ☐ attracts female *Bridgerton* fans of several ages. ☐ has boosted the number of *Bridgerton* viewers. ☐ is especially popular with men over 50. ☐ requires attendees to meet on a social media group first.	☐	☐	☐
6. Elizabeth Cohen thinks that ☐ immersive experiences can become stressful for guests. ☐ the fans' contact with the fictional world has become normal. ☐ fictional immersive experiences should be based on sports. ☐ the fans' participation in immersive experiences should be streamed.	☐	☐	☐
7. Why does there seem to be a double standard for pop culture? ☐ Because immersion tends to be criticised more often than sports fandom. ☐ Because immersion experiences are never considered childish. ☐ Because people tend to make fun of sports fans who dress up. ☐ Because pop culture fandom helps people connect with their heroes.	☐	☐	☐
8. Immersion experiences ☐ will become symbolic of first dates and work gatherings. ☐ have come to stay. ☐ are becoming more expensive due to increasing inflation. ☐ give people the chance to escape from real difficulties.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW GLOBAL CLIMATE TARGETS ARE SET AND WHAT THEY MEAN

How much warming can the world bear? This question was one of the main issues discussed at the past UN climate change **summit**, known as COP26, in Glasgow, Scotland.

Six years ago, when countries came together in Paris for the COP21 summit, at which the Paris climate accord was shaped, they committed to limit the global average temperature rise to below 2 degrees Celsius (2C) above pre-industrial levels. However, even though the 2015 agreement set 2C as the minimum, it also suggested that countries should push for a more ambitious goal: 1.5C. But not all countries agreed, with oil and gas producing Saudi Arabia among the countries complaining about the more ambitious targets. Some officials argued that countries should maintain the less ambitious target so that they were not set up for failure.

A preliminary draft of the COP26 agreement reaffirmed the Paris agreement's goal: limit Earth's warming to well below 2C and **pursue** a target of 1.5C. But it did not commit to meeting the 1.5C mark. The difference between the two targets may seem small, but they represent different levels of effort for countries trying to limit their carbon footprints, and very divergent **outcomes** for the planet. A study released by the UK Met Office, Britain's national weather service, found that 1 billion people could face heat stress, a potentially fatal combination of heat and humidity, if temperatures rise by 2C.

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), a UN body responsible for evaluating the scientific research on climate change, has warned that even an increase of 1.5C of global warming would result in significant differences, with increased heat waves and short cold seasons. The IPCC has found that an extreme heat event that would have occurred once per decade without human influence, would happen 4 times a decade with 1.5C of warming, and with 2C of warming there would be 5 extreme heat events.

The IPCC has also noted that the relative sea level will probably continue to rise throughout the 21st century and beyond. If temperatures do not increase more than 1.5C, over the next 2000 years sea levels could rise by as much as 3 meters, but it could be double that if temperatures grow by 2C, and be even worse if ice sheets in Antarctica become destabilized. Although a 2C increase would result in the number of people living in areas affected by extreme heat stress rising from 68 million today to 1 billion, a 4C rise could affect half of Earth's population.

In their latest report, the IPCC estimated that the world would probably reach the 1.5C mark by 2040. Global temperatures would initially be 1.5C higher by the middle of the century, and then fall as emissions were cut further. This could avoid some of the worst outcomes. If nothing is done, the world might see a rise of 4.4C by the year 2100—with an extreme impact on life on Earth.

Text adapted from an article on *The Washington Post* (November 10, 2021)

summit: cimera / cumbre
pursue: perseguir
outcome: resultat / resultado

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. At the COP21 summit, countries ☐ agreed to limit Paris global climate change. ☐ agreed to limit the increase in global temperatures to 2C. ☐ agreed to discuss oil and gas production. ☐ agreed to return to pre-industrial temperature levels.	☐	☐	☐
2. The most ambitious target at the Paris climate summit ☐ was agreed to by all countries in the world. ☐ was signed by Saudi Arabia. ☐ was considered too difficult to reach by a number of countries. ☐ would still result in the death of 1 billion people.	☐	☐	☐
3. The 1.5C mark ☐ was a firm commitment at the COP26 summit in Glasgow. ☐ represents a major difference with respect to the 2C target. ☐ guarantees the maximum reduction in a country's carbon footprint. ☐ will have no effect on a country's carbon footprint.	☐	☐	☐
4. What prediction has the IPCC made? ☐ There will be 5 extreme heat events in the next decade if no action is taken. ☐ Heat waves will become more frequent in the future. ☐ Extreme heat events will become increasingly rare if the 1.5C mark is met. ☐ Extreme heat events will happen once a year even if there is no rise in temperature.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following is TRUE? ☐ The relative sea level will probably keep on falling in this century. ☐ Sea levels could decrease by more than 3 meters over the next 2000 years. ☐ If ice sheets in Antarctica become destabilized, sea levels will rise. ☐ If temperatures rise by 2C, 2 billion people will die.	☐	☐	☐
6. The number of people living in areas of extreme heat stress ☐ might rise to a million if the temperature increases 2C. ☐ might rise to a hundred million if the temperature increases 4C. ☐ doesn't reach a hundred million today. ☐ will represent most of the world's population with a 4C rise.	☐	☐	☐
7. What are the IPCC estimates for the remainder of the 21st century? ☐ Global warming would not be recorded until 2040. ☐ Temperatures might start declining after 2050 if action is taken. ☐ Temperatures might keep on increasing after 2050 even if emissions are cut. ☐ Global warming might be stopped before the middle of the century.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does the IPCC predict will happen if no climate action is taken now? ☐ Life on Earth will remain unaffected. ☐ Temperatures might rise by more than 4C by the end of the century. ☐ Global warming effects will not be as serious as expected. ☐ There will be a 4.4C temperature rise by 2040.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

SOCCER IS THE WORLD'S MOST POPULAR SPORT. BUT WHO INVENTED IT?

Soccer is by far the world's most popular sport, and for good reason—beloved by at least 265 million people worldwide, it's easy to play in a random yard or field, and viewers instantly relate to the players racing across stadiums in different parts of the world. But if you're looking for the earliest ancestor of all that running, kicking, and cooperating, be ready to turn back your watch. Here's what you need to know about soccer's ancient origins and why it's the world's favorite sport today.

The Chinese were the first to kick balls into nets for sport in the third century B.C., and the game known globally as football was formalized in England in the 19th century. But the predecessor of most modern ball games can be found in the Americas. "The idea of the team sport was invented in Mesoamerica," says Mary Miller, a professor of the history of art at Yale University who has studied extensive evidence of the sport. In Mesoamerica, the vast historical region spanning from Mexico to Costa Rica, civilizations flourished well before Columbus "discovered" them, and many of them played a sport that involved a heavy ball made from a substance derived from tree resin.

It is unclear exactly where the game was invented, but it was popular across Mesoamerican cultures like the Teotihuacanos, Aztecs, and Maya beginning about 3,000 years ago. Its name varied—*ullamaliztli* in Aztec, *pok-ta-pok* or *pitz* in Maya. So did its rules, which included moves such as keeping the ball in play by bumping it with body parts or using racquets or bats.

Many of these games were played with rubber balls, which still exist in the archaeological record. Other evidence of game play ranges from ceramic vessels to more than 1,300 large stone courts that can be found across the region.

Aztec players bounced the ball back and forth between teams using only their hips and buttocks (feet or hands were off limits). They tried to hit the back wall of their opponents' courts with just one bounce, often sustaining life-threatening injuries when they were hit with the hard, heavy ball. If a player managed to get it into a high ring on the opposing team's side, it was an automatic win—and a major honor for the winner.

Though it was played as an everyday **pickup** sport, much like soccer or basketball, this ball game also held a **sacred** place in religion and warfare for Mesoamerican cultures. Aztec kings reportedly played it as a substitute for war, gaining ruling rights or diffusing diplomatic dramas with a game of ball. In Maya and Veracruz cultures, the stakes were even higher: the losers of some ritual games were sacrificed.

Though other cultures like Native Americans and Indigenous Australians played similar games, the modern sport that some people know as soccer—and many others know as football—was created in British schools. Although they had played variations of the game informally for centuries, the sport became formalized in the 19th century.

In the mid 19th century, developments in transportation, labor, and technology gave people the leisure and means to travel to competitive matches on mown lawn fields. By the 1840s, a variety of British schools created their own standards of play, making it possible to hold tournaments among players who all knew the same rules.

As the sport's popularity **ballooned**, players banded together in the London Football Association. By the 1870s, some teams had begun to recruit widely, secretly paying working-class league members. Upper-class footballers wanted the sport to remain amateur, but in 1885, they finally agreed to allow professional players, enabling a further boom in the sport. By 1904, the sport was so popular it had gone international, and the Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) began that same year.

Soccer's success skyrocketed from there. After the sport debuted in the 1908 Olympic Games and the first FIFA World Cup in 1930, professional soccer flourished. Today, FIFA remains the sport's governing body, **raking** in $755.5 million in 2021 alone.

But the heart of the sport has always been on the field, where everyone from small children to **seasoned** pro athletes can enjoy the action. Soccer's spirit is alive and well both in modern incarnations of the ball game and the millions of amateur and pro players who run and kick their way down an official or **makeshift** soccer pitch every day.

Text adapted from an article by Erin Blakemore.
The National Geographic [online] (November 17, 2022)

pickup: espontani / espontáneo
sacred: sagrat / sagrado
to balloon: incrementar
raking: recollint / recogiendo
seasoned: experimentats / experimentados
makeshift: improvisat / improvisado

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ Football as we know it was not formalized until the 19th century. ☐ Mesoamerican civilizations owe ball games to Columbus. ☐ In the third century B.C. the Chinese already played ball games. ☐ Modern ball games have their origin in Mesoamerica.	☐	☐	☐
2. The rules of a sport that involved a heavy rubber ball ☐ varied across Mesoamerican cultures. ☐ only included the use of body parts. ☐ excluded the use of racquets entirely. ☐ were formalized by Columbus and his men.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ Aztec players threw the ball back and forth. ☐ Aztec players could hit the hard, heavy ball with all their body parts. ☐ Aztec players used hard, heavy balls that could even kill them. ☐ Aztec players had to get the ball into the opposing team's ring several times to win.	☐	☐	☐
4. The ball game was sacred to Mesoamerican cultures and ☐ all their players were sacrificed at the end of the game. ☐ often created diplomatic conflict among Aztec kings. ☐ was used by Aztec kings for good luck before going to war. ☐ sometimes replaced battles and helped resolve conflicts.	☐	☐	☐
5. 19th century British schools ☐ are responsible for modern football or soccer. ☐ never agreed to a common set of rules to play football. ☐ only played football informally and uncompetitively. ☐ are responsible for technological developments in football.	☐	☐	☐
6. By 1870 ☐ all football players were professional. ☐ some working-class football players were paid. ☐ upper-class football players became professional. ☐ no football players were amateurs.	☐	☐	☐
7. The popularity of football as a sport ☐ had nothing to do with the professionalization of its players. ☐ can be attributed to the creation of the FIFA. ☐ resulted in its internationalization. ☐ was the consequence of only allowing amateur players.	☐	☐	☐
8. Although professional football has flourished since the early 20th century, ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that amateurs and pro athletes can play it together. ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that it raises a lot of money worldwide. ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that it is played only by pro athletes. ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that it can be played by anyone.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

Part 2: Reading comprehension

ASSATEAGUE'S WILD HORSES

Assateague Island is a 60 km long barrier island located on the East Coast of the United States, facing the Atlantic Ocean. The northern two-thirds of the island is in Maryland while the southern third is in Virginia. The Maryland section contains the majority of Assateague Island National Seashore; the Virginia section contains Chincoteague National Wildlife Refuge. The island contains numerous marshes, bays and pristine beaches, and is a habitat for migratory birds and a wildlife sanctuary.

Assateague, however, is best known for its **herds** of wild horses. The "wild" horses on Assateague are actually feral animals, meaning that they are descendants of domestic animals that have reverted to a wild state. Horses tough enough to survive the scorching heat, abundant mosquitoes, stormy weather and poor quality food found on this remote, windswept barrier island, which have formed a unique wild horse society.

Local folklore describes the Assateague horses as survivors of a shipwreck off the Virginia coast. While this dramatic tale of struggle and survival is popular, there are no records yet that confirm it. The most plausible explanation is that they are the descendants of horses that were brought to barrier islands like Assateague in the late 17th century by mainland owners to avoid fencing laws and taxation of livestock.

The horses are split into two main herds, one on the Virginia side and one on the Maryland side of Assateague. They are separated by a fence at the Virginia/Maryland State line. These herds have divided themselves into bands of two to twelve animals and each band occupies a home range. The National Park Service manages the Maryland herd. The Chincoteague Volunteer Fire Company owns and manages the Virginia herd, which is allowed to graze on Chincoteague National Wildlife Refuge through a special use permit issued by the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. The permit restricts the size of the herd to approximately 150 adult animals in order to protect the other natural resources of the wildlife refuge. It is the Virginia herd which is often referred to as the "Chincoteague" ponies.

Many visitors first learn about the Assateague horses from Marguerite Henry's famous book *Misty of Chincoteague*. The story takes place during a traditional Chincoteague festival called "Pony Penning." On the last Wednesday of July, the Virginia herd of horses is rounded up and made to swim from Assateague Island to nearby Chincoteague Island. On the following day most of the young **foals** are auctioned off. Proceeds from the sale benefit the Chincoteague Volunteer Fire Department.

Assateague's horses are beautiful, tough, and wild. They have learned to survive in a harsh environment. Feeding and/or petting them is detrimental to both visitors and horses. Horses can get sick from human food. Those that learn to come up to the road to beg for food are often hit and killed by cars. Visitors are kicked, bitten and knocked down every year as a direct result of getting too close to the wild horses. Treating wild horses like tame animals takes away the wildness that makes them special. The park rangers warn visitors that they must protect their family by respecting the horses: people must give the horses the space they need to be wild.

There are few places in the United States where you can view wild horses. Due to their complex social structure the Assateague horses display a wide range of unique behaviors. Visitors can take advantage of the opportunity to view these horses in a natural habitat. With careful management, the wild horses will continue to thrive on Assateague Island and provide enjoyment to thousands of nature enthusiasts, photographers, and people who just love horses!

Text adapted from an article on *NPS.gov* and *Wikipedia*

herd: ramat / manada
foal: cavall de menys d'un any / caballo de menos de un año

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The horses we see in Assateague Island are described as "feral". This means that they ☐ descend from domestic animals that have become wild over the years. ☐ are domestic animals whose owners have freed them in the island. ☐ were wild horses that now have been domesticated. ☐ have always lived free on this island.	☐	☐	☐
2. These horses are unique because they ☐ are extremely small. ☐ are native to the Americas. ☐ have adapted to very tough living conditions. ☐ must live in very frigid temperatures.	☐	☐	☐
3. How did the horses arrive on the island? ☐ They have always lived there. ☐ They migrated naturally from the mainland. ☐ They were travelling on a ship that sank off the coast. ☐ They were most probably taken there to avoid paying tax.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ The National Park Service is in charge of all the horses on the island. ☐ There is a herd of horses in each state. ☐ There's a variable number of horses in each band. ☐ A fence along the state line keeps the herds apart.	☐	☐	☐
5. The U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service ☐ owns the Chincoteague Volunteer Fire Company. ☐ issues a permit allowing the horses to feed on its grounds. ☐ is in charge of the Virginia herd of ponies. ☐ won't allow ponies to feed in order to protect the wildlife refuge.	☐	☐	☐
6. The Pony Penning festival ☐ is organized by the National Park Service. ☐ is a local festival in which horses swim to a nearby island to be sold. ☐ was created after Margaret Henry described it in her book. ☐ takes place in many other places around the US on the same day in July.	☐	☐	☐
7. The Assateague horses ☐ usually hit or bite other wild animals that get too near them. ☐ have become accustomed to eating human food. ☐ have adapted to their environment and developed a complex social structure. ☐ are quite tame and never bite humans.	☐	☐	☐
8. Visitors to Assateague Island ☐ know that this is the only place in the USA where they can see horses in the wild. ☐ must treat the horses as wild animals and respect their habitat. ☐ can feed the wild horses with a special permit. ☐ almost never see horses because they are extremely rare.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

Part 2: Reading comprehension

GINKGO TREES NEARLY WENT EXTINCT. HERE'S HOW WE SAVED THESE 'LIVING FOSSILS'

On the streets of Manhattan and Washington, D.C., in neighborhoods in Seoul and parks in Paris, ginkgo trees are gradually losing their bright yellow leaves in reaction to the first frigid winter air. Such leaf drop, gradual at first, and then suddenly, carpets streets with golden, **fan-shaped** leaves every year. But around the world, scientists are documenting evidence of the event happening later and later, a possible indication of climate change.

"People would ask us, 'When should I come out to see peak ginkgo color?' and we would say the 21st of October," says David Carr, the director of the University of Virginia's Blandy Experimental Farm, which is home to The Ginkgo Grove, an arboretum with over 300 ginkgo trees.

Carr, who's been at The Ginkgo Grove since 1997, says the trend toward warmer falls and later-in-the-season leaf color is a noticeable one. "Nowadays it seems to be closer to the end of October or the first week of November." But this is not the first time the ancient species has confronted major climate changes. And the story of ginkgos is not the familiar one of human carelessness with nature.

Thanks to fossils found in North Dakota, scientists know the species *Ginkgo biloba* has existed in its current form for 60 million years; it has genetically similar **ancestors** dating back 170 million years to the Jurassic Period. In its nearly 200-million-year timeline, "they gradually were reduced. They almost went extinct. Then they have this renewal that comes from the association with humans," says Peter Crane, author of the book *Ginkgo* and one of the world's foremost Ginkgo experts.

The International Union for the Conservation of Nature, an organization that tracks the survival of Earth's species, classifies the tree as endangered in the wild. Only a few rare populations are thought to potentially exist in China. When you walk on those bright golden fans **scattered** on some rain-darkened sidewalk this fall, you're having a close encounter with a rare thing—a species that humans rescued from natural **oblivion** and spread around the world. It's "such a great evolutionary story," Crane says, "and also a great cultural story."

On Earth today there are five different types of plants that produce **seeds**: flowering plants, the most abundant; conifers, plants with cones; gnetales, a diverse group of about 70 species including desert **shrubs**, tropical trees, and vines; cycads, another ancient group of palm-like trees—and the lonely ginkgo. In the plant kingdom's *Ginkgoaceae* family, there is just one living species, *Ginkgo biloba*.

Scientists think the world once contained many different species of ginkgo too. Fossilized plants found in a coal mine in central China that date back 170 million years show ginkgo-like trees with only slight variations in the shape of their leaves and number of seeds. The species was thought to be extinct in the wild until the early 20th century, when a supposedly undomesticated population was found in western China. A paper published in 2004 disagreed, suggesting instead that those trees had been cultivated by ancient Buddhist monks—but suggesting that other ginkgo **havens** might be found in the southwest of the country. Then in 2012, a new paper cited evidence that a wild population did indeed exist in southwestern China's Dalou Mountains. Those wild populations are a potential treasure of diversity for **crossbreeding** as scientists seek to improve the genetic composition of the domesticated species.

Crane is not worried about the future of the ginkgo, though. The popularity of the species will help it survive. "Though its status in the wild may be precarious and difficult to access, it is a plant that is unlikely to ever go extinct," Crane says.

Text adapted from an article by Sarah Gibbens.
The National Geographic [online] (November 30, 2020)

fan-shaped: en forma de ventall / en forma de abanico
ancestors: avantpassats / antepasados
scattered: escampats / esparcidos
oblivion: oblit / olvido
seeds: llavors / semillas
shrubs: arbustos
havens: refugis / refugios
crossbreeding: encreuament genètic / cruce genético

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to scientists, ☐ ginkgo trees losing their leaves later is possibly causing climate change. ☐ ginkgo trees no longer lose their leaves in the winter due to climate change. ☐ ginkgo trees losing their leaves later in the year is possibly due to climate change. ☐ ginkgo trees have gone from losing their leaves gradually to suddenly as a consequence of climate change.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which one of the sentences is FALSE? ☐ Ginkgos almost went extinct because of human carelessness with nature. ☐ Ginkgos have confronted major climatic changes before. ☐ Ginkgos have existed as a species for millions of years. ☐ Ginkgos have overcome extinction thanks to association with humans.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the International Union for the Conservation of Nature, ☐ ginkgos are found in vast numbers in the wild. ☐ practically no ginkgos exist in the wild. ☐ ginkgos no longer grow in the wild. ☐ ginkgos are a species that can only be found in the wild.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which one of the sentences is TRUE? ☐ Ginkgos are flowering plants. ☐ Ginkgos are palm-like trees. ☐ Ginkgos have several different species. ☐ Ginkgos produce seeds.	☐	☐	☐
5. Fossilized plants confirm that ☐ ginkgos have actually changed very little through time. ☐ currently extinct species of ginkgos did not produce seeds. ☐ millions of years ago ginkgos had the exact same number of seeds and shape of leaves as today. ☐ different species of ginkgos were once common on all continents.	☐	☐	☐
6. The undomesticated population of ginkgos found in western China ☐ showed that this species of trees only grows in the wild. ☐ was later destroyed by a forest fire. ☐ went extinct in the early 20th century. ☐ might have been cultivated by monks.	☐	☐	☐
7. Today domesticated ginkgo trees ☐ are common around the world. ☐ are only found in western China. ☐ belong to one of five related species. ☐ lose their leaves in mid-summer.	☐	☐	☐
8. Crane is not worried about the future of the ginkgo because ☐ it is difficult to find in the wild. ☐ it is a symbol of prosperity in China. ☐ it is a popular species of tree. ☐ its status in the wild is uncertain.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

Part 2: Reading comprehension

SHE WAS SOLD TO A STRANGER SO HER FAMILY COULD EAT AS AFGANISTAN CRUMBLES

Parwana Malik, a 9-year-old girl with dark eyes and rosy cheeks, **giggles** with her friends as they play jump rope in a dusty clearing. But Parwana's laughter disappears as she returns home, where she's reminded of her **fate**: she's being sold to a stranger as a child bride.

The man who wants to buy Parwana says he's 55, but to her, he's "an old man" with white eyebrows and a thick white beard. She worries he will beat her and force her to work in his house. But her parents say they have no choice. For four years, her family has lived in an Afghan displacement camp in the northwestern Badghis province, surviving on humanitarian aid and **menial work** earning a few dollars a day. But life has only gotten harder since the Taliban took power in Afghanistan.

As international aid **dries up** and the country's economy collapses, they're unable to afford basic necessities like food. Her father already sold her 12-year-old sister to someone else several months ago. Parwana is one of many young Afghan girls sold into marriage as the country's humanitarian crisis deepens. Hunger has pushed some families to make heartbreaking decisions, especially as the brutal winter approaches. "Day by day, the numbers are increasing of families selling their children," said Mohammad Naiem Nazem, a human rights activist in Badghis. "Lack of food, lack of work, and the families feel they have to do this."

Abdul Malik, Parwana's father, can't sleep at night. Ahead of the sale, he's "broken" with guilt, shame and worry. He had tried to avoid selling her and his wife **resorted** to begging other camp residents for food. But he felt he had no choice if he wants to feed his family. "We are eight family members". "I have to sell to keep other family members alive." The money from Parwana's sale will only sustain the family for a few months, before Malik has to find another solution, he said.

Parwana said she hoped to change her parents' minds—she had dreams of becoming a teacher, and didn't want to give up her education. But her **pleas** were futile.

On October 24, Qorban, the buyer, who only has one name, arrived at her home and handed 200,000 Afghanis (about $2,200) in the form of sheep, land and cash to Parwana's father. Qorban didn't describe the sale as a marriage, saying he already had a wife who would look after Parwana as if she were one of their own children. "(Parwana) was cheap, and her father was very poor and he needs money," Qorban said. "She will be working in my home. I won't beat her. I will treat her like a family member. I will be kind."

Since the Taliban's takeover, stories like Parwana's have been on the rise. Though marrying off children under 15 is illegal nationwide, it has been commonly practiced for years, especially in more rural parts of Afghanistan. And it has only spread since August, driven by widespread hunger and desperation. The problem is particularly acute for Afghan girls, who have stayed home and watched their brothers return to secondary school since the Taliban takeover. The Taliban said it is working on a plan to allow girls to return too, but have not said when that could happen or what conditions may be imposed. The uncertainty combined with rising poverty has pushed many girls into the marriage market. And once a girl is sold as a bride, her chances of continuing an education or pursuing an independent path are close to zero.

Text adapted from an article on *edition.cnn.com* (November 2, 2021)

giggles: riu efusivament / ríe efusivamente
fate: destí / destino
menial work: feina avorrida / trabajo aburrido
dries up: acaba
resorted: va recórrer com a última opció / recurrió como última opción
plea: petició urgent i emotiva / petición urgente y emotiva

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following best describes Parwana? ☐ Parwana was thrilled to return home and to marry the man of her dreams. ☐ Parwana giggled when she knew that she was getting married. ☐ Parwana was delighted to accept her fate. ☐ Parwana didn't want to accept her parent's decision.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, ☐ she had a sister who had already been sold to the same man. ☐ her parents were forced to sell her due to hunger. ☐ not many young Afghan girls have been sold into marriage. ☐ some other girls were sold to Mohammad Naiem Nazem.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ International aid has gradually diminished. ☐ Hunger has forced many families to take very hard decisions. ☐ The country's economy is booming. ☐ The situation of Afghan people worsened when the Taliban came to power.	☐	☐	☐
4. The word *futile* is used in the text in paragraph 5. A synonym for *futile* is ☐ *useless*. ☐ *heartbreaking*. ☐ *meaningful*. ☐ *productive*.	☐	☐	☐
5. Parwana's sale ☐ will probably be prevented by international aid agencies. ☐ will be a decision that Parwana's father will have to face for the rest of his children's sake. ☐ will sustain the family for a long time. ☐ is one of several possible options that the family has to survive.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, what does Qorban say about the sale? ☐ He will send Parwana to school to become a teacher. ☐ He paid more than what was first agreed because of the vulnerable situation of the family. ☐ He would treat her as another family member. ☐ He wants to marry her because he needed a wife for his children.	☐	☐	☐
7. When girls under 15 are married off ☐ they increase their possibilities to have an education. ☐ they have accepted and chosen their partner freely. ☐ their future prospects for a better life improve. ☐ their fundamental freedoms are being infringed.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following sentences best summarizes the content of the article? ☐ The sale and marriage of young girls is a desperate measure to overcome extreme poverty. ☐ Marriages of convenience are frequent in rural areas in Asia. ☐ Afghan girls look forward to marriage at age 15. ☐ Arranged marriages are a beloved tradition among Afghan families.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

THE WOMAN WHO SAVED MILLIONS OF LIVES WITHOUT KNOWING

One young black woman made one of the greatest contributions of all time to modern medicine, even though she never knew the important role she has played.

Henrietta Lacks was diagnosed with cervical cancer in 1951 at the age of 31, shortly after giving birth to her fifth child. At the time, segregation was widespread in the US, so she turned to Johns Hopkins Hospital in Baltimore, Maryland, as it was one of the few which provided medical care to black people.

The **ward** where she ended up was down the hall from George Gey, a researcher who had been trying to grow human cells in his lab for decades. During the treatment to remove her tumour, her doctor sent a small sample of **tissue** without her knowing to Gey. Up to this point, attempts to grow human cells outside the body had failed. But something about Lacks's cells was about to change that.

In most people a natural process called *senescence* puts a limit on the lifespan of cells. Senescence is linked to aging: as cells divide and multiply over time, the accuracy of each accompanying replication of DNA decreases. The protective caps on the end of each **strand** of DNA, which are called *telomeres*, shorten. Eventually the DNA strands become unprotected and mutations associated with cancers and other age-related diseases arise.

Typically human cells are able to divide around 50 times before they reach senescence. But Lacks's cells were different. In the laboratory, her cells were able to divide and replicate indefinitely. They were, in essence, immortal. It made them perfect for medical research as a **culture** of identical cells could be grown quickly. Gey shared them widely with other scientists, and they became a workhorse of biological research.

Her cell line, which came to be known as "HeLa" in honour of Lacks, is the first and most commonly used immortalised cell line in medicine. Today, work done with HeLa cells **underpins** much of modern medicine. Millions of people owe their lives to the tissue taken from her—the cell line it generated was used to create the first polio vaccine, cancer medicines and *in vitro* fertilisation. Her cells even made it into space before any living human. One of the most recent applications has been in research for vaccines against COVID-19.

But the story of Henrietta Lacks also illustrates the racial inequities that are embedded in American medical research and health-care systems. Lacks was a black woman. Doctors and scientists revealed Lacks's name publicly, gave her medical records to the media and even published her cells' genome online, repeatedly failing to ask her family for consent. None of the biotechnology or other companies that profited from her cells passed any money back to her family, either.

Now, the extraordinary events of 2020—the #BlackLivesMatter movement for racial justice, and the unequal **death toll** of COVID-19 on communities of colour—are forcing scientists to reconsider past injustices. Some have called for a reduction, or even an end, in the use of HeLa cells in research. The argument is that, because the cells were obtained without Lacks's knowledge or consent (even though this was legal at the time), any use of them is unethical and perpetuates an injustice.

But that is not what many Lacks family members want. Henrietta Lacks has dozens of descendants, several of whom are calling for people to celebrate her life and legacy in her centennial year, #HELA100. To her grandson Alfred Lacks Carter, the most important thing about HeLa cells is how they have advanced cancer research—an adequate tribute, given that Lacks died of the disease at the young age of 31. "The cells were taken in a bad way but they are doing good for the world," he says. And they do so for people of all ethnicities.

Text adapted from an article on
BBC.com (November 20, 2020)

ward: sala d'hospital / sala de hospital
tissue: teixit / tejido
strand: cadena
culture: cultiu / cultivo
underpins: forma la base de
death toll: nombre de víctimes / número de víctimas

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which one of the following sentences about Henrietta Lacks is NOT true? ☐ She is responsible for a great advance in medicine. ☐ She died while giving birth to her fifth son. ☐ She never knew of her contribution to medicine. ☐ She was segregated for being black.	☐	☐	☐
2. When Henrietta Lacks was in hospital, George Gey ☐ operated to remove her tumour. ☐ received some of her tissue. ☐ informed her of his experiments. ☐ was growing human cells in his lab.	☐	☐	☐
3. Because of senescence, ☐ cells continue dividing and multiplying. ☐ the DNA replicates perfectly throughout one's lifetime. ☐ cancers are avoided. ☐ cells eventually die.	☐	☐	☐
4. Lacks's cells "became a workhorse of biological research." This means that ☐ they were used over and over again. ☐ they divided endlessly. ☐ they could be shared easily. ☐ they were preserved in a lab.	☐	☐	☐
5. The HeLa cell line ☐ has been the basis for medical research for years. ☐ was immortalised in a laboratory. ☐ is only used in studies on the health of black people. ☐ cannot be used in present-day research anymore.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, ☐ neither Henrietta nor her family were ever asked permission to conduct experiments with her cells. ☐ the companies that used her cells in their products have paid her family compensation. ☐ Lacks's medical records have been very useful to scientists and doctors, and that's why they were published. ☐ Black people at that time had their lives exposed by doctors and the health-care system.	☐	☐	☐
7. The #BlackLivesMatter movement ☐ has made researchers consider stopping the use of HeLa cells completely. ☐ has increased the number of COVID-19 deaths among black people. ☐ considers the research done with HeLa cells illegal. ☐ expects scientists to continue the experiments with HeLa cells.	☐	☐	☐
8. Some of Henrietta's descendants ☐ want to pay tribute to all the people who have died of cancer. ☐ do not mind what was done wrong, because the result was worth it. ☐ are organising a party to celebrate the anniversary of her death. ☐ are encouraging people of all races to contribute to cancer research.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

IS PLASTIC A DEADLY THREAT TO WILDLIFE?

On a boat off Costa Rica, a biologist uses a Swiss army knife to try to extract a plastic straw from a sea turtle. The turtle seems to be dying, bleeding profusely. For eight painful minutes a video on YouTube—which has registered more than 20 million views—shows horrifying images that are hard to watch. In the end, the desperate biologists manage to remove a four-inch-long straw from the creature's nose.

These shocking scenes show the dangers of plastic on wildlife: images of a dead bird covered in oil or a flatback turtle stuck in a fishing net have spread widely in the media. But most of the time, the harm is not so noticeable. **Seagulls** that nest on islands off the coast of Australia and New Zealand eat more plastic as a proportion of their body mass than any other marine animal. Researchers say that in one large population, 90 % of the baby birds had already ingested some. A plastic piece **piercing** an intestine can kill any bird quickly. And what's worse, the consumption of plastic usually leads marine birds to suffer from chronic, permanent hunger.

Matthew Savoca, a marine biologist with the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration in the U.S., complains, "the really sad thing about this is that birds are eating plastic thinking that it is food." He goes on to add, "imagine you ate lunch and then just felt weak and lethargic and hungry all day, which would be very confusing." Seabirds use energy that their malnourished bodies cannot provide. That is why they **roam** farther in search of real food, but only to take back plastic waste to feed their young. Savoca has also come to the conclusion that fish such as anchovies eat plastic because it smells like food once it is covered with algae.

What makes plastic useful for people—it's durable, light, and easy to throw out—increases the threat to animals. Plastic lasts a very long time, perhaps for more than 400 years and besides, most of it floats. Scientists suggest that single-use plastic is the worst offender: straws, water bottles, and plastic bags have been proved to be the most serious danger to marine species. For instance, 700 marine species have been reported—so far—to have eaten or become entangled in plastic.

Society does not fully understand the long-term impact of plastic on wildlife, nor its impact on us. In an historical perspective, humans are not used to the massive use of this material. The first documented cases of seabirds ingesting plastic referred to 74 albatrosses found on a Pacific **atoll** in 1966, when plastic production was roughly 5 % of what it is today.

The widespread use of plastic in millions of products and the very nature of plastic waste mean that science is unlikely to be able to solve this huge problem any time soon. It is preferable to take policy action now before waiting for the situation to become even worse. The first step would be identifying places where plastic has been shown to be harmful for birds and then take forceful measures there. Passing a law banning the sale of plastic products in those places would be a significant step forward, for instance. In the end, people currently use plastics because they are easy to use and cheap, but increasingly we are realizing that in the long term, plastics are expensive and a serious threat to the environment.

Text adapted from an article in *National Geographic Magazine* (June 2018)

seagull: gavina / gaviota
to pierce: perforar
to roam: vagar
atoll: atol / atolón

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ A plastic straw was removed from the sea turtle. ☐ The images seen on YouTube are tough to watch. ☐ The biologists extracted the straw right away. ☐ A plastic straw made the turtle bleed.	☐	☐	☐
2. The harm that plastic causes on marine birds ☐ results in a constant feeling of hunger. ☐ has resulted in fewer anchovies in the sea. ☐ is minor in 90 % of cases. ☐ prevents them from migrating.	☐	☐	☐
3. We can deduce from Matthew Savoca's research that ☐ anchovies cannot smell algae. ☐ anchovies feed on algae. ☐ seagulls migrate to avoid eating plastics. ☐ seagulls feed on anchovies.	☐	☐	☐
4. Plastic is a threat to animals because ☐ it is poisonous. ☐ most of it does not remain on the sea surface. ☐ it can be thrown away easily. ☐ it does not last very long.	☐	☐	☐
5. Straws, water bottles and plastic bags ☐ sink down to the ocean floor. ☐ float for a short time. ☐ are eaten by only a few marine species. ☐ last much longer than expected.	☐	☐	☐
6. The massive use of plastic ☐ started on a Pacific island in 1966. ☐ has been documented since 1966. ☐ has not changed in the last 50 years. ☐ is a relatively recent phenomenon.	☐	☐	☐
7. The impact of plastic waste on wildlife ☐ was predicted by scientists 30 years ago. ☐ can be easily solved by science. ☐ requires government intervention. ☐ has remained the same over the years.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the text, which of the following is an effective solution to the threat of plastic waste on wildlife? ☐ Delaying taking measures now and waiting for science to solve the problem. ☐ Financing scientific research to change the nature of plastic. ☐ Locating crucial areas and then forbidding plastics there. ☐ Taking voluntary measures to reduce people's use of plastic.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

Part 2: Reading comprehension

RAGE AGAINST THE MACHINES: HOW UNPLUGGING HELPS

In the past, people could "switch off" after work by simply going home or avoiding dealing with dramatic friends by not picking up the phone. But smartphones, social media and the expectation that everyone should be available all the time have made taking a break much more difficult. From this necessity, a new anti-tech trend has arisen: over the past few years, the concept of *unplugging* has become popular amongst bloggers and youtubers.

It is widely accepted that multitasking and constant email cause a lack of productivity, negatively impact on social relationships and increase stress. But can we reverse these bad consequences if we abstain from using technology? According to most research, the answer is "yes."

Like a muscle, the brain needs recovery time in order to develop, grow and retain new memories. In fact, shutting off completely may be crucial: a Michigan university study found that students who walked in the woods after learning something new were more likely to retain it. Even brief activities such as taking a short walk, spending time in nature, or just daydreaming can help the brain. Without free time, it is impossible to fully learn new skills and keep the brain at its cognitive best.

Luckily more and more people are becoming aware of the importance of **down time**. Over the past few years, the idea of disconnecting from all online communication has grown into a major movement. In 2010, for instance, a group of Jewish artists created the *Sabbath Manifesto* designed to help people of all faiths and creeds find a day of rest amid the **fuss** of modern technology. This manifesto created the *National Day of Unplugging* which happens once a year, typically in early March.

Recently, countless bloggers have written about technological stress. For example, some of the people behind the lifestyle website *The Minimalists* suggest cancelling home Internet access in order to make using a computer more difficult and less appealing. Even some Internet celebs advocate a more radical approach: a 25-day digital detoxification after realizing their addiction was noticeable. And finally, a well-known magazine journalist has spent an entire year without Internet.

Unplugging is a trendy **buzzword** these days, but hopefully taking technological breaks is not just a **passing fad**. The Internet and mobile communication have grown by impressive leaps in the past ten years. But because we are used to tech companies releasing new and better products every week, we have assumed that more communication is good, more social media sites are better, and the ability to contact anyone at any time is best of all.

In reality, however, this behaviour might be unsustainable. Keeping up with email, Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and other sites round-the-clock have been shown to be exhausting, bad for our brains, our relationships and our productivity. Regardless of length and intensity, technology **fasts** have proved an important point: with a little bit of effort we can stop living through our phones and computer screens. It would be better if we could re-connect with other human beings, thus reducing stress and **enhancing** creativity.

Text adapted from an article by
Sophia Breene. *Greatist* [online] (June 2015)

down time: temps d'inactivitat / tiempo de inactividad
fuss: rebombori / jaleo
buzzword: paraula en voga / palabra de moda
passing fad: tendència passatgera / tendencia pasajera
fast: dejuni / ayuno
to enhance: augmentar / aumentar

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Some years ago people did not answer phone calls so that ☐ they could be connected to the web without disturbance. ☐ they were able to forget about their problems. ☐ they could be available all the time. ☐ they could continue working from home.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to most research, we can avoid the bad consequences of being permanently connected to the web ☐ if we leave little time for socialization. ☐ if we learn to go without technological tools. ☐ by emailing as little as possible. ☐ if we admit that multitasking harms our friends irreversibly.	☐	☐	☐
3. A Michigan university study concluded that ☐ our brain only develops when it does not work. ☐ a student must leave the city if he/she wants to learn something new. ☐ students learn best after moments of outdoor relaxation. ☐ brief activities are beneficial for our memories.	☐	☐	☐
4. The idea of disconnecting from all online communication ☐ was conceived by Israeli social activists. ☐ can unite people from all faiths and creeds. ☐ has induced several organizations to remind people to unplug. ☐ has been discarded because it is too expensive.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of these four statements is NOT true according to the text? ☐ Some famous people have decided to unplug for almost a month. ☐ For many network users, technological stress is a serious issue. ☐ If home Internet access is available, switching on a computer is appealing. ☐ Taking technological breaks can develop into a severe addiction.	☐	☐	☐
6. The text states that one possible solution to reduce stress would be: ☐ to not use smartphones on weekends. ☐ to keep up with Facebook and Twitter all day. ☐ to pause our use of connected devices periodically. ☐ to maintain contact with everybody through social media.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the text, why do people think that increased use of technology to contact others is good? ☐ Because we know companies are constantly launching state-of-the-art devices. ☐ Because technology has barely developed since the beginning of the 21st century. ☐ Because people have little time to communicate with each other. ☐ Because we know that it is always better to have more information.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is unsustainable about not "unplugging"? ☐ Multitasking has a positive impact on our social relationships. ☐ Being connected all the time makes us less creative. ☐ Keeping up with Facebook and Instagram keeps people more informed. ☐ Maintaining a public profile on social media is the key to success in business.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

Part 2: Reading comprehension

IS THERE SUCH A THING AS LOVE AT FIRST SIGHT?

The science of first impressions is complicated, influenced by things outside of our control, neurological processes that we don't understand and inaccurate stereotypes.

It takes less than a second to form an **assessment** of someone's face. These first impressions predict all kinds of important characteristics, not just attractiveness. These impressions we make in a second tend to be shared by the majority of the people. But that doesn't necessarily make them correct.

"A first impression could be **misleading**," says professor Alexander Todorov, author of the book *Face Value: The Irresistible Influence of First Impressions* and a professor at Princeton University. "Trying to figure out what a person is like from a simple exposure is basically ridiculous. We only make first impressions about strangers. So naturally they are superficial."

Whether our predictions are accurate or not, we make them quickly and we stick to them. Even if we are given more time than a second to judge the attractiveness of a face, we are unlikely to arrive at a different conclusion. According to professor Todorov, there are three universal qualities that people infer from a face: attractiveness, **trustworthiness** and dominance.

In these first impressions, men and women are not judged equally. Women who appear masculine are evaluated negatively whereas men would be evaluated positively. This applies to both genders, so men and women [both] make negative assessments of masculine-looking women."

First impressions of faces are superficial, general and can be inaccurate. If we think about this in the context of dating apps, we also have to think about the effects of how a photo is taken. The photos we choose to publish on dating profiles are those that present ourselves in the best light. Not just chosen for attractiveness, they are also there to reflect personality and social cues, like adventurousness or generosity.

First impressions are rapid but **shallow** and can change over time if you have better information, like when your date starts speaking. "The only way to tell whether two people will really like each other is when they have to talk. People don't make good predictions for compatibility without talking," says professor Todorov.

Professor Todorov has categorised all the conversational strategies we use which should lead to a second date and he came to several conclusions: "The traditional dating habit was that men approach women and we have found that it is men who approach women when dating online, too," says professor Todorov. "But the most interesting part is how few gender differences there were in the types of strategy used."

Men and women are more similar than they are different. Being sincere about the type of person you are looking for is more effective than talking about your wealth, profession or whether you are looking for love.

"Something that is unique about online dating is that you have a longer time to figure out if your date is going to meet your expectations," says Todorov. "Sometimes with online dating you have a tendency to build people up in your head which can lead to disappointment. We can idealise people when we don't have a lot of information to go on."

Having said that, there have been several marriages from these speed-dating meetings, so there must be some logic in there, says Todorov: "Some people now have children, so it produced some nice results".

Text adapted from an article by
William Park. *BBC News* [online] (April 3, 2019)

assessment: valoració / valoración
misleading: enganyós / engañoso
trustworthiness: confiança / confianza
shallow: superficial

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to professor Todorov ☐ we only make first impressions about people we don't know. ☐ we make first impressions only if they are misleading. ☐ our first impressions about someone are usually wrong. ☐ we usually share our first impression with many other people.	☐	☐	☐
2. Once people have made their first impressions ☐ they may change them quite quickly if their opinions are not accurate. ☐ they will change their opinion if they are not sure of the person they have just met. ☐ they will hardly ever change their first opinion about a person they have just met. ☐ they always change their mind soon afterwards if given more time to judge a person.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which one of these sentences is TRUE? ☐ In first impressions women and men make similar judgments. ☐ In first impressions women and men are judged similarly. ☐ In first impressions feminine-looking men are badly considered. ☐ In first impressions masculine-looking men are badly judged.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to the text, the photos people publish on their dating profiles are ☐ their best ones in order to reflect their personalities only. ☐ a mixture of fake and real ones; people don't want to show how they really are. ☐ very superficial in order not to show one's real personality and generosity. ☐ chosen to show physical and personality traits.	☐	☐	☐
5. Prof. Todorov affirms that ☐ first impressions are always reliable even when our date starts speaking. ☐ people can change their first impressions when they start talking to their date. ☐ talking to our date reinforces our first impressions, making them more certain. ☐ people in general make good predictions from their first impressions.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to professor Todorov, the conversational strategies used in online dating show ☐ that women talk more about themselves than men do. ☐ that men talk more about their profession than women do. ☐ that men and women use quite different approaches to dating. ☐ that men and women take similar approaches to dating.	☐	☐	☐
7. If you want to find your perfect date, Prof. Todorov recommends that you be ☐ talkative when you meet your date. ☐ honest when you talk to your date. ☐ a little vague when talking about your interests. ☐ responsible when you talk about your wealth.	☐	☐	☐
8. At the end of the article we can come to the conclusion that speed-dating meetings ☐ are the only way to get married successfully. ☐ are successful only if you want to have children. ☐ sometimes fulfil people's expectations. ☐ are a very flawed system of meeting people.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW TO LOOK MODERN IN VINTAGE

"I don't want to look retro. I think **permed hair** looks ridiculous and I would not be seen dead in anything with real fur. Right now I want a cardigan that I can tuck into a midi skirt, but I want it simple, with neutral colours like the ones on the **catwalk**, and not in some light, pastel colour with **embroidered** flowers." This is the thinking of many young people today, who increasingly go second-hand shopping, but for this season's looks. Can we find "now" clothes, without buying new clothes?

Buying clothes second-hand is, after all, very fashionable. This is sustainable **retail** therapy, a feelgood fashion fix that doesn't add to the environmental problem of clothing overproduction. In the U.S., the resale market has grown 21 times faster than the retail market in the past three years, with a report this year predicting that the second-hand market could overtake fast fashion within a decade. In the U.K., the younger shoppers are returning to a taste for second-hand things that their parents' generation, raised on fast fashion chains like Zara, Primark and H&M, never cultivated. Eighty per cent of 16-21-year-olds are happy to buy second-hand clothes and an amazing 90 % of over-60s are comfortable buying used garments, while less than a third of shoppers in their 30s and 40s are happy to buy used clothes, according to a survey by a waste management agency.

The new trendy profile of second-hand shopping is beginning to be felt on the high street. In Covent Garden in London, a new branch of *Picknweight*, a vintage store that is already a cult destination in Berlin, had customers queueing down the street when it opened. Many people start their hunt for now-clothes-not-new-clothes next door, in the Shelton Street branch of *Rokit*, a vintage institution which has resold more than a million tonnes of pre-worn clothing since the first branch opened in Camden market in 1986. Today *Rokit's* business is booming: it has expanded to four shops in London, has huge web sales, and even employs a team of people who transform and repair clothing that otherwise could never be resold into trendy, wanted items. Vintage is definitely IN.

Second-hand clothes hunting requires you to change your mind as a shopper. Walk into a high street store and you will see ready-made complete looks on **mannequins**, and the store has stock in different sizes. In a second-hand store, you have to look harder and use your imagination. You have to take a different approach: it helps to remind yourself that while new clothes look great on the shop floor, second-hand clothes are the opposite—these pieces often look unattractive in the shop and come into their own once you get them home.

If you want to find used clothes that look current, looking at labels for designer brands is not the best advice. Instead, zoom in on today's colours, shapes and details. Anything classic, like a blazer or a wool cardigan, is always a good buy if it is the right colour.

The preconception with vintage is that it's all baby blue polyester dresses, jackets with massive shoulder pads or horrible brown suits, but that's just not the case these days. The circular economy is perfectly suited to young people's commitment to recycling and creating a more sustainable world. The production of polyester alone is one of the world's most polluting industries because it depends on burning petroleum oil, so anything and everything we can do to reduce fast fashion and its carbon footprint should be our goal. Fashion is cyclical, after all. The fact is that the original of what you are looking for will be out there if you look hard enough.

Text adapted from an article by
Jess Cartner-Morley. *The Guardian* [online] (November 6, 2019)

permed hair: pentinat amb permanent / peinado con permanente
catwalk: passarel·la / pasarela
embroidered: brodat / bordado
retail: venda al detall / venta al por menor
mannequin: maniquí

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to the author, many young people ☐ want to wear light-coloured clothes with flowers. ☐ like shopping for second-hand clothes to achieve a "retro" look. ☐ like buying used clothes that don't look dated. ☐ shop for genuine fur coats in second-hand shops.	☐	☐	☐
2. In the U.S. ☐ the second-hand market for clothing is getting smaller and smaller. ☐ the first-hand market for clothing is 21 times larger than the second-hand market. ☐ the second-hand market for clothing will overtake the first-hand market in 10 years. ☐ the second-hand market for clothing has increased much faster than the first-hand market.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following is TRUE about people's shopping preferences in the U.K.? ☐ People over 60s are the age group that feels best about buying pre-worn clothing. ☐ Teenagers do not usually like buying second-hand clothes. ☐ About half of all 30-40-year-olds regularly buy used clothes. ☐ Less than half of people between 16 and 21 feel comfortable buying second-hand clothes.	☐	☐	☐
4. Where is the first *Picknweight* vintage store? ☐ In Covent Garden in London. ☐ In Camden market in London. ☐ In Berlin. ☐ The text does not say.	☐	☐	☐
5. How is second-hand clothes shopping different from buying new, unworn clothes? ☐ Shoppers can find well-matched outfits ready to be purchased. ☐ All sizes are available in second-hand stores. ☐ Shoppers should be ready to spend more time in the store. ☐ Clothes look nicer in a second-hand clothes shop than at home.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following is NOT true about *Rokit*? ☐ Its business has grown substantially since 1986. ☐ It has a single retail location in London. ☐ It has sold a huge amount of pre-worn clothing. ☐ It mends clothing before trying to sell it.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the author, if you want to buy now-but-not-new clothes ☐ you need to browse the Internet. ☐ you need to look for famous brands. ☐ you should be looking for bright colours. ☐ you need to look for details currently in style.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does the phrase "Fashion is cyclical, after all" mean? ☐ It means that fashion trends return and are periodically back in style. ☐ It means that vintage clothes inevitably look old and outdated. ☐ It means that cycling trends will always be fashionable. ☐ It means that we should reduce, recycle and reuse vintage clothes.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HUGE REDUCTIONS IN MEAT-EATING 'ESSENTIAL' TO AVOID CLIMATE BREAKDOWN

Huge reductions in meat-eating are essential to avoid dangerous climate change, according to one of the most comprehensive analyses of the food system's impact on the environment. In Western countries, the study states that beef consumption needs to fall by 90 % and be replaced by five times more beans and peas. The research also finds that enormous changes to farming are needed to avoid destroying the planet's ability to feed the 10 billion people expected to be on the planet in a few decades.

Food production already causes great damage to the environment, via greenhouse gases from **livestock**, deforestation and water shortages from farming, and vast dead zones in oceans from agricultural pollution. But without action, its impact will get far worse as the world population rises by 2.3 billion people by 2050. At the same time, global income is increasing, enabling more people to eat meat-rich Western-style diets. "It is pretty shocking," said Marco Springmann at the University of Oxford, who led the research team. "We are really risking the sustainability of the whole system. If we are interested in people being able to farm and eat, then we better not do that."

The new study follows the publication of a UN report in which the world's leading scientists warned there are just 12 years in which to keep global warming under 1.5 °C, beyond which even half a degree will significantly worsen the risks of **drought**, floods and extreme heat. The report said consuming less meat and dairy products (like eggs and cheese) was important. Nevertheless, current trends are in the opposite direction.

The new research, published in the journal *Nature*, is the most thorough to date and combined data from many countries to evaluate the impact of food production on the global environment. It then looked at what could be done to stop the **looming** food crisis. "There is no magic bullet," said Springmann. "But dietary and technological change [on farms] are the two essential things, and hopefully they can be complemented by a reduction in food loss and waste." About a third of food produced today never reaches the table.

The researchers recommended a global shift to a "flexitarian" diet in order to keep climate change under 2 °C. This flexitarian diet means drastic changes for many people: the average European or American would need to eat 75 % less beef, 90 % less pork and half the number of eggs, while tripling consumption of legumes such as beans, peas, and lentils and quadrupling that of nuts and seeds. This would cut emissions from livestock by 50 %, and better management of **manure** would enable further cuts. In contrast to what needs to occur in the U.S. and Europe, the millions of people in poor nations who are undernourished need to eat a little more meat and dairy.

Reducing meat consumption might be achieved by a mix of education, taxes, subsidies for plant-based foods and changes to school and workplace menus, the scientists said. To prevent deforestation, water shortages and pollution from overuse of fertiliser, they recommend profound changes in farming practices.

Ultimately, we live on a finite planet, with finite resources. It is a myth to imagine that there is a technological solution allowing us to produce as much food as we might ever want, allowing us to overeat and throw food away. The effects of the current food system on the environment will not allow future generations to live on a stable, ecologically rich planet.

Text adapted from an article by
Damian Carrington. *The Guardian* [online] (October 10, 2018)

livestock: ramaderia / ganado
drought: sequera / sequía
looming: que s'acosta / que se avecina
manure: fems / estiércol

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. In order to avoid environmental damage ☐ people should eat less meat. ☐ people need to eat more fish. ☐ people should eat more meat and dairy. ☐ vegan diets need to be adopted.	☐	☐	☐
2. In a few decades, the world population ☐ will increase to 2.3 billion people. ☐ will increase by 70 %. ☐ will increase to 10 billion people. ☐ will not change.	☐	☐	☐
3. If global warming is kept under 1.5 °C ☐ traditional farming areas will experience major floods. ☐ the risk of drought, floods and extreme heat will increase. ☐ we will have a dozen years of continuous drought, floods and extreme heat. ☐ we will reduce the risk of drought, floods and extreme heat.	☐	☐	☐
4. The report states that dietary habits and changes in farming should be accompanied by ☐ more emissions from livestock. ☐ less impact on beef production. ☐ a decrease in food loss and waste. ☐ a global increase in meat consumption.	☐	☐	☐
5. A flexitarian diet implies ☐ eating mainly raw vegetables. ☐ eating no meat from farms. ☐ eating more meat and less legumes. ☐ eating more beans and peas and less meat.	☐	☐	☐
6. In order to be effective against climate breakdown, dietary changes ☐ should be applied equally across the world's population. ☐ should be applied more strictly in developed countries. ☐ are unnecessary in developing countries. ☐ should not be applied in the U.S. or U.K.	☐	☐	☐
7. What does the report recommend to reduce people's consumption of meat? ☐ Adopting traditional European farming practices everywhere. ☐ Using more fertilisers in developing countries. ☐ Changing menus served to children in schools. ☐ Clearing forests to increase the land available for agriculture.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ The Earth's resources are limited. ☐ The current food system does not enable future generations to have a sustainable planet. ☐ Technology will help us to continue with food production as we know it now. ☐ The current food system has a damaging impact on our climate.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

THE EMOJI IS THE BIRTH OF A NEW TYPE OF LANGUAGE (NO JOKE)

Tyler Schnoebelen has discovered something curious about why people use the skull emoji. Schnoebelen is a linguist and the chief analyst for Idibon, a firm that interprets linguistic data. Recently he got interested in emoji. He analyzed a million social media posts containing those familiar little pictograms and found that when people talk about their phone, they're 11 times more likely to use the skull. Weird, right? But to Schnoebelen, it makes sense. Our phones, he points out, are social lifelines, and when they malfunction—a weak signal, short battery life—we're upset. "When you don't have access to your phone, or when nobody's texting you, you're socially dead," he says. So we reach for a metaphorical emoji: the skull.

Fully 92 percent of all people online use emoji now, and one-third of them do so daily. On Instagram, nearly half of the posts contain emoji, a trend that began in 2011 when Apple's iOS added an emoji keyboard. Rates increased when Android did the same two years later. Emoji are so popular they're killing off **netspeak**. The more we use emoji, the less we use LOL and OMG.

In essence, we're watching the birth of a new type of language. Emoji assist in a peculiarly modern task: conveying emotions in short, online texts. "They're trying to solve one of the big problems of writing online, which is that you have the words but you don't have the tone of voice," as Gretchen McCulloch, a linguist, says.

Purists are not so convinced. What have we become, children with **crayons**? Surely words alone can convey emotional tone. Maybe—if you're a novelist with years of experience. But most of us write speedily and conversationally on Instagram or WhatsApp. Of the 20 most frequently used emoji, nearly all are hearts, smilies, or hand gestures—the ones that express feelings. In an age of rapid chatter, emoji aid communication by adding an emotional meaning to the message.

We also use emoji to express a sort of ambient presence, when words alone aren't enough. Ryan Kelly, a computer scientist at the University of Bath, has found that texters often exchange a few emoji as nonverbal conclusion to a conversation. "You might not have anything else left to say," Kelly says, "but you want the person to know that you're thinking of them." So you send a couple of pandas. Or telescopes! Or some other symbol that seems **witty**. This is another aspect of emoji—many are open-ended. In fact, it is known that friends use that flexibility to assign their own private meanings to specific emoji. (My wife and I use the Easter Island head to connote absurdity.)

People are even developing syntax and rules of use for emoji. Schnoebelen found that when face emoji are used, they tend to occur before other objects. If you text about a late flight, you'll put an unhappy face followed by a plane, not the reverse. In linguistic terms, this is called conveying "**stance**." Just as with face-to-face talk, our expression illustrates our stance before we've spoken a word.

Social pessimists can stop worrying; no linguist thinks that this means the end of writing. Natural language is our most powerful communication tool. For most people, these ideograms represent an upgrade. Language always changes: slang is born, develops and becomes obsolete, for example. But it's exceedingly rare—maybe unprecedented—for languages with phonetic alphabets to suddenly acquire a big expansion pack of ideograms. In an age when we write more than ever, emoji are the new language of the heart.

Text adapted from an article by
Clive Thompson. *Wired* [online] (April 19, 2016)

netspeak: llenguatge del ciberespai / lenguaje del ciberespacio
crayon: llapis de cera / lápiz de cera
witty: enginyós / ingenioso
stance: actitud

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Many people use the skull emoji when talking about their phone ☐ to tell friends that they don't feel well. ☐ to explain that it is not working well. ☐ to complain that nobody's sending them text messages. ☐ because they like using metaphorical language.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ Instagram incorporated emoji in 2011. ☐ Emoji usage increased after Android included them. ☐ Since we have emoji, we use netspeak less. ☐ Emoji in Instagram posts are very frequent.	☐	☐	☐
3. The author believes that we are watching the birth of a new type of language because ☐ writing online presents big problems. ☐ emoji replace voice messages. ☐ emoji have stable meanings. ☐ emoji help us transmit our feelings in writing.	☐	☐	☐
4. Emoji have become so popular so quickly because ☐ people no longer know how to spell. ☐ we want to convey emotional tone. ☐ alphabet keyboards are difficult to use online. ☐ we need new words to express our feelings.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to the author, smiley, hand and heart emoji ☐ seldom occur in online messages. ☐ are the only way to communicate our feelings online. ☐ have become effective tools of communication. ☐ often result in miscommunication.	☐	☐	☐
6. Many emoji are open-ended. This means that ☐ different people may assign them different meanings. ☐ they are sometimes used to end a conversation. ☐ you can use them when you don't know what to say. ☐ some people use them to express absurd things.	☐	☐	☐
7. We tend to put an emoji face before an object because ☐ it's impossible to convey stance in a message. ☐ we don't need to speak words in an online conversation. ☐ when we speak, we see the person's facial expression first. ☐ that's what the new syntax rule for emoji use tells us to do.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the writer, ☐ we write so much today because language always changes. ☐ emoji do not represent a threat to writing. ☐ emoji are a form of slang. ☐ emoji communicate more powerfully than text.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

THRILLER: MICHAEL JACKSON'S SURPRISING SUCCESS

The album that would become the most successful record in music history went unnoticed by the magazine *Time* when it was first **released** 35 years ago, on November 30, 1982. But it didn't take too long for that to change, as the album sat atop the charts for weeks and revolutionized the entire record industry and the music-video culture. About a year after its **release**, *Thriller* was still selling 200,000 copies a week. By the time Michael Jackson appeared on the cover of *Time* magazine in 1984, the album had become the best-selling album ever (and it still claims that title).

But, while it could be said that a success of that magnitude is always a surprise in some way, *Time*'s music critic Jay Cocks also suggests a deeper reason why the editors at *Time* may have **overlooked** the album when it was first released:

> For the record industry, *Thriller* was a restoration of confidence, a rejuvenation. Its effect on listeners, especially younger ones, was nearer to a revelation. *Thriller* brought Black music back to mainstream radio, from which it had been **banished** in the mid-'70s. "No doubt about it," says composer-arranger Quincy Jones, who produced the albums *Off the Wall* and *Thriller* with Jackson. "He took us right up there where we belong. Black music had to **play second fiddle** for a long time, but its spirit is the whole motor of pop. Michael connected with every soul in the world."
>
> *Thriller* does not have the mean, challenging immediacy of rap, but it is consummate contemporary rhythm and blues. Jane Fonda, one of Jackson's pals, put it as nicely as any music critic: "Michael had a fresh, original sound. The music is energetic, and it's sensual. You can dance to it, work out to it, make love to it, sing to it. It's hard to sit still to."
>
> The pulse of America and much of the rest of the world **beat** in time to the tough **strut** of *Billie Jean*, the asphalt aria of *Beat It*, the cool chills of *Thriller*. *Thriller* was on the Japanese charts for 65 consecutive weeks, and local teens were copying Michael's moves and singing his songs. *Thriller* was also South Africa's top seller: "Jackson bridged the apartheid gap," declared one record executive. The Soviet press in Moscow denounced Jackson, and his fans couldn't buy his records in any stores, but **bootleg** tapes were swapped and treasured.
>
> "Michael used to say, when he wrote, he'd write for everyone," says his mother Katherine, "even though the music business would list it as rhythm and blues because of him being Black." Jackson was the biggest thing in music since The Beatles. He was the hottest single phenomenon since Elvis Presley. He just may be the most popular Black singer ever.
>
> This success, Jones says, "had never happened to a Black performer." Rock critics (who are mostly white) liked *Thriller* well enough and wrote respectfully of it when it was released in December 1982, but they were as surprised as record-company executives (who are mostly white) when the album started **burning its way into** the country's collective musical consciousness. The message is obvious anyway: soul is for sharing, not segregating.

When Jackson died in 2009, *Thriller* was still remembered by many as a high point in his career. "For a generation, the magic is partly nostalgic; everyone in his fifties remembers exactly where they were when they heard *Beat It* for the first time," wrote *Time*'s Richard Corliss in his remembrance of the pop idol. "As a piece of music, it remains the greatest pop album of all time."

Text adapted from an article by
Lily Rothman. *Time* [online] (November 29, 2017)

to release: publicar
release: publicació / publicación
to overlook: passar per alt / pasar por alto
to banish: bandejar / desterrar
to play second fiddle: ser a l'ombra / estar en la sombra
to beat: marcar el ritme / marcar el ritmo
strut: estil de caminar fatxenda / pavoneo
bootleg: còpia pirata / copia pirata
to burn one's way into: establir-se ràpidament i amb força / establecerse rápidamente y con fuerza

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. When Michael Jackson's *Thriller* was released, ☐ *Time* magazine didn't pay much notice to it. ☐ it sold 200,000 copies on the first week. ☐ it was considered the best album ever. ☐ it didn't reach the charts immediately.	☐	☐	☐
2. After *Thriller*, ☐ Black music was forbidden on the radio. ☐ young people started listening to the radio again. ☐ only Black people listened to the radio stations playing Jackson's music. ☐ Black music was heard on radio stations aimed at a general audience.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these things does Quincy Jones NOT say? ☐ Michael Jackson made Black music important again. ☐ Pop music has a strong influence of Black music. ☐ Michael Jackson had connections all over the world. ☐ Black music was considered secondary for years.	☐	☐	☐
4. When Jane Fonda said that "It's hard to sit still to [Michael Jackson's music]", she meant that ☐ his music makes you want to move. ☐ his music makes you want to sit down. ☐ it's difficult to listen to his music. ☐ it's difficult to dance like he did.	☐	☐	☐
5. In Moscow, Michael Jackson's records ☐ were widely available in music stores. ☐ were only available as pirate copies. ☐ reached the top position in the charts. ☐ were played regularly on state-owned radio stations.	☐	☐	☐
6. Michael Jackson's mother says that ☐ he didn't make music for a specific group of people. ☐ he composed music for a Black audience. ☐ he composed mainly rhythm and blues. ☐ he wrote for the music business.	☐	☐	☐
7. Rock critics ☐ worked together with record companies. ☐ thought that Jackson's music would promote segregation. ☐ predicted the success of the album. ☐ didn't expect the album to be so successful.	☐	☐	☐
8. Many people believe that *Thriller* ☐ is the most famous song of the 20th century. ☐ marked the end of a music era. ☐ is one of the best albums in Michael Jackson's career. ☐ is a song with a strong political message.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

LEONARDO'S *SALVATOR MUNDI*: ART OR BUSINESS?

Salvator Mundi, the long-lost Leonardo da Vinci painting of Jesus Christ ordered by King Louis XII of France more than 500 years ago, has been sold in New York at Christie's, the well-known auction house, for more than $450 million, breaking the world record of any work of art sold at auction. It far surpassed Picasso's *Women of Algiers*, which was sold for $179.4 million at Christie's in May 2015.

Christie's marketing campaign was unprecedented in the art world. It was the first time the auction house had paid an agency for an advertising campaign. Christie's produced a video that compared the painting to "the discovery of a new planet" and showed celebrities like Leonardo di Caprio and Patti Smith viewing it. Christie's called the work "the last da Vinci," the only known painting by the Renaissance master still in a private collection (some fifteen others are in museums), and "the biggest discovery of the 21st century." In short, Christie's ran a brilliant marketing campaign for a painting with a very complicated history.

The oil on wood panel painting **depicts** a half-length figure of Christ as Savior of the World, facing frontally and dressed in flowing blue and **crimson** robes. He holds a crystal orb in his left hand as he raises his right hand in benediction.

Leonardo, who died in 1519, is thought to have painted *Salvator Mundi* sometime after 1500, during the same period that he produced the *Mona Lisa*. It became part of the British Royal collection in the early 17th century. It then disappeared in 1763 until 1900, when it was acquired by Sir Charles Robinson, an art collector, for the Cook Collection in Richmond, England. At the time, the painting was thought to have been by Leonardo's follower, Bernardino Luini. In 1958 the painting was sold by Sotheby's (Christie's rival auction house) for just £45 and the painting disappeared once again until it showed up in Louisiana in 2005.

It was acquired, badly damaged and partly painted-over, by a consortium of American art dealers who paid less than $10,000 for it. They restored it extensively and documented its authenticity as a work by Leonardo.

The masterpiece was long believed to have existed but was generally presumed to have been destroyed. In 2011, following six years of investigations, the work was confirmed as a genuine work of art by Leonardo and **unveiled** publicly at London's National Gallery, making it the first discovery of a painting by Leonardo since 1909. The painting was then sold to a Swiss art dealer, who then sold it to a Russian billionaire in 2013 for $127.5 million in a private sale that became the subject of a continuing **lawsuit**. The Russian family has sold the painting, which was bought by a prince from Saudi Arabia and will eventually be displayed in the new museum, Louvre Abu Dhabi.

Christie's says most scholars agree that the painting is by Leonardo, though some critics have questioned the attribution and some say the extensive restoration makes it impossible to determine the work's authorship. Before the auction, over 27,000 people had lined up at viewings in Hong Kong, London, San Francisco and New York to see the painting. Most of the people in line did not seem to care if Leonardo had actually made the work himself, or how much of the canvas had been repainted and restored. They just wanted to see a masterwork that dates from about 1500 and was rediscovered in 2005.

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (November 15, 2017), *The Telegraph* (November 16, 2017) and *The Guardian* (November 20, 2017)

to depict: representar
crimson: carmesí
unveiled: descobert / descubierto
lawsuit: demanda judicial

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The first owner of *Salvator Mundi* was ☐ the auction house Christie's. ☐ King Louis XII of France. ☐ a Russian art dealer. ☐ an anonymous American collector.	☐	☐	☐
2. Before they put the painting up for sale, Christie's ☐ showed it to professional collectors in France. ☐ had the painting put in a new frame. ☐ made a video to show the painting. ☐ tried to cover up the painting's complicated history.	☐	☐	☐
3. Most of Leonardo da Vinci's paintings that still exist are ☐ on exhibit in museums. ☐ owned by private collectors. ☐ currently being restored. ☐ in very poor condition.	☐	☐	☐
4. *Salvator Mundi* has been in known hands ☐ since the 16th century. ☐ for seven years, when it was first shown to the public. ☐ only since it was acquired by a group of American art dealers thirteen years ago. ☐ only for a short time compared with its 500+ years of existence.	☐	☐	☐
5. In 2005, a group of Americans ☐ bought the painting from a museum in Richmond, England. ☐ found the painting in a garage in San Francisco. ☐ purchased the painting and then had it cleaned and restored. ☐ lent the painting to the National Gallery in London for a major art exhibition.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following is NOT true? ☐ Christie's auctioned the painting for a Russian family. ☐ Christie's sold the painting to a Russian family. ☐ A Russian family bought the painting after it had been restored. ☐ A Swiss art dealer made a controversial sale to a Russian billionaire.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which of the following best describes this painting of the *Salvator Mundi*? ☐ There is no doubt that the painting is by Leonardo da Vinci. ☐ There is little evidence to support that Leonardo da Vinci was the painter. ☐ A few art critics claim that the painting is by Leonardo da Vinci. ☐ Despite extensive restoration, most experts believe the painting was done by Leonardo da Vinci.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the text, most of the people who lined up to see the *Salvator Mundi* ☐ did not believe that it was done by Leonardo da Vinci. ☐ were not very concerned about the details of restoration. ☐ were celebrities like Leonardo di Caprio and Patti Smith. ☐ were representatives of potential buyers from around the world.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE FUTURE OF FAKE NEWS: DON'T BELIEVE EVERYTHING YOU READ, SEE OR HEAR

In an age of Photoshop, filters and social media, many of us are used to seeing manipulated pictures—subjects become slimmer and smoother or, in the case of Snapchat, transformed into puppies. However, there's a new breed of video and audio manipulation tools, made possible by advances in artificial intelligence and computer graphics, that will allow for the creation of realistic looking **footage** of public figures appearing to say anything: Queen Elisabeth declaring her desire to fly to the moon, or Hillary Clinton describing how she climbed Mount Everest without oxygen. This is the future of fake news. We've long been told not to believe everything we read, but soon we'll have to question everything we see and hear as well.

For now, there are several research teams working on capturing and synthesizing different visual and audio elements of human behaviour. Software developed at Stanford University called Face2Face is able to manipulate video footage of public figures to allow a second person to put words in their mouth—in real time. Face2Face captures the second person's facial expressions as they talk into a webcam and then **morphs** those movements directly onto the face of the person in the original video. On its own, Face2Face is a fun plaything for creating memes and entertaining late-night talk show hosts. However, with the addition of a synthesized voice, it becomes more convincing—not only does the digital puppet look like the politician, but it can sound like the politician, too.

A research team at the University of Alabama at Birmingham has been working on voice impersonation. With 3-5 minutes of audio of a victim's voice—taken live or from YouTube videos or radio shows—an attacker can create a synthesized voice that can **fool** both humans and voice biometric security systems used by some banks and smartphones. The attacker can then talk into a microphone and the software will convert it so that the words sound like they are being spoken by the victim—whether over the phone or on a radio show.

Although their intentions may be well-meaning, voice-morphing technology could be combined with face-morphing technology to create convincing fake statements by public figures. However, these morphing technologies still aren't perfect. The facial expressions in the videos can seem a little distorted or unnatural, and the voices can sound a little robotic. But given time, they will be able to faithfully recreate the sound or appearance of a person, to the point where it might be very difficult for humans to detect the fraud.

Given the erosion of trust in the media and the **rampant** spread of **hoaxes** via social media, it will become even more important for news organizations to **scrutinize** content that looks and sounds like the real deal. People should be looking at the lighting and shadows in the video, whether all the elements featured in the frame are the right size, and whether the audio is **synced** perfectly. **Doctored** content might not pass the scrutiny of a rigorous newsroom, but if posted as a **grainy** video to social media it could spread virally and trigger a political, diplomatic, or public relations disaster, or even start a war.

Text adapted from an article by
Olivia Solon. *The Guardian* [online] (July 26, 2017)

footage: filmació / filmación
to morph: aplicar canvis / aplicar cambios
to fool: enganyar / engañar
rampant: sense restriccions / sin restricciones
hoax: engany, trampa / engaño, fraude
to scrutinize: examinar detalladament / examinar detalladamente
synced: sincronitzat / sincronizado
doctored: manipulat / manipulado
grainy: granulat / granulado

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Artificial intelligence and computer graphics ☐ are the future of social media sites. ☐ are creating new types of video and audio manipulation tools. ☐ will benefit public figures such as Donald Trump. ☐ enable readers to spot fake news.	☐	☐	☐
2. Fake news will be more convincing in the future because ☐ people tend to have less critical thinking skills. ☐ people will be more familiar with image technology. ☐ it will incorporate improved image and voice technology. ☐ human behaviour is easy to imitate.	☐	☐	☐
3. Face2Face can currently ☐ capture someone's facial expressions and map them onto someone else's face. ☐ imitate someone's facial expressions. ☐ synthesize voice and incorporate it onto someone's image. ☐ capture someone's physical appearance.	☐	☐	☐
4. Recent research allows ☐ smartphones to synthesize voice. ☐ the creation of software to convert real voice into a synthesized one. ☐ the creation of microphones that synthesize voice. ☐ the creation of 3-5 minute audios.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ Digital puppets will look and sound like real people. ☐ Face and voice-morphing technology will create more convincing fake news. ☐ Synthesized voice may deceive some security systems. ☐ Current software only works with live voice.	☐	☐	☐
6. There is certainly room for improvement in morphing technologies ☐ since they are able to exactly reproduce voice and image. ☐ since there are often sound delays in the videos. ☐ since facial expressions and voices may appear unreal. ☐ since humans can never detect fake videos.	☐	☐	☐
7. From now on, news organisations should ☐ manipulate news more often. ☐ not trust any information on social media. ☐ be more critical with their sources. ☐ pay particular attention to the features of videos.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is the danger of fake news, according to the author of the text? ☐ News agencies will never be able to detect fake news. ☐ Fake news will go viral on social media and create family conflicts. ☐ News agencies will spread fake news and create political conflicts. ☐ The viral presence of fake news on social media could create serious conflicts.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

SECRETS IN BUCKINGHAMSHIRE

There are secrets and there are secrets. The work done during the Second World War at Bletchley Park, a Victorian mansion fifty miles north of London, was so secret that the people who worked there didn't talk about it even to their friends or family. The work done at Bletchley Park is now well known: in recent years there have been major films, documentaries and books, and today it is a tourist attraction. So what took place there during the war?

Bletchley Park was purchased by the British government in 1938 as a location for its code-breaking school. The mansion was not really **suitable** for the task because the house was too small for all those who worked there, so many worked in "**huts**" around the main house. Bletchley Park was Britain's top code-breaking centre and security was very **tight**. The government feared that a Nazi agent would infiltrate the centre and ruin everything.

Station X, as Bletchley Park was known, was so efficient that it could read coded messages from German generals on the battlefield before they were even seen by Hitler in Berlin. Historians now believe that the code-breakers shortened the war in Europe by two years.

The Germans had invented Enigma, the most complicated encoding machine the world had ever seen. It resembled a large typewriter with lights and could, letter-by-letter, turn a normal message into entirely unintelligible nonsense that could be decoded only by using another Enigma machine. The design of Enigma machines allowed for millions of different configurations. Enigma machines were initially decoded by Polish mathematicians in 1932. When the Poles broke Enigma, the Germans changed the code only once every few months. Over the years, the Nazis continued to improve Enigma to increase the number of possible configurations to the billions, and with the **advent** of war, codes were changed at least once a day. Only a few weeks before Germany invaded Poland in 1939, Polish mathematicians showed their code-breaking machine, called a *bombe*, to the British. This information was extremely valuable, as the British had previously been unsuccessful at decoding German messages.

As the Second World War progressed, Station X became a hidden city with 10,000 people working there. About 75 % of the people working at Bletchley Park were women. Many of the code-breakers were Cambridge mathematicians, both experienced professors and recent graduates, but some were **recruited** because of their linguistic skills, knowledge of hieroglyphics, or brilliance at chess. Two of the best known code-breakers were Alan Turing and Gordon Welchman. Turing had significantly improved the design of the Polish machine, and Welchman then refined Turing's design. The result of their collaborations was the *Turing-Welchman Bombe*, named after the original Polish machine. The new Bombe went through all the possible Enigma configurations in order to reduce the possible number of settings to a **manageable** number that could be analyzed, and then decoded, by people.

The importance of code-breaking was recognized early on by Prime Minister Winston Churchill. In 1941, Turing and Welchman wrote directly to Churchill to ask for more resources. Churchill's now famous response was "Make sure they have all they want—extreme priority—and report to me that this has been done."

In 1945 Churchill ordered that all records of Bletchley Park be destroyed. The public first became aware of Bletchley Park because of a book published in 1974 that was authored by one of its former employees. Bletchley Park even has its own royal connection: in 2014 the visitor centre was opened by Catherine, Duchess of Cambridge (Kate Middleton), whose own grandmother had worked there during the war.

Text adapted from an article in *The Telegraph* (July 16, 2016)
and from information on the Bletchley Park Trust website

suitable: adequat / adecuado
hut: barracó / barracón
tight: estricte / estricto
advent: començament / comienzo
recruited: reclutat / reclutado
manageable: manejable

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The mansion at Bletchley Park was ☐ large enough for an entire school. ☐ too small for the number of people working there. ☐ converted into several huts. ☐ used as a shelter during Nazi attacks.	☐	☐	☐
2. The work done by the code-breakers at Bletchley Park ☐ had no effect on the outcome of the war. ☐ probably helped the Allies win the war earlier. ☐ was heavily criticized by Churchill. ☐ was infiltrated by the Nazis.	☐	☐	☐
3. Who built the Enigma machines? ☐ Germany. ☐ Polish mathematicians. ☐ The British Army. ☐ Alan Turing and Gordon Welchman.	☐	☐	☐
4. During the war, codes for Enigma machines ☐ changed daily. ☐ changed monthly. ☐ changed once every few months. ☐ never changed.	☐	☐	☐
5. The code-breakers at Bletchley Park included people who were ☐ very good at playing chess. ☐ mechanical engineers. ☐ originally from Poland. ☐ students from local universities.	☐	☐	☐
6. Churchill thought that code-breaking ☐ was interesting but too expensive. ☐ was important to winning the war. ☐ should be assigned to Army officers. ☐ could be done by anyone with some training.	☐	☐	☐
7. Bletchley Park was first discovered by the public because ☐ a documentary was made about it. ☐ Churchill gave many interviews about it. ☐ someone who had worked there wrote a book. ☐ the Poles reported on it to the British press.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following best describes the centre at Bletchley Park? ☐ A home owned by Queen Victoria. ☐ Government buildings turned into a tourist attraction. ☐ A school for mathematicians. ☐ The childhood home of Kate Middleton.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

HOW THE COLOUR RED **WARPS** THE MIND

We can never know what was going through our ancestors' minds, tens of thousands of years ago, when they first picked up natural **crayons** and began painting their bodies. But it is perhaps significant that they chose a rich, red colour—the colour of our blood and a **vivid** reminder of life, and death.

Today, shades of red are linked with power, aggression, and sex. And those associations may not be coincidence. A new **branch** of science called "colour psychology" has found that red can have a profound influence on our mood, perceptions and actions.

Wearing red can even change your physiology and balance of hormones. So what is it about the shades of red that makes them so potent? There is no doubt that our appreciation of red coincides with one of the most important events in our evolutionary history. Red skin is an important sign of dominance for many primates. Mandrill monkeys are perhaps the most famous example, with vivid markings on their face and bottom that signal their position in the group's strict hierarchy; the fitter, and more dominant an individual is, the redder he appears.

It was only in 2004 that two psychologists—Russell Hill and Robert Barton at the University of Durham—began to wonder whether humans might react in the same way. Although we don't tend to **flush** a vivid, inflamed red like a mandrill, we do sometimes burn up with anger. So the sight of red clothes could perhaps carry associations of aggression and dominance. The exact reason for these associations still remains a matter of debate. Researchers point to studies showing that people who wear red often feel more dominant themselves. Or perhaps the red intimidates the competitor: if you see red, you'll feel fear and be aware of your difficult situation, and as a result your testosterone drops.

Perhaps the most studied effect concerns the association of the colour with desire, seduction, and sin. A series of experiments, by Andrew Elliot and other colleagues at the University of Rochester in New York State, have all confirmed that men and women are both considered as being more attractive when wearing red compared to other colours. A possible explanation is that slightly redder skin seems to signal health and fitness; perhaps, by extension, we read the same from the clothes that we wear. Otherwise, not all the findings of colour psychology are robust enough to be fully trusted just yet. "I think the investigation is at a very early stage of development," says Elliot. "Eventually we might be able to use colour psychology to create a more productive working environment, but we're far from that point."

Elliot would also like to see more work investigating the rest of the rainbow. He has found that while red may **hinder** performance, green and blue can encourage creativity in certain kinds of word games. Even so, Elliot suspects that their influence will be fairly limited, compared to the potent effect that red has over our behaviour.

"The perception of red will always be associated with connotations and influences that run as deep as the blood in our veins. Perhaps we are only confirming what our ancestors realised when they first started painting their bodies: there is no other colour like it."

Text adapted from an article by
David Robson. *BBC.com* [online] (September 1, 2014)

to warp: torçar / torcer
crayon: llapis de color / lápiz de color
vivid: intens / intenso
branch: branca / rama
to flush: enrogir / enrojecer
to hinder: impedir

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The reason why our ancestors picked up on the colour red is ☐ because it made them more aggressive. ☐ because it was a vivid colour. ☐ still a mystery to the experts. ☐ because it is the colour of our blood.	☐	☐	☐
2. "Colour psychology" has found that red ☐ was the favourite colour of our ancestors. ☐ can affect the way people behave. ☐ is a vivid reminder of life and death. ☐ was the first colour our ancestors used.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these statements is NOT true? ☐ For many primates, red is a sign of power. ☐ In the primate world red shows who the leader is. ☐ Mandrill monkeys' social order is marked by the colour red. ☐ Red only appears on the strongest primates.	☐	☐	☐
4. Russell Hill and Robert Barton ☐ affirm that humans don't follow the same pattern as monkeys. ☐ think that humans act with anger whenever they see red. ☐ want to know if the reactions of humans and monkeys to red are identical. ☐ doubt that humans could behave like mandrills right now.	☐	☐	☐
5. A series of experiments led by Professor Elliot have confirmed that people who ☐ wear red are considered more desirable. ☐ wear colours other than red are not attractive. ☐ wear red are more intelligent. ☐ choose red clothes are healthier.	☐	☐	☐
6. Professor Andrew Elliot says that colour psychology ☐ is not far from being fully developed. ☐ is now ready to create better conditions at work. ☐ is still in a premature phase. ☐ will soon create a productive working atmosphere.	☐	☐	☐
7. Professor Elliot has observed that ☐ red is the perfect colour for creativity in word games. ☐ red doesn't help in some word games. ☐ blue is worse than red in some word games. ☐ blue and green are not useful for word games.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is Professor Elliot's final conclusion about the perception of red? ☐ It has changed over the years. ☐ It is constantly in progress. ☐ It is related to blood. ☐ It has been the same throughout history.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

WHAT'S THE REAL HISTORY OF BLACK FRIDAY?

Black Friday is the day after Thanksgiving, when crowds of turkey-stuffed shoppers descend on stores all over the country to take advantage of the Christmas season's biggest **bargains**. But the real story behind Black Friday is a bit more complicated—and darker—than that.

The first recorded use of the term *Black Friday* was applied to a financial crisis, specifically, the crash of the U.S. gold market on September 24, 1869. Two speculators, Jay Gould and Jim Fisk, bought up as much as they could of the nation's gold, hoping **to drive** the price **up** and sell it for huge profits. On that Friday in September, the conspiracy was finally revealed, sending the Wall Street stock market into **bankruptcy**.

The most commonly repeated story behind the post-Thanksgiving shopping-related Black Friday tradition links it to **retailers**. As the story goes, after an entire year of operating at a loss ("in the red"), stores would earn a profit ("go into the black") on the day after Thanksgiving, because holiday shoppers spent so much money on discounted merchandise. Though it's true that retail companies used to record losses in red and profits in black when doing their **accounting**, this is an inaccurate version of Black Friday's origin.

In recent years, another myth has appeared, giving a particularly ugly **twist** to the tradition and claiming that back in the 1800s, Southern plantation owners could buy slaves at a discount on the day after Thanksgiving. Though this version of Black Friday's roots has understandably led some to call for a boycott of the retail holiday, it has no basis in fact.

The true story behind Black Friday, however, is quite different. Back in the 1950s, police in the city of Philadelphia used the term to describe the chaos on the day after Thanksgiving, when thousands of shoppers and tourists arrived in the city on the day before the big Army-Navy football game held on that Saturday every year. The Army-Navy game, one of the biggest rivalries in American sports, is usually played in Philadelphia, the first capital of the U.S. Philadelphia cops were not able to take the day off because they had to work extra-long **shifts** to deal with the big crowds and added traffic. Shoplifters would also take advantage of the confusion in stores to steal merchandise, adding to the policemen's headaches.

By 1961, the expression *Black Friday* had caught on in Philadelphia. The city's merchants tried unsuccessfully to change it into *Big Friday* in order to remove the negative connotations. The term didn't spread to the rest of the U.S. until much later. Sometime in the late 1990s, however, retailers found a way to reinvent Black Friday and turn it into something that reflected positively on them and their customers. The day after Thanksgiving became America's shopping day, marking the point when stores turned a profit. It is interesting to note, however, that stores traditionally see bigger sales on the Saturday before Christmas than on Black Friday.

The Black Friday story stuck, and soon the term's darker roots in Philadelphia were forgotten. Since then, the one-day sales bonanza has become a four-day event, and has inspired other retail holidays such as Small Business Saturday/Sunday and Cyber Monday. Stores started opening earlier and earlier on that Friday, until Walmart, the world's largest retailer, opened its stores on Thanksgiving evening in 2011. Ever since, retailers have been in a race to catch up and now, millions of Americans say they plan to shop immediately after their Thanksgiving meal. Retailers have come up with a name they hope will catch on: Grey Thursday.

Text adapted from an article by
Sarah Pruitt. *History.com* [on line] (November 24, 2015)

bargain: ganga
to drive up: incrementar
bankruptcy: bancarrota
retailer: comerciant que ven al detall / comerciante minorista
accounting: comptabilitat / contabilidad
twist: gir / giro
shift: torn / turno

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. On Black Friday ☐ you can find the biggest discounts of the year. ☐ lots of shoppers buy stuffed turkey. ☐ retailers sell merchandise at lower prices. ☐ shops all over the country increase prices.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which sentence is NOT true? ☐ Gould and Fisk managed to sell their gold at a high price. ☐ As a result of Gould and Fisk's conspiracy, Wall Street crashed in 1869. ☐ The term *Black Friday* was used for the first time in 1869. ☐ Gould and Fisk's speculative moves were discovered on a Friday.	☐	☐	☐
3. It is said that Black Friday owes its name to retailers because ☐ they sold a lot and made a profit on the day after Thanksgiving. ☐ they had losses and profits on the same day. ☐ the stores that didn't offer any discounts were in the red. ☐ they didn't make any profits on the day after Thanksgiving.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to the text, what's the relationship between slavery and Black Friday? ☐ None; the whole story is fake. ☐ Slaves used to be sold on Fridays. ☐ Slaves were cheaper after Thanksgiving. ☐ Extra help was needed on plantations after Thanksgiving.	☐	☐	☐
5. Police officers in Philadelphia used the term *Black Friday* to refer to the day when ☐ thousands of visitors to the city caused them a lot of trouble. ☐ the Army-Navy football match was played. ☐ stores opened later than usual. ☐ they could enjoy a long Thanksgiving holiday.	☐	☐	☐
6. The term *Black Friday*, with the meaning we know today, was widely used ☐ at the end of the 1990s. ☐ throughout the 1950s. ☐ from 2011 onwards. ☐ back in the 1800s.	☐	☐	☐
7. Nowadays, Black Friday sales ☐ last until the Monday after Thanksgiving. ☐ have been replaced by Cyber Monday. ☐ start very early on Thanksgiving Day. ☐ continue until the following Thursday.	☐	☐	☐
8. Grey Thursday refers to ☐ going shopping right after Thanksgiving dinner. ☐ the first time Walmart opened its stores on Thanksgiving Day. ☐ the shops that open on Thanksgiving Day. ☐ the day when most Americans go shopping.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

JAMIE'S SUGAR TAX ON FIZZY DRINKS

Jamie Oliver is an English celebrity chef, owner of more than 50 restaurants and also a personality known for his food television shows, cookbooks and more recently his global campaign for better food education. One of the actions of his global campaign is to impose a **levy** on sweet **fizzy** drinks sold in Jamie's restaurants in protest at the government's refusal to introduce a "sugar tax."

Oliver will add a 10 p (€ 0.15) charge to every drink with added sugar in an attempt to **highlight** the dangers of too much sugar as well as to send a message to the government to take urgent action on childhood obesity.

Several other restaurant chains are expected to join Oliver's "sugar tax" protest. All the money raised from the levy will be put into a foundation called *Sustain*, which will promote better food and farming policies and practices, to support children's healthy food initiatives across Britain. The Jamie Oliver Restaurant Group will make a donation of £25,000 to get the fund started. Oliver expects the charge—which he calls "the children's health levy"—to raise £80,000 in the first year.

Oliver said: "I was born into the restaurant industry and I truly believe that by joining together on this problem we not only send a powerful and strong message to government but we also have the potential to make a long lasting **legacy** that could make many parents be aware of the benefits that a healthy diet has on their children."

Oliver also added: "I have seen first-hand the heart breaking effects that poor diet and too much sugar is having on our children's health. Young children often need multiple teeth pulled out under anaesthetic and one in three kids now leaves primary school overweight or obese. Soft drinks are the biggest single source of sugar among school-age kids and teenagers and so we have to start here."

An explanation of the sugary drink levy will be printed on all menus in Jamie Oliver's restaurants and the waiters **will be briefed** about the alternative choices for children. Oliver points out that tap water is always freely available. Oliver does not allow fizzy, sugary drinks in his own home. He says his four children have grown up drinking mainly water or diluted fruit juice. He believes parents should explain to children which drinks are best for them and make healthy drinks fun—for instance, by adding freshly cut lemons, oranges or strawberries to iced water.

Simon Bladgen, chief executive of the Jamie Oliver Restaurant Group, said: "As a business we're concerned about the increasing number of illnesses related to the diet in the UK, especially in children, and while we're not against sugar, we do feel that we need to take the initiative when it comes to keeping our costumers informed, so a levy on these drinks allows us to send a message as well as raise money to help give children the knowledge to make better choices."

The idea has been welcomed by health activists. Tam Fry, a spokesman for the National Obesity Forum, said: "Once again Jamie Oliver has taken the initiative that should force the government to take measures as soon as possible. His levy will be applauded by everyone who understands obesity and the health damage of excessive sugar."

While all the main medical professions in Britain have given support to a 20 % tax on sugary soft drinks, the government has excluded such a move, preferring to work with the food industry on voluntary measures.

Text adapted from *The Sunday Times* (June 21, 2015)

levy: taxa / impuesto
fizzy: amb gas / con gas
highlight: fer patent / resaltar
legacy: llegat / herencia
to be briefed: ser informat / ser informado

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Jamie's sugar tax is imposed in ☐ all British restaurants. ☐ Jamie's restaurants only. ☐ restaurant chains only. ☐ hamburger restaurants in Britain.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ Jamie has created this tax to emphasize the dangers of too much sugar in our diet. ☐ The British government has imposed a sugar tax because of childhood obesity. ☐ The money from the tax will support programmes promoting healthy food. ☐ Jamie participates in a worldwide campaign to improve food education.	☐	☐	☐
3. Oliver considers that if all the restaurant industry is united on the "sugar tax," ☐ the Sustain foundation will not raise enough money to continue with its activities. ☐ the government will have more support to carry on with its policy on childhood obesity. ☐ parents will be convinced to give their children a healthy diet. ☐ they will send a strong message to the fizzy drink manufacturers.	☐	☐	☐
4. Jamie Oliver considers that soft drinks ☐ have improved the diet of many children. ☐ are a necessary source of energy for children. ☐ are often recommended by doctors and nurses. ☐ should be taxed by the government.	☐	☐	☐
5. At Jamie Oliver's restaurants ☐ fizzy drinks are not printed on the menus. ☐ waiters are told not to offer fizzy drinks. ☐ tap water is cheaper. ☐ fizzy drinks are more expensive.	☐	☐	☐
6. Jamie Oliver's own children ☐ can't drink fizzy sugary drinks at home. ☐ don't usually drink fizzy, sugary drinks at home. ☐ only drink water at home. ☐ hardly ever drink fruit juice.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Simon Bladgen, a levy on fizzy drinks will ☐ stop young people from buying too many fizzy drinks. ☐ make obese children lose weight by consuming fewer fizzy drinks. ☐ make people aware of the risks of too much sugar in their diet. ☐ help the government policy on financing healthy diets for young people.	☐	☐	☐
8. Although the main medical professions support a 20 % tax on sugary drinks, the government has decided ☐ to ignore the proposal made by the doctors. ☐ to study the proposal carefully before taking any move. ☐ to promote optional actions among the food industry. ☐ to ban soft drink advertising.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

HOW A ROBOT COULD BE GRANDMA'S NEW **CAREGIVER**

With an ageing population and care costs rising, robots and smart homes may be a solution. But would you want a plastic dog to look after your loved ones?

Sitting in a studio in Kensington, London, the designer Sebastian Conran walks me through a worst-case scenario. "Basically, what it's looking for is a break in routine," he explains, pointing to a drawing of an elderly woman lying on the floor of her home. "There's an event. The e-sensor in the room notices that you've fallen over. MiRo goes to investigate." MiRo is a robotic dog. There is an early model close to where we are sitting. Its head sits above a torso without arms or legs, its ears carry hidden speakers, and its big eyes stare out at me.

Conran's company describes MiRo as a biomimetic companion robot, and says it will eventually work with facial recognition technology to make life easier for its owner. For example, the robot could **prompt** people to take medicine, or remind them of visitors' names, or question them if it thinks there is a problem. "It tries talking to you," he continues, "and then it will send a signal to the central office. Someone in the central office will then talk on the home speaker, asking if you're all right, and telling you to touch your wrist." Conran points at the wristband the elderly woman in the picture is wearing. It is another key part of his system because it monitors the vital signs of its wearer 24 hours a day. "If you touch your wrist the process will stop but will be recorded," he says. "If you don't touch your wrist it will contact a caregiver, who can see your heart rate and body temperature. The system rewinds the recording using the cameras in the home to see what happened. So when the ambulance gets there, the doctor will know what to expect."

Many of these visions are just **emerging**, but at a time of rising elderly populations and less government **funding** for health care, they raise important questions about where we are going with care. Can robots supplement human contact? Do economic realities mean technology is pushing some of society's most vulnerable into the arms of machines?

The technologists insist that their creations are designed to work alongside people, and not to replace them. They say there is a lot of misunderstanding about what robots are and whether they could have human-like qualities and give emotional support. Some technologists are against the idea of robots that resemble humans precisely for this reason. There are things that people are good at, and there are things that machines are good at. Designing robots to look like human beings could dangerously confuse these lines, they warn. Politicians might decide to spend much less money on doctors and nurses because they think robots can do everything.

Is a robot something people would actually want as a caregiver? Conran mentions an interesting point. For the generations now growing up that are accustomed to digital culture, centred on their instant gratification, the idea of 24-hour attention may even be desired. "These people are going to have completely different expectations," he says. "They will expect the state to provide for them in a different way than previous generations did. The quality of life has constantly got better and better, and we're coming up against the fact that, instead of getting better and better, things are beginning to drop off. Ageing needs to be improved."

Text adapted from an article by
Thomas McMullan. *The Guardian* (November 6, 2016)

caregiver: cuidador, cuidadora
to prompt: indicar
to emerge: emergir / emerger
funding: fons / fondos

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Robots and smart homes might ☐ be a solution to anyone who lives on their own. ☐ prevent ageing. ☐ be a solution to increasing elderly care costs. ☐ become plastic dogs.	☐	☐	☐
2. When you fall over, MiRo ☐ helps you stand up. ☐ notices that and gets closer to you. ☐ controls your body temperature. ☐ tells you to touch your wrist.	☐	☐	☐
3. MiRo ☐ only physically resembles a human person. ☐ can tell you to take medicine and remind you of names. ☐ can have a normal conversation with you. ☐ can prevent you from falling.	☐	☐	☐
4. If a robotic dog like MiRo takes care of you, ☐ you need to wear a wristband that constantly checks your health. ☐ there's always an ambulance that will know exactly what to do. ☐ it will come to you and take your body temperature. ☐ you need to call the central office with your vital signs every day.	☐	☐	☐
5. Robots ☐ are created to eventually substitute what human caregivers do. ☐ are designed to give and receive emotional support as human caregivers do. ☐ are created to solve misunderstandings with human caregivers. ☐ are designed to complement what human caregivers can do.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ Some scientists believe robots should not have human-like traits. ☐ Government authorities will definitely invest more money on automated care. ☐ Both humans and machines are each good at certain things. ☐ There's a lot of debate as to whether robots can have human-like traits.	☐	☐	☐
7. Present-day generations ☐ might want to have constant care. ☐ will be very interested in managing robots. ☐ will surely have a better life than older generations. ☐ should be given a robot by the state authorities.	☐	☐	☐
8. Sebastian Conran believes that ☐ economic realities make automated care a need. ☐ robots will entirely replace human caregivers. ☐ ageing is getting easier. ☐ the State will cover the costs of automated care.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

NORWAY, THE GREEN PATH

Norway, a country of 5.2 million people and one of the richest countries in the world, is trying to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and meet ambitious climate goals. Many Norwegians today are taking part in the world's most ambitious governmental effort to reduce the use of fossil fuels.

Norway has become a global model of how to get the public interested in buying electric vehicles. The country has the highest proportion of electric car registrations in the world—by a long margin. According to a recent study, 1/3 of all new car registrations were of electric vehicles.

This interest in electric cars is attracting the attention of researchers and government officials from around the world. Some people wonder if the Norwegian program is an efficient way to reduce air pollutants. And some elements of the program simply may not be possible in other countries. But for many, Norway is showing a **path** forward.

At first, it seems ironic that electric cars are so popular in a country that is one of the world's biggest producers of oil (Norway is the world's 7th largest producer of petroleum). But Norway also has many fast rivers, allowing it to generate almost all of its electricity from hydropower. As a result, Norway's electricity is clean and relatively cheap. Countries where much of the electricity is generated by power plants burning coal, like the U.S., China, or Germany, would not see as many environmental benefits from switching to electric vehicles.

Electric cars, however, are not popular in all countries with fast rivers. So what does Norway have that others don't? In a word: incentives. Norwegians pay some of the world's highest taxes, but they also receive huge benefits for buying electric cars. An electric vehicle pays no road tax or registration fee, no sales tax, and no **value-added tax**. Public parking is free; **tolls** on roads, bridges, and tunnels are free, and it is free to transport electric cars on ferries. In addition, electric cars can be charged for free at public charging points, and they can also travel in restricted bus lanes.

Those incentives are working. Electric vehicles now account for 2.5 % of all cars in Norway. After more than a decade of government support, officials had expected that there would be 50,000 electric cars on Norway's roads by the end of 2017. The government program has been even more successful than hoped: by September 2015, over 66,000 all-electric cars were in use. The American luxury car manufacturer Tesla, which only makes fully electric cars, sells approximately 30 % of its cars in Europe, and its largest European market is Norway.

Naturally, all those incentives cost a lot of money. In fact, the incentives have been so successful that some of them will be reduced in the future. Electric car owners will have to pay 50 % of the road tax starting in 2018, and all of it in 2020. Local governments can now decide if they offer free parking and free tolls. Many smaller cities have said that they will start treating electric cars like all other vehicles because they need the extra cash to repair bridges and tunnels. Free charging of electric vehicles will probably remain, however, because Norway has so much inexpensive hydroelectric power. The effect of eliminating some incentives for electric cars in Norway remains to be seen, although in Japan, electric car registrations fell by 20 % when some incentives ended. The green approach, although widely supported by Norwegians, may turn out to be too expensive, even for a rich country.

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (October 19, 2015)

path: camí / camino
value-added tax: IVA
toll: peatge / peaje

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The reason the government of Norway promotes the sale of electric cars is that it wants ☐ to support the local coal industry. ☐ to lower the levels of gas emissions. ☐ to limit petroleum and gas production. ☐ to support Norwegian companies producing electric cars.	☐	☐	☐
2. People in other countries study the evolution of the car market in Norway because ☐ there are more cars in Norway than in any other country. ☐ electric cars were only recently introduced in the country. ☐ a high percentage of electric cars are sold there. ☐ the government has decided to restrict the sale of cars.	☐	☐	☐
3. Electricity production in Norway mainly depends on ☐ coal. ☐ gas. ☐ oil. ☐ water.	☐	☐	☐
4. The effects on the climate of moving away from gasoline-fueled cars to electric cars are greater in Norway than in a country like Germany because ☐ Norway produces more oil than Germany. ☐ Norway produces cheap, clean electricity. ☐ no electric cars are made in Germany. ☐ of Norway's location.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text claims that Norway is able to provide free public charging of electric vehicles because ☐ electricity is cheap to produce in the country. ☐ electricity is produced from Norwegian gas. ☐ it is a world leader in oil production. ☐ only a very few vehicles in the country are fully electric.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following is NOT an incentive offered by the Norwegian government to buy an electric car? ☐ Free charging. ☐ Free car repairs. ☐ Free parking. ☐ Free registration.	☐	☐	☐
7. The program to promote the use of electric cars ☐ has been a failure in many ways. ☐ has succeeded beyond expectations. ☐ has had very little impact. ☐ cannot be evaluated yet.	☐	☐	☐
8. The text states that the benefits of operating an electric car in Norway ☐ will remain unchanged during the next 5 years. ☐ will be eliminated in part in the next 5 years. ☐ will be increased in the next 5 years. ☐ will depend on the production of Norwegian gas and oil.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE SECRET LIFE OF WORDS: HOW ENGLISH BECAME ENGLISH

Communication is essential to our lives, but how often do we stop to think about where the words we use have come from? Have you ever thought about which words in English have been **borrowed** from Arabic, French or Dutch? A recent book by Henry Hitchings, *The Secret Life of Words*, shows how and why English has absorbed words from more than 350 other languages, many originating from the most unlikely of places, such as *shampoo* from Hindi and *kiosk* from Turkish. Indeed, words do have a secret life, or rather a secret past. One learns things like that the English words taken from Basque are only two: *anchovy* and *Basque*. But etymology is just Hitching's starting point; he shows us that the history of our vocabulary is the history of our place in the world.

Hitchings' book covers the history of the English language from pre-Roman Britain to the latest street **slang**, though individual chapters tend to concentrate on particular cultural encounters or themes, sometimes in an extended way. A chapter called "Powwow", for instance, is an interesting account of the British early exploration of America and their encounter with its languages. A chapter called "Connoisseur" explores the 18th century's extensive relation between English and French, the rise of scientific writing, the use of Italian terms in music, and the lexicon of travel and exploration, including an account of the first confrontations of the British with Australian Aboriginal languages.

We usually talk of "borrowing" words. It is a way of describing in a simple manner a process that is very complex. Hitchings gives an intelligent account of what really happens when two languages come into contact. There is an exchange of terms; but the **breadth and depth** of that exchange is dependent upon the strength of the relationship. Long connections between two languages are likely to generate more borrowings. English, for example, has taken more words from French than from anywhere else, because the British have been engaged with French culture for a thousand years. But English has also taken a surprising amount from Native American languages, because the British settled there and, at the beginning, enjoyed fruitful relationships with the Native Americans. In contrast, English has taken next to nothing from Australian Aboriginal languages.

One of the themes of *The Secret Life of Words* is the recurring tension between those who want the language to be pure, simple and Germanic, and those who **relish** complexity and adopting new words. Hitchings points out that words only come into the language because there is a need for them, though at the same time, he thinks that "there are strong reasons for wanting a large degree of stability in our language."

Hitchings is clearly well informed on this subject. His book includes an extensive bibliography and index and many clarifying and interesting footnotes. Furthermore, the book is written in a clever, persuasive and delightful style and contains entertaining observations. All in all, *The Secret Life of Words* is an exhaustive account not only of the history of English, but also of how words witness history, reflect social change and remind us of our turbulent past.

Text adapted from *The Independent* (May 4, 2008)

borrow: manllevar / tomar prestado
slang: argot
breadth and depth: amplitud i profunditat / amplitud y profundidad
relish: gaudir / disfrutar

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Who is Henry Hitchings? ☐ The author of a very influential English grammar. ☐ An expert in the etymology of Arabic, French and Dutch. ☐ The author of a book on the history of the English language. ☐ An expert on the influence of English communication in many languages.	☐	☐	☐
2. We learn from the text that the Basque language ☐ has had a common past with the development of English. ☐ has as many borrowings from English as from French. ☐ has a difficult etymology because of its secret past. ☐ has had a minor influence on English vocabulary.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, English can be seen as a language ☐ capable of absorbing many foreign words. ☐ that is spoken by the majority in 350 countries. ☐ unable to adopt words from Hindu and Turkish. ☐ that became popular with the study of etymology.	☐	☐	☐
4. The aim of Hitchings' book is ☐ to study how "Powwow" can be useful in world explorations. ☐ to analyse the effect of borrowing on English vocabulary. ☐ to explain the difficulties of English in borrowing words of French origin. ☐ to determine the benefits of English as a language for scientific writings.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text explains that borrowings are normally the result of ☐ having many "connoisseurs" studying languages in your own country. ☐ nations wanting to impose their own language on colonized peoples. ☐ strong relationships between people speaking different languages. ☐ the love of the British for discovering remote places in the world.	☐	☐	☐
6. Hitchings argues that English can only develop if ☐ it remains pure and simple and uses words of Germanic origin. ☐ it becomes a language largely appreciated by purist grammarians. ☐ it becomes a language that proves able to accept needless words. ☐ it remains largely stable but adopts new useful words.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the author, Hitchings has written a book ☐ that is full of information but with some boring chapters. ☐ with not enough specific bibliography on its subject. ☐ which is highly specialized but enjoyable to read. ☐ that will encourage readers to learn foreign languages.	☐	☐	☐
8. The text suggests that words ☐ can be a source of knowledge about our historical past. ☐ can carry secrets that are only known to native speakers. ☐ from foreign languages should not be officially accepted. ☐ have been borrowed so that languages can have many synonyms.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

STARTING EARLY

One night, 18-year-old Ritesh Agarwal was locked out of his apartment in Delhi. It was an unfortunate minor incident that would change his life. Forced to check into a hotel, he found himself in a situation he had already experienced several times while travelling in India. "The receptionist was sleeping, electrical **sockets** did not work, the bathroom was leaking, and at the end they wouldn't let me pay by card. I felt if this was my problem, this had to be a problem for many travellers. Why can't India have a good standard of hotel rooms at a reasonable price?" he says.

Four years later, at the age of 22, Mr Agarwal is the founder and chief executive of Oyo Rooms, a network of 3,000 hotels operating in 140 cities across India, with monthly **revenues** of $3.5 million and 1,500 employees. The firm works with independent hotels to improve their **facilities** and train staff, renames them with the Oyo **brand**, and from then on takes a percentage of the hotel's revenues. The owner of the hotel benefits from a higher occupancy rate, thanks to the new brand name. As part of the business, Mr Agarwal has also developed an app, which guests can use to book rooms, get directions to the hotel and order room service.

Despite such rapid growth, he says the early days were "extremely difficult." "Nobody would believe this could be a technology business in the future," he says. But some people did believe in him. The idea won him a **fellowship** which pays for 20 teenagers to stop studying and set up a business instead. He used the money from the fellowship to start the business.

The firm launched in 2013 with just $900 a month, working with one hotel near Delhi. "I used to be the manager, engineer, receptionist, and I also delivered stuff in hotel rooms," says Mr Agarwal. "At night I would write codes to develop our app and improve our website. But at the same time I was also building strong teams because I wanted the project to grow."

The only way he could persuade investors was to show them just how bad some **budget hotels** in India were. "I took our first investor to our hotel and to other hotels where there were many problems. He saw the conviction in us and agreed we could make a difference," recalls Mr Agarwal. Now that the business has grown, it has become much easier to attract investors, including banks.

Mr Agarwal's journey from college **dropout** to business owner may seem smooth, but he admits starting a business at 17 was not easy. "Normal things like getting a bank account or hiring staff were more challenging. Some people also saw my age as a chance to take advantage, but I met some very good people, too. Overall, my experience was quite positive," he says.

He has ambitious plans for the firm, which he wants to expand abroad. Currently, his focus is on making improvements based on customer feedback and he is optimistic about expanding the company at home, saying India's increasing smartphone and internet penetration offers "huge potential."

For those keen to emulate his success, his advice—unsurprisingly—is to "start early." "Start really fast and, if you fail, you will learn and the chances of success in the next venture will increase," he says.

Text adapted from *BBC News* (September 6, 2015)

socket: endoll / enchufe
revenue: benefici / beneficio
facilities: instal·lacions / instalaciones
brand: marca
fellowship: beca
budget hotel: hotel de baix cost / hotel de bajo coste
dropout: persona que abandona els estudis / persona que abandona los estudios

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Ritesh Agarwal got the idea to start his own business ☐ when he was travelling around India. ☐ when he couldn't pay by credit card in a hotel. ☐ when he saw that travellers were having problems in India. ☐ when he couldn't enter his flat one night.	☐	☐	☐
2. Mr Agarwal's company ☐ buys and sells unbranded hotels. ☐ mainly develops apps for hotel guests. ☐ benefits from other hotels' occupancy rates. ☐ improves hotels and gives them its brand.	☐	☐	☐
3. The beginning of Oyo Rooms was difficult because ☐ few people thought this business had a future. ☐ some people thought technology was not a good business. ☐ Agarwal's fellowship demanded that he stopped studying. ☐ the money from the fellowship was not enough to start out.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which sentence is NOT true? In his first hotel, Mr Agarwal ☐ had to do all sorts of jobs. ☐ was in charge of the hotel's website and app. ☐ already had the idea to make the project big. ☐ had a team of people to work for him.	☐	☐	☐
5. The investors were convinced ☐ when they compared an Oyo hotel to other, unimproved ones. ☐ when they saw that all Indian hotels had many problems. ☐ after the banks were also interested in the project. ☐ after seeing budget hotels that were as good as the Oyo hotel.	☐	☐	☐
6. Mr Agarwal admits that ☐ he couldn't open any bank accounts in the beginning. ☐ everyone took advantage of his young age. ☐ leaving college at seventeen was easier than it might have seemed. ☐ his experiences with good people exceeded the bad ones.	☐	☐	☐
7. At present, Mr Agarwal ☐ is expanding his hotel network to other countries. ☐ pays little attention to customer feedback. ☐ is improving the potential of smartphones for his business. ☐ hopes to expand in India thanks to the wider use of the internet.	☐	☐	☐
8. His advice to other people is to start a business young because ☐ if you fail, what you learn will be useful for your next attempt. ☐ it is easier for young people to find investors to support their ideas. ☐ studying is the key to success in the business world. ☐ if you fail, you still have time to go back to school.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

ARE LOVE-LOCKS ON BRIDGES ROMANTIC OR A MENACE?

Beautiful bridges in Paris are being ruined by an epidemic of **padlocks**. But is the growing trend for love-locks a thoughtless act of vandalism, or just a harmless expression of love?

It seemed romantic when Carolyn Barnabo and Clive Roberts attached a padlock to the Pont des Arts and symbolically threw the key into the Seine. Five years later they are married and their love is still strong, but Carolyn's fondness for love-**locks** certainly isn't. "It's just out of control and I feel so bad that we contributed to it," says Carolyn. "This beautiful bridge is ruined." There were just a few love-locks on the bridge when she attached hers and posted photos on her blog. Now there are thousands on bridges all over Paris.

The locks first started appearing on bridges in Paris around 2006, shortly after young couples in Italy had begun attaching padlocks to the Ponte Milvio over Rome's river Tiber, mimicking the protagonists of a popular Italian novel. In 2007 the **mayor** of Rome introduced fines for anyone leaving a padlock on this bridge. "After Rome started forbidding the locks, couples from all over Europe came to Paris," Lorna Taylor explains. She and friend Lisa Anselmo started the No Love-Locks campaign in January 2014. "The delicate Pont des Arts, which has become a freakish mass of indistinguishable metal pieces, is now in mortal danger," Lisa Anselmo adds. They say the City of Love has now become the City of Locks, and they have counted at least eight bridges over the Seine and three over the Canal Saint Martin where padlocks have spread "like fungus." Anselmo thinks that this trend "**defaces** and damages historic structures, and it is already imposing itself on other cities around Europe, where some of the bridges involved are hundreds of years old."

The padlock supposedly symbolises a **bond** between two people in love—but local authorities are now removing some padlocks from time to time. It was only after a wall on the Pont des Arts collapsed under the weight of the locks that the Paris authorities got serious about putting an end to the practice. "Some of the **railings** have 500 kilograms of locks by the time they are removed. The one that collapsed weighed 700 kilograms. They're a costly problem for the city and also a safety one," Lorna Taylor says. Now, city officials in Paris are experimenting with panels of thick glass to protect the bridges from the damage caused by padlocks.

Described as an "epidemic" by the No Love-Locks campaign, padlocks are spreading around the world, and they are no longer restricted to bridges. Love-locks have appeared on the top of the Eiffel Tower and others can be found on fences in London. And they are not restricted to tourist destinations either—four have already appeared on St Botolph's Bridge in Boston, Lincolnshire, which only opened in February 2014. Many businesses have benefitted from this **trend**: some offer engraved padlocks in heart shapes and even one website suggests locations to attach them in Amsterdam, Chicago, Prague, Rome or Sydney. Lisa Anselmo says: "If a city wants to designate a space uniquely for love-locks, and restrict the practice on non-designated areas, that's not a bad idea. The question is how to find a way for love-locks and **heritage** to co-exist."

Despite attaching her own love lock in Paris five years ago, Carolyn now regrets that she contributed to this horrendous sight. "I would hate to see any beautiful bridges in England get like that. It was a nice idea, but I hope it dies out soon."

Text adapted from *BBC News* (May 5, 2014)

padlock, lock: cadenat / candado
mayor: alcalde
defaces (to deface): desfigurar
bond: lligam / vínculo
railing: barana / barandilla
trend: tendència, moda / tendencia, moda
heritage: patrimoni històric / patrimonio histórico

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Carolyn Barnabo and Clive Roberts left a lock on a bridge in Paris ☐ because it was a romantic thing to do. ☐ to contribute to the Parisian tradition. ☐ because they were fond of locks. ☐ in order to write an entry in a blog.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the sentences is FALSE? The custom of attaching locks on bridges ☐ was made popular by an Italian novel. ☐ is prohibited in Rome. ☐ follows an Italian tradition. ☐ was exported to Paris.	☐	☐	☐
3. The phrase "padlocks have spread like fungus" means that ☐ fungus appear on the bridges where padlocks are attached. ☐ padlocks are attached mainly on historic bridges. ☐ eight bridges over the river Seine were seriously deteriorated. ☐ padlocks have appeared in great quantities and very quickly.	☐	☐	☐
4. The municipal authorities in Paris decided to eradicate this practice ☐ after they had removed padlocks from bridges several times. ☐ when part of a historic bridge fell because of the weight of the locks. ☐ only when the eight bridges got covered by 500 kilograms of locks. ☐ when the railings of the Pont des Arts had to be removed.	☐	☐	☐
5. The city of Paris is putting panels of glass on bridges ☐ to protect the locks that are already attached. ☐ to let people see the locks more safely. ☐ to prevent the damage that the locks cause. ☐ to make an experiment on the bridges.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, padlock sellers ☐ are making profits from this epidemic. ☐ sell only heart-shaped padlocks. ☐ tell you where you must put yours. ☐ sell them only through their website.	☐	☐	☐
7. Love-locks ☐ are restricted in European cities, like Paris or London. ☐ are limited to bridges or fences. ☐ are not found in non-tourist destinations. ☐ can now be found in a variety of places.	☐	☐	☐
8. Lisa Anselmo thinks that it would be a good idea for local authorities ☐ to assign a place for people to attach their locks. ☐ to restrict love-locks anywhere in the city. ☐ to keep love-locks in historic areas. ☐ to forbid love-locks everywhere, once and for all.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

ESPERANTO AND UNIVERSAL COMMUNICATION

Today, English has no rival as an international *lingua franca*. However, things could have been different if Esperanto, an artificial language invented in 1887 by Ludwig Lazarus Zamenhof, a Jewish doctor from Bialystok (modern-day Poland but then part of the Russian Empire), had become a common language. Esperanto is made up of key structures from different linguistic families (Latinate, Germanic, Slavic and Semitic). The word *Esperanto* derives from *Doktoro Esperanto* ("Esperanto" translates as "one who hopes"), the pseudonym under which Zamenhof published the first grammar of Esperanto. Zamenhof's goal was to create an easy-to-learn, politically neutral language that would transcend nationality and encourage peace and international understanding between people with different languages.

In a letter to a friend, Zamenhof explained why he was worried about human communication: "The place where I was born and spent my childhood gave direction to all my future **struggles**. In Bialystok the inhabitants were divided into four distinct elements: Russians, Poles, Germans and Jews; each of these spoke their own language and looked on all the others as enemies. Living in such a town made me feel the misery caused by language division. The diversity of languages is the first, or at least the most influential, basis for the separation of the human family into groups of enemies. I was brought up as an idealist. I was taught that all people were brothers, while outside in the street at every step I felt that there were no people, only Russians, Poles, Germans and Jews."

In 1905, Esperanto's first international congress took place in Boulogne-sur-Mer, in France. Then, in 1920, the League of Nations (the precursor of the United Nations) recommended that its member states incorporate the language, despite **misgivings** in France, as at that time French was the dominant international tongue. However, the advent of the Second World War and Nazi expansion put an end to the possibility of the language, which was invented by a Jew, from becoming the new international *lingua franca*. Nevertheless, more than a century since Zamenhof published his first grammar enthusiasts of Esperanto continue to promote the usefulness of the tongue. "Esperanto is much easier to learn than English," says Ramon Perera, a member of the Associació Catalana d'Esperanto and a teacher of the language for the past 20 years. "Esperanto," he says, "is a fairer language because none of its speakers have an advantage over the others." Perera says that up to two years are needed to learn the language, "depending on the capabilities of each person, the hours dedicated to it and the level they want to reach."

Perera began learning the language some 38 years ago when a friend lent him a book written in Esperanto. He took a four-week intensive course, which left him captivated by the language's "simple and logical" grammar. From that moment on, he became a dedicated "Esperantist" and has since met speakers from all over Europe, something that has been aided by the advent of the Internet. "It is a language that works and that could solve the world's communication problems," he says. In fact, the French economist François Grin, in 2005, presented a report to the European Parliament that proposed adopting Esperanto as a common language in the European Union, which would save the Union 25 million euros every year. For the moment, that report has been **filed away** somewhere, but according to **estimates** by the World Esperanto Association, there are as many as two million Esperanto speakers who hope that one day their adopted language will **take root** and a new era of universal communication will begin.

Text adapted from *Catalonia Today* (October 31, 2013)

struggle: lluita / lucha
misgiving: recel / recelo
filed away (to file away): arxivar / archivar
estimate: valoració / valoración
take root (to take root): arrelar / arraigar

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Who was Doktoro Esperanto? ☐ The leader of an organization in favour of international languages. ☐ The pseudonym of a novelist of Slavic origin. ☐ The inventor of an artificial, neutral language. ☐ The title of the first published grammar of Esperanto.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, Zamenhof was ☐ an idealist in favour of international understanding. ☐ a believer in the impossibility of human dreams. ☐ an idealist in favour of translation for peaceful purposes. ☐ a believer in the benefits of speaking many languages.	☐	☐	☐
3. As a child, Zamenhof quickly realized that language division ☐ was a necessity in the Russian Empire. ☐ makes people better informed about others. ☐ makes people more sensitive to differences. ☐ creates barriers to common humanity.	☐	☐	☐
4. At the time of the first Esperanto international congress, the French were ☐ clearly against the fact that it was held in French territory. ☐ not enthusiastic about a new international language. ☐ worried about the use of French as an international language. ☐ against the use of a single language for international communication.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text implies that the Nazi regime would not favour Esperanto because ☐ Zamenhof was a poor speaker of German. ☐ it would put an end to the Second World War. ☐ it had been created by a Jewish person. ☐ it was a tool that could be used against Germany.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Ramon Perera, a good thing about Esperanto is that ☐ it was created by speakers of different cultures. ☐ it began to expand in the Russian Empire. ☐ it will make people learn other languages. ☐ it is not the language of any particular community.	☐	☐	☐
7. The French economist François Grin argued that the use of Esperanto in the EU would ☐ reduce many travelling expenses. ☐ make state members more efficient. ☐ help save a great amount of money. ☐ increase people's interest in languages.	☐	☐	☐
8. The text suggests that the European Parliament has ☐ shown little interest in the use of Esperanto. ☐ denied that there are many Esperanto speakers. ☐ said that Esperanto is a useless language. ☐ said that Esperanto could become a common language.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE LAST OF THE NOBLEST GENERATION

Harry Patch, the last survivor of the First World War, and the man who reminded the modern world of its obscene massacre, died at the age of 111. His life ended on a fine summer morning in his native Somerset, many miles from the Belgian land of Ypres where so many of his comrades fell, and where he so nearly joined them. For decades he kept the sights and sounds of that terrible experience to himself. But then, at the age of 100, he began to talk…

Born in the village of Coombe Down, Harry left school at 14 for an apprenticeship with a plumber, and would, no doubt, have lived a life of peaceful anonymity if the war hadn't been declared. Being too young at first, at the age of 17 Harry was **conscripted**. "I didn't want to go and fight anyone, but it was a case of having to," he said. He was in charge of a machine gun, and, by his 19th birthday, was in a **trench** in the middle of one of the most famous and bloodiest battles of the First World War: the Battle of Ypres. "Anyone who tells you he wasn't **scared** is a damned liar," Harry would later say. "We lived by the hour… You saw the sun rise; hopefully, you'd see it set. If you saw it set, you hoped you'd see it rise."

Many didn't. One of them was a young soldier whom Patch and his comrades found in the battlefield, badly wounded by **shrapnel**. "Shoot me," he said, and then, before Harry could react, he died with the words "Mother!" on his lips. It was but one of the phantoms from the trenches that Harry carried with him until his death. Later on, in September 1917, came the German projectile which would hit Harry. It burst among his **mates** with such force that three of them were never found again. Harry, some metres away, was seriously wounded, his stomach pierced by shrapnel. He was taken to a **CCS (casualty clearing station)**, where he lay, untreated in maddening pain, for one day and a half. Finally, a doctor came, and, with no anaesthetic, took out the metal while four men held him down. Although he would not be **demobbed** for another year, that was the end of Harry's war. He returned home, to plumbing, marriage, two sons, and an old age that saw him survive both sons and his wife.

All this time, he had kept those memories of war to himself, telling no one. But then, as he passed his 100th birthday, a journalist called Richard Emden asked Harry if he would talk of war. He agreed and he wrote, with Richard's help, his life story, and became a witness for those comrades who had been killed so many years before. When Richard Emden went to see him, Harry sat at a table in the morning room of his house. The conversation went mainly one-way. Harry's mind was sharp, and his sight good, but his voice was soft and delicate, and he was practically speechless. The journalist ended the interview before he had intended, afraid to be more of an inconvenience than he had already been.

His voice and body may have died, but his words on war should live on, resonating strongly. Harry Patch had words for all his experiences. They were spoken with an anger that lasted all his adult life. "War," he said, "is organised murder, and nothing else."

Text adapted from *The Independent* (July 26, 2009)

conscripted: cridat a files, reclutat / llamado a filas, reclutado
trench: trinxera / trinchera
scared (to be scared): tenir por / tener miedo
shrapnel: metralla
mate: company / compañero
CCS (casualty clearing station): hospital de campanya / hospital de campaña
demobbed: desmobilitzat, que ha deixat de servir a l'exèrcit / desmovilizado, que ha dejado de servir en el ejército

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following sentences about Harry Patch is FALSE? ☐ He was the only survivor of the First World War. ☐ He only explained his experiences when he was 100. ☐ He nearly died during the Battle of Ypres. ☐ He died at the age of 111 in his home country.	☐	☐	☐
2. When the First World War began, Harry Patch ☐ was too young to be called into the army. ☐ was looking forward to joining the army. ☐ had already been enrolled in the army. ☐ was ready to be enrolled but he was at school.	☐	☐	☐
3. Harry explains that during the Battle of Ypres, the soldiers were ☐ only focused on winning the battle. ☐ constantly worried about their survival. ☐ not quite aware their lives were in danger. ☐ not really worried about being killed.	☐	☐	☐
4. When Harry and his comrades found an injured soldier in the battle field ☐ they took him to the trenches for shelter. ☐ they took him still alive to a casualty clearing station. ☐ they decided to shoot him because he asked them to. ☐ they couldn't do anything to save his life.	☐	☐	☐
5. After being seriously wounded, Harry was taken to a CCS where ☐ he was operated on, after being in pain for more than one day. ☐ he was left alone in terrible pain for less than one day. ☐ he was immediately treated by a doctor. ☐ four men took out the metal without anesthetics.	☐	☐	☐
6. The war finished for Harry Patch ☐ the year after he was demobbed. ☐ several months after his recovery. ☐ immediately after being wounded. ☐ when he was sent back home.	☐	☐	☐
7. Shortly before Harry died, Richard Emden interviewed him and ☐ Harry did most of the talking. ☐ Harry spoke in a surprisingly clear voice. ☐ Richard did most of the talking. ☐ Richard was not able to talk too much.	☐	☐	☐
8. After all his experiences in the First World War ☐ Harry thought that no war could ever be justified. ☐ Harry's views on war became ambiguous. ☐ Harry chose never again to talk about war. ☐ Harry never again expressed his opinions about war.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE RIGHT TO VOTE

"Votes for women? What a ridiculous idea!" Some of the arguments that male voters used in the past to prevent women the right to vote would seem unacceptable to most of us nowadays.

However, many people would be surprised to read that the women of Switzerland received the right to vote in 1971, and yet **canton** Appenzell Innerrhoden resisted until 1991. Most male and female residents in that part of the country saw the law preventing women's **suffrage** as one of their cultural traditions, along with voting by assembly in the town square. Only after two women **filed suit** with the Swiss Federal Court was the canton forced to extend suffrage to its female residents.

Some argued that women were less intelligent than men, that their brains were smaller than men's. Others feared women would go out to campaign without asking their husbands' permission. The point was also raised for equality because, they said, "women's natural modesty would stop them going out to vote when pregnant, and since rural women have more babies than those in towns, this would give an unfair advantage to the latter." "And if women were actually elected, that would be a source of humiliation for their husbands!"

Such were the arguments that convinced Switzerland's male population to **turn down** every proposal to allow women the vote. In New Zealand women had the right to vote since 1893 and in most European countries since the end of World War I. Even though both chambers of the Swiss parliament finally gave the green light to women's suffrage in 1958, more than 50 years after Europe's pioneer Finland, when proposed to the people, two thirds of the male citizens turned parliament's recommendation down.

But it wasn't as if Swiss women had stood **idly** waiting for their rights to be given to them. Emilie Kempin-Spyri (1853-1901), Switzerland's first woman lawyer, had claimed that the article of the Federal Constitution which stated "All Swiss are equal before the law" meant that men and women had equal rights. However, this assertion was rejected by the Swiss Federal Court.

The first feminist association was established in 1868, calling for civil rights, and the right to attend university. There had been proposals to include women's suffrage in the 1874 constitution. In 1929 a petition for voting rights managed to collect a quarter of a million signatures—but it was ignored.

Switzerland's system of direct democracy, which gave voters the final say on legislation, ironically kept women out. However, the extensive autonomy of even the smallest administrative units gave them their chance to **break in** to political life. It was a tiny commune in Canton Valais that, in 1957, was the first to allow its women members to vote. Several cantons gradually followed and in the 1960s women started occupying more and more important positions in local parliaments and governments. In 1968 Geneva, then the country's third largest city, had a woman mayor—but she still couldn't vote in federal elections.

When the human rights convention of the Council of Europe was signed, Switzerland remained out of those parts that call for sexual equality. The protest this provoked forced the government to revise its position and a new referendum was put to the country.

The result: on February 7th 1971 Swiss males finally gave their female compatriots the full federal voting rights by a two thirds majority. The official results showed 621,403 of the all-male electorate supported the vote for women and 323,596 were against.

Text adapted from *Swissworld.org*

canton: One of the several states which form the Swiss Confederation.
suffrage: vot / voto
filed suit (to file suit): demandar, portar a judici / demandar, llevar a juicio
turn down (to turn down): rebutjar / rechazar
idly: inactiu / inactivo
break in (to break in): entrar, introduir-se /entrar, introducirse

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Women in Switzerland got their right to vote ☐ when female residents were accepted by assembly. ☐ thanks to two women who took legal action for it. ☐ as part of their traditional rights. ☐ before canton Appenzell Innerrhoden accepted it.	☐	☐	☐
2. In the text, which of these arguments for not giving women the right to vote is FALSE? ☐ Women were considered less intelligent than men. ☐ Women in rural areas had more advantages than urban women. ☐ Pregnant women would be too shy to go out to vote. ☐ Men feared they would lose their control over women.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, when the Swiss parliament proposed to pass the vote for women in 1958, ☐ the majority of male voters rejected it. ☐ all European countries had already given it the green light. ☐ only women in Finland had the right to vote. ☐ the arguments were not convincing at all.	☐	☐	☐
4. The text explains that Swiss women ☐ had never become involved in political action before 1991. ☐ were peacefully waiting for their rights to be granted to them. ☐ had been fighting for their rights since the nineteenth century. ☐ ignored the quarter million signatures petition for votes in 1929.	☐	☐	☐
5. Although Switzerland's system of direct democracy kept women out of their right to vote in federal elections, ☐ women started taking political posts in local government in the 1960s. ☐ some small communities allowed women extensive autonomy. ☐ most cantons always resisted the legislation. ☐ in 1968 Geneva gave the first woman mayor the chance to vote.	☐	☐	☐
6. At the human rights Convention of the Council of Europe, Switzerland ☐ demanded governments to change their position on equal vote. ☐ called on a referendum on equal vote in Europe. ☐ suggested to revise those parts on sexual equality. ☐ refused to sign the parts on sexual equality.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Emilie Kempin-Spyri, the Swiss Federal Constitution ☐ should give more rights to women. ☐ gave equal rights to both men and women. ☐ needed an article on equal rights. ☐ rejected her proposals before the Federal Court.	☐	☐	☐
8. Swiss women finally gained full right to federal vote ☐ in spite of the criticism of the Federal Court. ☐ thanks to the claims of the first woman lawyer, Emilie Kempin-Spyri. ☐ when 50 % of male voters signed a petition. ☐ in the 1971 referendum, with more than 50 % of male voters.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

WHY BILINGUALS ARE SMARTER

Speaking two languages has obvious practical benefits in an increasingly globalized world. But in recent years, scientists have begun to show that the advantages of bilingualism are even more fundamental than being able to converse with a wider range of people. Being bilingual, it turns out, makes you smarter. It can have a profound effect on your brain, improving cognitive skills not related to language and even protecting against dementia in old age.

This view of bilingualism is remarkably different from the one through much of the 20th century. Researchers and educators used to consider that a second language was an interference that **hindered** a child's academic and intellectual development. They were not wrong: there is ample evidence that in a bilingual's brain both language systems are active even when only one language is being used, therefore creating situations in which one system obstructs the other. But this interference, researchers are finding out, isn't so much a **handicap** as an advantage. It forces the brain to resolve internal conflict, making the mind strengthen its cognitive muscles.

Bilinguals, for instance, seem to be better than monolinguals at solving certain kinds of mental puzzles. In a 2004 study by the psychologists Ellen Bialystok and Michelle Martin-Rhee, bilingual and monolingual preschoolers were asked to **sort** blue circles and red squares presented on a computer screen into two digital boxes—one marked with a blue square and the other marked with a red circle. In the first task, the children had to sort the shapes by colour, placing blue circles in the box marked with the blue square and red squares in the box marked with the red circle. Both groups did this with similar easiness. Next, the children were asked to sort by shape, which was more challenging because it required placing the images in a box marked with a different colour. The bilinguals were quicker at performing this task.

The evidence from such studies suggests that the bilingual experience improves the brain's executive function—a command system that directs the processes that we use for planning, solving problems and doing other mentally demanding tasks. These processes include avoiding distractions, **switching** attention from one thing to another and holding information in mind—like remembering a sequence of directions while driving.

The main difference between bilinguals and monolinguals may be more basic: an increased ability to **monitor** the environment. "Bilinguals have to switch languages quite often—you may talk to your father in one language and to your mother in another," says Albert Costa, a researcher at the Pompeu Fabra University in Spain. "This requires observing changes around you in the same way that we monitor our surroundings when driving." In a study comparing German-Italian bilinguals with Italian monolinguals on monitoring tasks, Mr Costa found that the bilingual speakers did them better and needed less brain activity, indicating that they were more efficient.

The bilingual experience appears to influence the brain from infancy to old age. In a recent study of 44 elderly Spanish-English bilinguals, scientists directed by the neuropsychologist Tamar Gollan of the University of California, San Diego, found that individuals with a higher degree of bilingualism were more resistant than others to the **onset** of dementia and other symptoms of Alzheimer's disease and developed them later.

Nobody ever doubted the power of language. But who could imagine that the words we hear and the sentences we speak might have such a big influence?

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (March 17, 2012)

hindered (to hinder): entorpir / entorpecer
handicap: desavantatge / desventaja
sort (to sort): classificar /clasificar
switch (to switch): canviar / cambiar
monitor (to monitor): observar, controlar
onset: començament / inicio

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Recent scientific studies have proved that bilingual people ☐ obtain greater benefits in today's world. ☐ are better conversationalists. ☐ have better cognitive skills than monolinguals. ☐ will not suffer from mental diseases in old age.	☐	☐	☐
2. As opposed to the 20th century view, we now know that ☐ bilingual children had more learning advantages in the past. ☐ when two languages interfere, they cause many disadvantages. ☐ language interference is good because it makes the mind stronger. ☐ the brain of bilingual people is obstructed more easily.	☐	☐	☐
3. In the first part of a study by Bialystok and Martin-Rhee, both mono and bilingual kids ☐ had difficulty in classifying the colours in the corresponding circle. ☐ found it similarly easy to classify the figures according to colour. ☐ had problems using the computer. ☐ put circles and squares together in the same box.	☐	☐	☐
4. In the second part of the study, which was more difficult, ☐ bilingual kids were faster at solving the problem. ☐ there was no difference between the performance of mono and bilingual kids. ☐ monolingual kids could not classify the figures according to shape. ☐ both groups of kids encountered the same difficulties.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to the text, which one of the following tasks is NOT carried out by the brain's executive function? ☐ Making plans and decisions. ☐ Retaining a sequence of information. ☐ Giving directions to people who drive. ☐ Changing your focus of attention.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Albert Costa, changing from one language to another all the time ☐ makes you observe the changes around you. ☐ may improve your driving skills. ☐ allows you to talk to your father and mother in different languages. ☐ makes you quicker at changing the things around you.	☐	☐	☐
7. In Mr Costa's study, ☐ German-Italian bilinguals required more brain activity on their monitoring tasks. ☐ Italian monolinguals were not as active as German-Italian bilinguals. ☐ Italian monolinguals got better results in their monitoring tasks. ☐ German-Italian bilinguals did their monitoring tasks better and more efficiently.	☐	☐	☐
8. A study at the University of California revealed that ☐ monolinguals suffer from more mental illnesses like dementia. ☐ bilinguals developed some mental diseases at a more advanced age. ☐ Alzheimer's disease is more resistant in monolingual people. ☐ some people were more resistant to bilingualism than others.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió escrita ☐

THE TEACHER WHO CHANGED MY LIFE

A fortnight ago I heard that the English master who taught me at school, the great Frank Miles, had died, aged 92. Although he was a teaching giant and recognised as such by former pupils and colleagues, there is just a brief mention of him on the Internet. That is exactly as he would have wanted it: modern communication methods were not for him. He only just tolerated the telephone; a telephone which rang at an inopportune moment, such as when he was marking essays or exam papers, could easily be thrown out of the window.

But when he was teaching, Frank made his inflexible views extremely plain. The classroom was his theatre. In physical presence he was quite **slight**. But to a boy of my age his reputation made him seem several times life-size. That reputation alone was enough to cause fear into the lazy and **quell** the uncontrollable. He didn't have to do anything to keep order. Lessons would begin with what a friend has described as a "ferocious, almost neurotic intensity." They could also be very funny, as long as the class was performing to the highest level.

Frank's critical remarks were annihilating. After the first homework our class ever did for him, Frank judged the standard so poor throughout the entire class that he **tore** up every incorrect composition and threw it in the bin. All except one, and I **blush** to write that the piece saved was mine. It would have been much better for me if someone else's homework had been picked.

He was highly intolerant of those who disagreed with him. By today's standards he was deeply politically incorrect and had little time for rules and regulations. In fact, in the modern bureaucratic world he would be considered a problematic teacher.

Yet he was a truly inspirational teacher who held his class in focused attention. Because, above all, he had a complete passion not only for his subject but also for education. What was most important to him was his pupils' intellectual understanding of English, and he was not afraid to reprimand them when they were failing to reach his high standards. Frank would have taught anyone who showed a **spark** of aptitude for his subject as he was determined to raise standards. He was particularly pleased when a boy who had previously had a low level could achieve spectacular results.

He was quite a peculiar man. His **mannerisms** and language lent themselves so well to imitation that the image of boys pretending to be Frank is sometimes more vivid than the memory of Frank himself.

In the restaurant, after the funeral service, we discussed the never-ending question: who was Frank? He once told me how lucky I was to come from a loving family. He had not got on with his father. Other than that, his childhood was to us a complete blank, as was his emotional life.

He lived for his pupils; if other relationships had once existed, nobody knew about them. Although he detested snobbery and money, he could be considered an elitist—but only in the sense that he expected the best from every boy he taught, whatever their background or potential.

I was lucky to come under the eyes of a classroom colossus. Sadly, Frank did not find relationships outside the classroom easy. He became a recluse in his last decade and died in a basic flat. And the tragedy is that I never told him how much he had influenced my life—and that of many others.

Text adapted from the *Daily Mail* (July 16, 2013)

slight: menut, prim / menudo, delgado
quell (to quell): apaivagar, calmar / apaciguar, calmar
tore (to tear): estripar / romper
blush (to blush): ruboritzar-se / sonrojarse
spark: espurna, mica / chispa, pizca
mannerism: peculiaritat, gest d'expressió / peculiaridad, gesto de expresión

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The author of the text knew about the death of Frank Miles ☐ a long time ago. ☐ through a phone call. ☐ from his colleagues. ☐ quite recently.	☐	☐	☐
2. The author also states that information about Frank Miles ☐ can be found on most educational websites. ☐ was widely spread on the Internet. ☐ was not available on the Internet. ☐ was hardly mentioned on the Internet.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, Frank Miles calmed his rebellious students thanks ☐ to his physical appearance. ☐ to his good manners. ☐ to his weak character. ☐ to his strong personality.	☐	☐	☐
4. Frank's classes could be very funny ☐ provided the students were at their best. ☐ only when the students behaved correctly. ☐ provided the students did their homework. ☐ as long as the students paid attention.	☐	☐	☐
5. The author thinks that Frank Miles was a remarkable teacher because ☐ he had an intellectual understanding of English. ☐ he was passionate about educational values. ☐ he never reprimanded his rebellious pupils. ☐ he had little interest in raising his students' results.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, which of the following statements about Frank Miles' character is TRUE? ☐ He had a passion for rules and regulations. ☐ He tolerated diversity of opinion. ☐ He was intolerant with his students' low standards. ☐ His students were never frightened by his criticism.	☐	☐	☐
7. The author considered Frank Miles elitist because he ☐ fancied money and snobbery. ☐ ignored rebellious students. ☐ had particular mannierisms. ☐ demanded the best from his pupils.	☐	☐	☐
8. During his last decade, Frank Miles lived ☐ surrounded by his ex-pupils. ☐ alone in his wealthy house. ☐ on his own in a modest apartment. ☐ in a hostel for the homeless.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

HOW CHINA IS WINNING THE SCHOOL RACE

China's education performance—at least in cities such as Shanghai and Hong Kong—is as spectacular as the country's rapid economic expansion, surpassing many more advanced countries. But what is behind this success?

Surprise came when the results of the **OECD**'s international maths, science and reading tests —the 2009 **PISA** tests—were published. Shanghai, taking part for the first time, came top in all three subjects. Meanwhile, Hong Kong, which did well in the last decade, has gone from good to great. In this global ranking, it came fourth in reading, second in maths and third in science. These two Chinese cities **outstripped** leading education systems around the world. The results for Beijing are not quite as spectacular. "But they are still high," says Andreas Schleicher, the OECD's head of education statistics.

Cheng Kai-Ming, Professor of Education at Hong Kong University, attributes the results to "a devotion to education not shared by other cultures." More than 80 % of Shanghai's older secondary students attend after-school tutoring. They may spend another three to four hours each day on homework under close parental supervision. Such dedication also reflects the ferociously competitive university entrance examinations. Prof. Cheng says Chinese parents are definitely devoted to their children's education.

Certainly these two open and dynamic cities regard as valuable to adopt the best educational practices from around the world to **ensure** success. Under the slogan "First class city, first class education", Shanghai re-equipped classrooms, **upgraded** schools and revised the curriculum in the last decade. Teachers were trained in more interactive methodology and computers were brought in. The city's schools are now a model for the country. About 80 % of Shanghai school leavers go to university compared to an average of 24 % in China.

Last year Shanghai claimed to be the first Chinese city to provide free schooling for all migrant children. Shanghai controls who lives and works in the city, allowing only the best and the brightest students to become residents with access to jobs and schools. "For over 50 years Shanghai has been accumulating talent, the cream of the cream in China. That gives it an incredible advantage," says Ruth Heyhoe, former head of the Chinese Institute of Education.

Meanwhile, Hong Kong was forced into educational improvements when its industries moved to cheaper Chinese areas in the 1990s. To continue being a service centre for China, the city had to upgrade knowledge and skills. In the last decade Hong Kong has concentrated on raising the level for all students, and today Hong Kong's education system is rated among the best in the world. "If we want to have high **achievement**, we need experts in secondary schools," said Catherine Chan, secretary for education in the Hong Kong government. Teachers are selected from the top 30 % of the university graduates. By contrast, according to the OECD, the US selects from the bottom third. In Hong Kong, over one-fifth of government money is spent on education every year.

Both Hong Kong and Shanghai are changing their educational models and no-one knows how this will result in terms of quality. However, they believe they are moving in the right direction. Their societies are changing rapidly and for both cities, reaching the top might be easier than staying there.

Text adapted from *BBC News* [on line].
<http://www.bbc.co.uk/news>

OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development): OCDE
PISA (Programme for International Student Assessment)
outstrip: deixar enrere / dejar atrás
ensure: assegurar / asegurar
upgrade: modernitzar, millorar / modernizar, mejorar
achievement: assoliment, èxit / consecución, éxito

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The results of the 2009 PISA tests in Hong Kong and Shanghai were ☐ much better than cities in other countries. ☐ as spectacular as those in other countries. ☐ not as good as was expected. ☐ good, but not great.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, which of the following statements is FALSE? ☐ Chinese parents supervise their children's schoolwork very closely. ☐ Education is a very important issue for Chinese parents. ☐ All Chinese secondary students take extra after-school lessons. ☐ Chinese students spend most of their afternoons doing homework.	☐	☐	☐
3. In order to get better results in education, both Shanghai and Hong Kong ☐ will become open and dynamic. ☐ want to copy successful education systems from other countries. ☐ will continue with their own successful education practices. ☐ want the best educators in the world.	☐	☐	☐
4. The slogan "First class city, first class education" suggests that ☐ only people from the higher classes can get an education. ☐ to get an education, first you must go to class. ☐ they want to offer the best education to its citizens. ☐ in this city, everybody must get an education.	☐	☐	☐
5. In the last ten years, Shanghai has ☐ not done much to modernise its school system. ☐ started a teacher training program. ☐ introduced computers into schools. ☐ had 80 % of people who leave school.	☐	☐	☐
6. Shanghai ☐ has allowed immigrants to go to school for over fifty years. ☐ is the Chinese city with most migrant students. ☐ has no control over who lives and works there. ☐ only gives residence permit to the best students.	☐	☐	☐
7. Hong Kong had to make improvements in education ☐ because its industries were a service centre for China. ☐ to continue playing an important part in Chinese economy. ☐ because China was just as expensive and the industry moved there. ☐ when China upgraded its industry in the 1990s.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the OECD, in ☐ Hong Kong, 30 % of university students become teachers. ☐ Hong Kong, only the best university students may become teachers. ☐ the USA, one third of the best university students become teachers. ☐ the USA, the bottom university students will never be teachers.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

WHY KIDS BULLY: BECAUSE THEY'RE POPULAR

Mothers tell their children that **mean** kids behave that way because they have unhappy home lives, feel inadequate, or don't have enough friends; or because they lack empathy. But a new study suggests some mean kids actually behave that way simply because they can. It has now been proved that the more popular a kid becomes, the more central to the social network of the school, the more aggressive the behaviour he or she **engages** in. At least, that was the case in North Carolina, where students from 19 middle and high schools were studied for 5 years by researchers at the University of California-Davis.

Authors Robert Faris and Diane Felmlee interviewed public-school kids seven times over the course of their study, starting when the students were in grades 6, 7 and 8. They asked the students to say who their friends were and used the data to create friendship maps. They then asked the kids who was unkind to them and whether they bullied anyone. Researchers then tried to determine the pathways of aggression. What they found was that only one-third of the students engaged in any bullying at all — physical force, insults or spreading gossip — but those who were becoming more popular in the school bullied more. Only when kids reached the very top 2 % of the school's social **hierarchy** or fell into the bottom 2 % did their behavior change; these kids were the least aggressive. "Seemingly normal well-adjusted kids can be aggressive," says Faris, whose results are published in the *American Sociological Review*. "We found that school status increases aggression."

Although authors do not discard psychological or background influences as **underlying** causes of bullying, they believe that popularity is at least as important. "It's one of the few times I can remember in social sciences where race and family background seem to make very little difference," says Faris. "Those demographic and socioeconomic factors don't seem to matter as much as where the kids are in the school hierarchy in terms of their popularity." Faris also found that kids who cared more about popularity, were more aggressive. Surprisingly, though, hostile behavior did not make them more popular. "The evidence suggests that aggression does not increase status," he says. Then again, bullying works mostly because kids believe it does.

Another stereotype the study destroyed was that males and females bully differently. Boys spread gossip less often than girls did. And girls were less physically violent to each other than boys were. Gender-on-gender bullying was more **prevalent** among girls than boys, but boys were more likely to be hostile toward girls than the other way around. However, gender wasn't entirely a neutral factor. If a girl knew a lot of boys, or a boy knew a lot of girls at a school where there wasn't much mixing of the sexes, those kids' popularity would go up, presumably because they provided a bridge to contact with potential dates. And, yes, the "gender-bridge" kids, as the study called them, seemed to be more aggressive than others.

If bullying is actually more a result of school hierarchy than of psychology, Faris believes there might be a more effective solution than trying to change the behavior of the bullies. "The majority of kids who witness bullying, either do not oppose it or encourage it," says Faris. "Those are the ones who give these kids their status. We need to change their minds."

Text adapted from *Time* (February 8, 2011)

mean: mesquí / mezquino
engage: involucrar
hierarchy: jerarquia / jerarquía
underlying: fonamental /fundamental
prevalent: freqüent / frecuente

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to the text, mean kids behave that way ☐ because mothers do not prevent them to do so. ☐ as a result of the pressure of other students. ☐ for no apparent reason, just because it is accepted. ☐ as a consequence of their empathy with their friends.	☐	☐	☐
2. The text argues that aggression at school ☐ increases with the kids' popularity. ☐ increases when the kid is involved in the school hierarchy. ☐ is insignificant among popular kids. ☐ depends on the school's social network.	☐	☐	☐
3. Faris and Felmlee's research to determine the pathways of aggression revealed that ☐ in principle any kid may become a bully. ☐ physical force, insults or spreading gossip are the only forms of bullying. ☐ kids who were in the bottom 2 % of the school hierarchy inevitably become bullies. ☐ reaching the top 2 % of the school hierarchy conditioned kids towards bullying.	☐	☐	☐
4. Faris and Felmlee also argue that ☐ popularity is the only determining factor in bullying. ☐ race and family background are strongly determining factors in bullying. ☐ psychological or background influences are also relevant when considering bullying. ☐ demographic and socioeconomic factors condition the school hierarchy.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to the text, hostile behaviour ☐ increases the status of the kid at school. ☐ works mostly because kids like bullying. ☐ makes kids more popular at school. ☐ does not imply a rise in popularity.	☐	☐	☐
6. The study found out that both boys and girls bully, but the difference is that ☐ girls prefer bullying boys rather than the other way round. ☐ boys clearly spread more gossip than girls do. ☐ bullying was clearly more violent among boys than among girls. ☐ bullying was more frequent between girls than the other way round.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which one of the following statements is TRUE? According to the study, "gender-bridge" kids ☐ tended to be more aggressive than other students. ☐ are kids that have more dates than others. ☐ are very popular because they bully the rest. ☐ prove that gender is a neutral factor when considering bullying.	☐	☐	☐
8. All in all, Faris argues that the solution to bullying ☐ is to change the behaviour of the bullies. ☐ lies in changing the minds of the majority of kids at school. ☐ is to encourage opposition againts the bullies. ☐ lies in introducing changes in the school hierarchy.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

NOMOPHOBIA: THE BIGGEST PHOBIA IN THE WORLD?

We use mobile phones every day, but for a growing number of people staying connected is an obsession.

According to a study carried out in 2012 by SecurEnvoy, a company that deals in mobile phone technology, Nomophobia (as in "No Mobile phone phobia", that is, the **fear** of being apart from your cell phone) is rising. Out of those surveyed, 66 percent said they have it. That number has gone up from a similar study carried out four years ago, in which 53 percent of people admitted they were afraid of losing their cell phones.

In the 2012 survey, SecurEnvoy **polled** 1,000 people about their mobile phone usage and found that 41 percent of people surveyed said they have more than one cell phone, an indication that fear of going without a cell phone is the real deal. The **poll** also found that nomophobia affects women more than men (70 percent of women surveyed compared to 61 percent of men). "We may draw the conclusion that, perhaps because 47 percent of men have two phones, they're less likely to **misplace** both and therefore be left phone-less," said Andy Kemshall, SecurEnvoy co-founder.

Nomophobia crosses all ethnic and social barriers, but researchers say young people are more likely to be addicted: 18-24 year-olds are the most nomophobic (77 %), followed by 25-34 year-olds (68 %). Perhaps a little more surprising is that the third most nomophobic are 55 and over!

The study also found that people check their phones, on average, 34 times a day. For Karla Campos, who owns a web services company, that's nothing. She says she checks her phone usually 50 times per day, and even sleeps with it: "Before I go to sleep, I put it under my pillow." She also uses the phone to communicate with her 10-year-old son, but not necessarily when they are apart. She says their conversations are deeper on the phone, or through Facebook. Campos argues that this form of communication is better than none at all, and thinks the cell phone connects her family.

Dr. Mitch Spero, a child and family psychologist, disagrees, "I recommend keeping your mobile phone there for emergencies, but when you're with someone, make them the priority in your life." He says it's common to see problems arise because of mobile phone use. "Cell phones should be used to improve our lives," he warned, "not to destroy our interpersonal communication skills with those that we love."

Kemshall found another interesting revelation: nearly half of the people surveyed by SecurEnvoy said they would be upset if their messages were viewed by their partner, and yet only a few take security measures to keep them private. "With 58 percent of the **respondents** using at least one **device** for business use, this lack of security is a worrying trend that needs addressing," said Kemshall.

"What this study does reveal though," adds Kemshall, "is how much people now depend on their mobile phones. As people are increasingly connected, nomophobia will continue to rise, with millions of people needing to have their phones on them, and on at all times."

Wondering if you have Nomophobia? The symptoms include: having multiple phones, constantly **topping up** your battery life, compulsively checking your phone for missed calls or messages, worrying about losing it even when it's in a safe place, never turning it off, using it in inappropriate places and feeling panic and anxiety when separated from it.

Text adapted from *RedOrbit.com* (May 9, 2012)

fear: por / miedo
to poll: enquestar / encuestar
poll: enquesta / encuesta
misplace: perdre, extraviar / perder, extraviar
respondent: enquestat / encuestado
device: aparell /aparato
top up: carregar completament / cargar por completo

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Comparing the 2008 and the 2012 surveys, we see that ☐ more people are afraid now of being without their mobile phone. ☐ in 2008 the number of nomophobes was similar to this year. ☐ in 2008 more people feared being without their mobile phones. ☐ in 2012 the number of nomophobes did not increase.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, more women suffer from nomophobia probably because ☐ a big percentage of men have two phones. ☐ all men have two phones. ☐ women usually have two phones. ☐ women easily misplace their phones.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which sentence is FALSE, according to the text? ☐ One third of people older than fifty-five are nomophobic. ☐ Nomophobia affects people of all ages, races and social classes. ☐ Those who are fifty-five or older are the third most affected age group. ☐ Young adults are the most nomophobic.	☐	☐	☐
4. Karla Campos ☐ talks to her son on the phone even when they are together. ☐ has better communication with her family on the phone. ☐ connects her family via mobile phone. ☐ only communicates with her son through Facebook.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to Dr Spero, ☐ we should make mobile phones a priority in our life. ☐ we should only use mobile phones in case of emergency. ☐ we should prioritise people over mobile phones. ☐ cell phones destroy communication with our loved ones.	☐	☐	☐
6. Kemshall says that security in mobile phones needs to be improved because ☐ lots of people use a phone for business purposes. ☐ nobody likes having their messages viewed by others. ☐ security measures don't help keep messages private. ☐ business people often view other people's messages.	☐	☐	☐
7. This study shows that ☐ there will be lots more nomophobes in the future. ☐ we don't know how many people depend on their phones. ☐ almost everybody will need to carry a phone in the future. ☐ it is necessary to have our mobiles constantly on, these days.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following may indicate nomophobia? ☐ Charging the phone's battery all the time. ☐ Worrying about having just one mobile phone. ☐ Having many missed calls and messages. ☐ Putting the phones in a safe place.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE DAY I MET THE STRANGE AND INSCRUTABLE STEVE JOBS

One morning in Paris six years ago, I found myself sitting opposite Steve Jobs. I was feeling really excited, as getting an interview with Jobs had become an obsession. In recent years, particularly since his health had declined, he had rarely talked directly to the media. But then, one day I got the news: I'd been given an interview.

Over the years I'd built up a vague impression of what I could expect: there were stories about the notorious "**flamethrower** treatment" that he would give to anyone who made a mistake. Beyond this, I expected him to be something like the other captains of industry that I had come across, with magnetic personalities and enormous presence.

However, the reality turned out to be very different. The interview took place at Apple's Paris Expo, an exhibition of the company's latest technology. Once he had finished taking questions from the media I was asked to accompany him on a walk around the Expo. Like everything else in Jobs' life, the program was meant to be strictly managed: a quick turn around the **show floor**, and then downstairs to his temporary office for our interview. But as soon as Jobs began his walk, a wild group of Apple fans suddenly appeared, shouting his name and surrounding us. Jobs visibly **shrank** as they approached. His bodyguards quickly took him downstairs. A public relations officer invited me to follow him. Suddenly I was in a room with the man I'd been running after for years. But it wasn't what I expected at all. Yes, the man sitting in front of me looked like the Steve Jobs I knew. But the Steve Jobs I was used to seeing was always in command, always in control, when launching new products. This one, however, seemed frightened and a little confused.

We had half an hour scheduled to talk. I kept looking up at the clock. His assistant indicated that he still needed time to **settle**. Clearly disturbed by his brief encounter with the real world, he came to sit opposite me and adopted a defensive posture. Although we talked for 30 minutes, it wasn't a fluent and easy conversation. He spent too much of his time avoiding questions that he felt were inappropriate. I asked him about Apple's environmental policy, which had received some criticism recently. He rejected the **claim** that Apple's products were less green than its rivals with the same argument that he had always used in press conferences. When I pushed for more details he simply refused to go any further.

I mentioned his health. It was a year after he had had a pancreatic cancer operation, and it seemed that he had beaten the disease successfully. He refused to give me any details about it. For most of my time with him, it seemed he just wasn't mentally in the room. My presence seemed to be another reminder that not everything could be controlled.

This was, after all, a man whose life was so carefully organized that he rarely had to do anything that he didn't want to. He used to spend most of his life in or around Apple's headquarters in Silicon Valley. He followed a strict routine. He was so used to getting his way that when his cancer first appeared he tried to beat it simply through focusing on a diet of fruit and vegetables. It didn't work.

All in all, I was supposed to have just met the most attractive character that the business world has seen in decades. In person, Steve Jobs turned out to be the most inscrutable and peculiar **entrepreneur** I'd ever interviewed.

Text adapted from *The Times* (August 27, 2011)

flamethrower: llençaflames (en el text, abrupte, brusc) / lanzallamas (en el texto, abrupto, brusco)
show floor: pavelló firal / pabellón ferial
shrank: encongir-se / encogerse
settle: calmar-se / calmarse
claim: acusació / acusación
entrepreneur: empresari / empresario

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The narrator felt excited about having an interview with Steve Jobs because… ☐ Steve Jobs had been a myth for him. ☐ Steve Jobs refused to talk to the media. ☐ Steve Jobs never used to grant interviews in Paris. ☐ Steve Jobs hardly ever granted interviews.	☐	☐	☐
2. When the narrator talks about "the notorious flamethrower treatment", he means that… ☐ Jobs was a very strict person. ☐ Jobs was a very magnetic person. ☐ Jobs worked very hard every day. ☐ Jobs was obsessed about the computer world.	☐	☐	☐
3. When the narrator was going to interview Jobs, he found… ☐ him quite different from what he had expected. ☐ him very similar to what he had expected. ☐ him ready to have a long talk. ☐ out that Jobs was not going to answer any questions.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to the text, Jobs adopted a defensive posture because he was… ☐ angry with the interviewer. ☐ not feeling comfortable in Paris. ☐ still influenced by the incident with the fans. ☐ afraid of the interviewer.	☐	☐	☐
5. When asked about Apple's environmental policies… ☐ Jobs refused to answer the question, as he usually did. ☐ Jobs simply repeated the same explanation he always gave. ☐ Jobs answered that the question was inappropriate. ☐ Jobs gave a new point of view about the topic.	☐	☐	☐
6. When the narrator mentioned his health Jobs… ☐ answered that he had beaten his disease successfully. ☐ said that he had had a cancer operation. ☐ gave a short answer with no more details. ☐ simply did not answer.	☐	☐	☐
7. In his everyday life, Steve Jobs… ☐ followed a well-established routine. ☐ did not follow a rigorous routine. ☐ used to spend his time working in his office. ☐ was constantly travelling to sell his products.	☐	☐	☐
8. By defining Steve Jobs as "inscrutable and peculiar", the narrator means that Jobs was… ☐ a hard-working person. ☐ a model for the business world. ☐ a genius of this century. ☐ difficult to define.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

DEATH SITES: HOW TO LOG IN YOUR AFTERLIFE

Lately a lot of websites (*legacylocker.com, gonetoosoon.org, Deathswitch.com…*) have **sprung up** offering to help users to solve a particular modern problem: what happens to your web presence when you die? In the past, a person's legacy used to include a collection of letters and other personal papers; now it is more likely to include thousands of e-mails, tweets, blogs and online records.

The average internet user, with online banking facilities, Facebook and Twitter profiles, and internet based photos, blogs and e-mail accounts can now receive help in order to prepare "their **posthumous** online footprint". The new sites promise to store safely data such as e-mail account passwords, online banking codes and "goodbye videos" to be sent only to nominated friends or relatives in the event of a death.

These websites require that customers either pay an annual fee or buy a "lifetime membership" to keep the information, which is stored in new online legacy **depositories**. After a death, the online archive is opened by beneficiaries exclusively. These websites have many ways of certifying the death of their users: The *Deathswitch* website sends out regular e-mails to check that users are still alive. If a series of messages receive no response, the site contracts qualified people (or experts) called "verifiers" that make sure that the missing person is dead, before making his/her stored information available.

Facebook website now offers a "memorial status" where **deceased** former users have their profiles free from features such as accepting new friend's requests, and only previously accepted friends can see the profile. But it remains open to posts from **mourning** friends.

Neither Facebook nor e-mail providers such as Microsoft Hotmail and Google Gmail will give out the passwords of deceased former users. But Microsoft will provide authentic relatives with a CD of the late user's e-mails; and Gmail allows close relatives access only to specific messages in a deceased person's account. For that matter, relatives must provide copies of a death certificate, details of the content of the e-mails required and proof of legal right to access.

The American businessman Jeremy Toeman set up *Legacy Locker*, which is a website that promises to pass on "digital property" after death. Mr Toeman defines his website as a safe **depository** for vital digital property that allows access to online accounts for accepted friends and close relatives in the event of death. The idea occurred to him after his grandmother died. "I tried to get into her Hotmail account, as I wanted to contact people to let them know" said Mr Toeman. "But I couldn't gain access".

Responses to the new "death sites" are split. John Kay, 68, is a Facebook user but confesses that he wouldn't **sign up** to a death service because he doesn't keep anything confidential online. However, Stephen Marcus, 23, said: "I don't mind people looking through my e-mails or Facebook when I die. And I'm seriously thinking about the idea of a posthumous video. It could be a nice gesture."

In the end, all these sites are just trying to do us a pretty good favour, that is, they are likely to solve one of the most important mysteries in the history of humanity: how to be eternal.

Text adapted from *The Times*

sprung up: sorgir / surgir
posthumous: pòstum / póstumo
depository: magatzem virtual / almacén virtual
deceased: difunt / difunto
mourning: dol, aflicció / luto, aflicción
sign up: registrar-se / registrarse

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The main topic of the text is about websites that…	☐	☐	☐
☐ delete your personal online data when you die.			
☐ organise your personal letters and personal documents.			
☐ help you to die in case you ask for it.			
☐ keep your online profiles safe after your death.			
2. According to the text, a "posthumous online footprint" is…	☐	☐	☐
☐ a funeral service that can be downloaded from the internet.			
☐ an online message that your friends can send you when you die.			
☐ any kind of personal online information that is kept after your death.			
☐ a series of acts dedicated to honour your memory when you die.			
3. When a user of one of these websites dies…	☐	☐	☐
☐ all the user's archives are destroyed.			
☐ the user's beneficiaries can access his/her online profiles.			
☐ the website communicates the user's close friends the tragic ending.			
☐ the website page of the dead user is removed.			
4. A "verifier"…	☐	☐	☐
☐ is sent by the website to certify the user's death.			
☐ keeps all the user's data after the funeral.			
☐ makes sure that the user's annual fee is paid after the death.			
☐ downloads all the user's profiles to the legal beneficiaries.			
5. A "memorial status" is a web service that…	☐	☐	☐
☐ keeps your profiles updated daily after your death.			
☐ allows anyone free access to your online legacy.			
☐ allows your authorised friends access to your online messages.			
☐ keeps everybody away from reading or downloading your online post.			
6. Which of these sentences is TRUE?	☐	☐	☐
☐ There is no site that gives out the passwords of deceased users.			
☐ Microsoft provides access to all messages in a dead user's account.			
☐ Facebook provides legal advice on the deceased user's e-mails.			
☐ Gmail allows free access to a deceased person's account.			
7. Jeremy Toeman's *Legacy Locker* site…	☐	☐	☐
☐ gives everybody free access to your account once your death is certified.			
☐ makes a copy of all your e-mails and leaves it to your family after your death.			
☐ makes all your digital posthumous legacy available to allowed people.			
☐ contacts all your relatives and close friends to let them know your death.			
8. According to the text, responses to the new "death sites" are:	☐	☐	☐
☐ sceptical.			
☐ indifferent.			
☐ neither positive nor negative.			
☐ divided.			

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

LIVING IN HARMONY WITH THE LAND

The Himba live in the northwest of Namibia in the Kunene region, near the river of the same name. The land is the driest and most **barren** region of Namibia, with less than 250 mm of rain a year. There is little farming and few roads. The mountains are hard to access. The largest town in the region, Opuwo, has only about 5,000 inhabitants. But this impenetrable wilderness has also meant that Himba people have been able to preserve their traditional way of life.

These semi-nomadic people number between 20,000 and 50,000. They live in the northwest of Namibia and mainly **breed** cows and goats. It is the children's job to look after the goats and also to **grind** corn, while the adults look after the cows. Himba society is divided into groups and clans and, unsurprisingly, the head of a clan is its eldest male member.

It has not been easy for the Himba to preserve their traditions. In 1904, when Namibia was ruled by Germany, Himba people were nearly exterminated. Starting in the 1920s, South African rulers confined them to a restricted "homeland," officially forbidding them to trade, breed farm animals freely, or garden and collect wild plants along the Kunene River. When dry weather and war struck Namibia in the 1980s, it looked as if the culture of the indigenous Himba people might disintegrate. Ninety percent of Himba **cattle**, the centre of their economy and identity, died. Some families left for Angola. Yet they resisted—even if at times it meant eating the **hides** they slept on.

With the peace and good rains that came to Namibia in the 1990s, the Himba rebuilt their **herds** and, working with international activists, helped block a proposed hydro-electric dam that would have inundated ancestral lands along the Kunene. They also have benefited from new opportunities provided by the government of independent Namibia—mobile schools where Himba children learn English and **conservancies** that give Himba control of wildlife and tourism on their lands. Vengapi Tijvinda, a grandmother in her 50s, lived through this rebirth. In the 1980s she was making baskets for tourists. Now she has returned to farming and raising cattle: "Life is still the same, but the children can read and write. I am a member of a **conservancy**, and now we can taste animal meat again".

In 1996 the government of Namibia made it possible for the Himba to profit from increased wildlife populations through a program that allows them to manage their shared property as a registered conservancy. This programme—officially called the Community Based Natural Resource Management Programme—requires that a group wanting to form a conservancy establish its membership and define the limits of the land they share, write a constitution and elect a governing committee. When the group's application is accepted by Namibia's Ministry of Environment and Tourism, the conservancy begins to manage the wildlife and other resources on its land according to principles of sustainable use, while continuing with traditional farming. Because conservancies can also control tourism on their land, they are able to contract with commercial tour operators and establish their own tourist facilities. Because a healthy wildlife population is a big tourist attraction, illegal hunting is down, animal numbers are increasing, and efforts are going into maintaining the natural environment that supports wildlife. And perhaps most important, indigenous people like the Himba, whose lives were for generations largely controlled by outside governments, are regaining local control over the future of their communities.

Text adapted from *National Geographic*

barren: àrid / árido
breed: criar
grind: moldre / moler
cattle: bestiar / ganado
hides: pells d'animals / pieles de animales
herds: ramats / manadas
conservancy: espai protegit / espacio protegido

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The Himba people live in…	☐	☐	☐
☐ a rainy region densely populated.			
☐ a mountainous region with good farming conditions.			
☐ a dry region badly communicated.			
☐ a traditional region known for its lakes and rivers.			
2. In Himba culture, children…	☐	☐	☐
☐ spend most of their time playing in the fields.			
☐ are taught traditional arts and crafts.			
☐ are in charge of looking after the cows.			
☐ play an important role in processing food.			
3. According to the text, the Himba people…	☐	☐	☐
☐ had to face many adverse circumstances.			
☐ lost their identity during the German domination.			
☐ were forced to sell most of their cattle to South African rulers.			
☐ were given housing and farming land in Angola.			
4. In the last decades life for the Himba…	☐	☐	☐
☐ has been troubled by monthly rains.			
☐ has improved in many ways.			
☐ has been difficult because of international activists.			
☐ has become much more expensive because of tourism.			
5. At present, Vengapi Tijvinda…	☐	☐	☐
☐ devotes her time to traditional crafts.			
☐ has to work in the tourist sector.			
☐ is finally learning how to read and write.			
☐ has recovered her old way of life.			
6. In a registered conservancy members are supposed…	☐	☐	☐
☐ to limit the increase of tourism.			
☐ to become commercial tour operators.			
☐ to preserve wildlife and traditional farming.			
☐ to refuse the property of the land.			
7. The government of Namibia is now helping the Himba…	☐	☐	☐
☐ to learn how to live away from their land.			
☐ to control the influence of tourism.			
☐ to become more autonomous.			
☐ to defend themselves from wildlife.			
8. The story of the Himba is best described as one of…	☐	☐	☐
☐ hardship and survival.			
☐ tradition and wealth.			
☐ happiness and dreams.			
☐ leisure and freedom.			

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió escrita ☐

WHAT THE AU PAIR SAW

Silvia, an 18-year-old from Bratislava, the capital of Slovakia, could not believe how **mean** her employers were. They hardly spoke to her, made her work very long hours for very little pay and restricted her access to food. Silvia didn't work in a shop. She was an au pair to a middle-class British family.

Silvia's story comes from a new book, called *Au Pair*, which takes a full and honest look at British families from the sincere point of view of the girls who come to look after their children and help around the house.

The book focuses on the experiences of 50 Slovakian au pairs who have lived with more than 100 **host families** in London. Its author is Zuzana Burikova, a Slovakian sociologist who has been working on this project for more than three years.

The book's most noticeable feature is the pejorative view that au pairs develop towards their host British families. In particular, they are highly critical of the *'having it all'* culture. British **parenting**, it seems, is shockingly bad. The book suggests that the British concept of a woman's right to a career as well as a family is viewed negatively by au pairs. The author thinks that "au pairs generally feel that any family that chooses to have an au pair must, by definition, either be lazy, or lack proper care and consideration for children and for people in general".

In the book we can read about the experience of an au pair called Jarmila, whose host mother worked at home as a clothes designer. Even when she was not working, her child spent all his time with Jarmila, who really felt like a second mother. Another case is that of Darinka, who was fascinated by "English mothers constantly talking about quality time and feeling guilty if they were not actually reading to or playing with their children". In fact, in most cases it was pretty clear they spent very little time with their children. "English women do love their children," Darinka **reluctantly** admits, "but the problem is that they are just not able to combine childcare, housework and a career."

From the experiences in the book we can learn that "food is a particularly tricky issue," says Ms. Burikova. "I'm surprised that children and parents do not eat the same food and that parents buy healthy food like vegetables and fish for themselves but not for their children." Zuzana Burikova explains that "the British like TV programmes where experts tell them how to keep their home, since they don't know how to do it themselves. That's why they need au pairs."

And yet, as with all things, there is a **flip side**. And not all families are cold and unfeeling. In the book we can read the experience of Tina. Tina worked in London as an au pair about nine years ago. She had an absolutely terrific time in there, and there was good understanding between Tina and her host family, as a result of which the family decided to **put her up** until she finished her studies.

After having studied all these experiences, Zuzana Burikova comes to the conclusion that none of all these au pairs' negative experiences stop people from applying for the job. Most Slovakian women go to Britain to work as an au pair in order to learn the language and earn some money at the same time, but there are also others that accept this job because it's a way of escaping from their families or simply because they have just split up with their boyfriend. So, up to a point, the arrangement suits them.

Text adapted from *The Sunday Times* (August 1, 2010)

mean: mesquí, gasiu / mezquino, tacaño
host family: família d'acollida / familia de acogida
parenting: criança / crianza
reluctantly: a contracor / a su pesar
flip side: l'altra cara de la moneda / la otra cara de la moneda
to put her up: acollir-la, contractar-la / acogerla, contratarla

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The book called *Au Pair* is about... ☐ the way Slovakian au pairs look after their own children. ☐ how Slovakian families should raise their children. ☐ what Slovakian au pairs think about British families. ☐ the way Slovakian girls can get a job in England.	☐	☐	☐
2. After reading the text, the *'having it all'* culture could be explained as… ☐ British women's aim of working out instead of being mothers. ☐ the idea of bringing up children and working at the same time. ☐ the difficult choice between having a family and working at the same time. ☐ the idea of having an au pair at home to look after the children.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, the British idea of a modern woman… ☐ is not shared by Slovakian au pairs. ☐ is generally accepted by au pairs. ☐ is never criticised by au pairs. ☐ has become a model for Slovakian au pairs.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to Ms. Burikova's book, some British families contract au pairs because… ☐ they think it is the cheapest way of educating their children. ☐ they can't survive without the au pair's help. ☐ they can't afford to raise their children on their own. ☐ they don't care enough about their children.	☐	☐	☐
5. Darinka thinks that most English mothers… ☐ do their best to look after their children. ☐ do not spend enough time with their children. ☐ prefer their careers to their children. ☐ play their role successfully.	☐	☐	☐
6. By saying that "food is a particularly tricky issue" Ms. Burikova suggests that parents… ☐ don't feed their children healthily. ☐ only care about what their children eat. ☐ do not care about their health problems. ☐ believe their children are healthy enough.	☐	☐	☐
7. Tina's experience as an au pair was… ☐ terrible. ☐ wonderful. ☐ depressing. ☐ unbelievable.	☐	☐	☐
8. Most Slovakian au pairs apply for the job mainly because… ☐ they want to travel abroad to get a well-paid job. ☐ it's a good opportunity to leave their homes and relatives. ☐ their love relationships are broken and they want to meet new people. ☐ it's a way of learning a language and earning some money.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

THE *CAMINO DE SANTIAGO*, THE ENGLISH WAY

I was somewhere near Betanzos and I didn't know I was lost, but a passer-by guessed I was doing the *Camino*, said something I did not understand and pointed down the hill. So I retraced my steps about 50 metres, and there was the sign of the **scallop shell**.

The *Camino de Santiago*—or St James's Way—started attracting international **pilgrims** more than 1,000 years ago. By the 12th century, half a million a year were arriving in Santiago de Compostela to pay homage to a mythical early missionary who had a habit of appearing on battlefields to help the Christians. An early guidebook, the *Codex Calixtinus*, detailed the route, and a chain of hostels (called *albergues*) was built to give the pilgrims places of rest.

Nowadays, the hostels are still there, and they are so cheap as to be almost free. In Galicia official hostels cost €6 per night; some hostels along the way ask only for donations. The route is still **waymarked** with the scallop shell that became the pilgrim symbol, and after many centuries of little use the numbers of pilgrims are increasing again.

In a Holy Year, the pilgrimage is even more valued. Holy Years pilgrims occur whenever St James's Day (25 July) falls on a Sunday, as was the case in 2010, when 250,000 pilgrims—double the usual number—arrived in Santiago to claim their *compostela* (certificate of completion) and hug the statue of St James in the cathedral in the hope of absolute **forgiveness**. Even the Pope made an appearance this year.

There's not just one *Camino* across Spain, but five. The main route is the French Way, a difficult walk across northern Spain. Then there's the Portuguese Way, the Silver Way, the Northern Way and the English Way. This one is the shortest and the least crowded—and the one I was taking. It starts from the ports of either La Coruña or El Ferrol, where the English originally arrived by boat. It mixes coastal scenery with rural Spain, includes some handsome seaside towns and less handsome industrial sites, and can be done in less than a week. At times it felt to me quite English, too, as I walked between flower-rich **hedgerows** and crossed rivulets that could have been in Cornwall, except for the fragrant eucalyptus and vineyards on south-facing hills. And although it would probably have been more appropriate to stay in an *albergue*, I chose to do it the easy way, walking between designated points, and stopping at lovely rural hotels in the evening.

I'm not, really, a true pilgrim and I'm no believer (but neither are many of the walkers who **set out** every year on this oldest example of mass tourism). I wasn't expecting absolution. I wanted simply to enjoy an inexpensive long-distance walk through a little known part of Spain. That didn't diminish my satisfaction on arriving in Santiago, however, a historic city which makes an appropriate end to a form of tourism that hasn't fundamentally changed since medieval times.

Although I hadn't done enough to collect my *compostela* (you must complete at least 100 km and have the stamps to prove it), I felt so satisfied with myself on arrival that I went to pilgrim Mass in the magnificent sculpture-covered cathedral. Outside, the main square was full of buskers, beggars and pilgrims, tanned and smiley, just as it's been happening over the centuries.

Text adapted from *The Independent* (July 24, 2010)

scallop shell: petxina de vieira / concha de vieira
pilgrim: pelegrí / peregrino
waymarked: senyalitzat / señalizado
hedgerow: tanca / valla
forgiveness: perdó / perdón
to set out: sortir, començar el camí / partir, empezar el camino

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The writer got lost while he was doing the *Camino*…	☐	☐	☐
☐ and asked the way to a passer-by.			
☐ but he was lucky to find the scallop shell that marks the way.			
☐ and a man gave him directions even before he asked.			
☐ and he had to walk a long way back to get on the right track.			
2. According to the text, which of the following sentences is FALSE?	☐	☐	☐
☐ Pilgrims started to come to Santiago in the 12th century.			
☐ Pilgrims who take on St James' Way come from many different countries.			
☐ St James is a legendary character who helped win many battles.			
☐ The *Codex Calixtinus* was written as a guide for the pilgrims.			
3. The author explains that…	☐	☐	☐
☐ you can stay for free in all the hostels on the route.			
☐ you just pay a small amount to spend a night in an *albergue*.			
☐ you must make a donation in all the hostels.			
☐ official hostels are cheap, but unofficial ones are not.			
4. In a Holy Year…	☐	☐	☐
☐ the Pope always visits Santiago.			
☐ pilgrims cannot get their *compostela*.			
☐ the number of pilgrims always doubles that of a normal year.			
☐ pilgrims who take on the *Camino* expect absolute forgiveness.			
5. The English way…	☐	☐	☐
☐ starts in Cornwall and runs through coastal towns.			
☐ must be taken along the seaside by boat.			
☐ was preferred by the English people because it was easier.			
☐ doesn't take as long to complete as the other routes.			
6. As he was walking, the author felt…	☐	☐	☐
☐ as if he was in England because the landscape was similar to that of Cornwall.			
☐ that the eucalyptus and the vineyards he found on the way are typically English.			
☐ that it was just as easy to stay in an *albergue* or in a hotel.			
☐ that staying in rural hotels was what an English pilgrim should do.			
7. The author did the *Camino* because…	☐	☐	☐
☐ he had strong religious beliefs, just like many other pilgrims.			
☐ as a pilgrim, he was looking for absolution.			
☐ he wanted to experience a cheap walking holiday.			
☐ he had never been to Santiago before.			
8. When he reached Santiago, he was very pleased because…	☐	☐	☐
☐ he had won his *compostela.*			
☐ he had to attend Mass in the cathedral.			
☐ he could see the buskers and beggars in the square.			
☐ he had completed the *Camino*.			

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

DIGITAL AND TRADITIONAL TOOLS

Do the latest social networks encourage strong relationships or weak ones? Generally speaking, digital ties aren't as powerful as the friendships and **commitments** we make in person.

Twitter and Facebook, when used together with other tools of human **connectedness**, can be extremely useful. Digital networks haven't replaced physical togetherness and conversation, even if it sometimes feels that way. Yes, it is true that some people have effectively moved their entire lives online, and the media have for years covered every digital phenomenon, no matter how trivial.

Thankfully, however, the silly use of social networks is beginning to die down. What's emerging in its place is a more intelligent and constructive view of the digital future, one that **embraces** the enormous promise of these technologies while accepting their limitations.

Twitter and Facebook aren't going to save the world. But when used alongside other tools of human connectedness—including some very old ones, like the face-to-face conversations, meetings and protests that **drove** the civil rights movement in the USA—the new technologies can be extremely useful. We can learn a lot from our digital life and make real friends there. But if we never turn off the screen and don't use those **gains** in our life, what use would they be? Digital networking and more traditional forms of communication aren't mutually exclusive—they feed into each other.

American writer Clay Shirky tells in his book *Here Comes Everybody*, about how, through the wonders of digital networking, a New Yorker recovered a lost cell phone. His book is full of stories about really important social and organizational change that was significantly helped along—if not entirely created—by the newer gadgets.

Change begins with great ideas. Shirky says that among the 50 or so people he follows on Twitter are the Dalai Lama and a community of Benedictine monks who make writing journals and other paper products with the intention of slowing down our over-busy minds. "When I pick up a valuable new thought on Twitter, I try to take it with me into the non-digital world, where we should all be spending more time these days," he says. "That's where the real revolutions happen."

Professor Rheinghold, from Berkeley University, said about Twitter: "You have to learn how to make it add value rather than subtract hours from one's day. Certainly, it may cause distraction. But it also makes possible the formation of forums called *personal learning networks*". He explains that he values Twitter because of its openness, its immediacy, variety, reciprocity, its channel to multiple publics, its potential for allowing networks to become communities and the mass collaborations it enables.

The Web can be a labyrinth of abusive language and misinformation, but it can also be an accessible and inexpensive medium for community-building and political activism. The difference lies not in the technology but in the literacy—**know-how** is the critical difference. Those who gain the know-how to transform networks into movements might gain the keys to power—for better or worse—in coming decades.

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (September 30, 2010)

commitment: compromís / compromiso
connectedness: relació, comunicació / relación, comunicación
to embrace: incloure, abraçar / incluir, abarcar
to drive: moure, impulsar / mover, impulsar
gain: guany / ganancia
know-how: coneixements, experiència / conocimientos, experiencia

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The author…	☐	☐	☐
☐ prefers personal relationships to digital ties.			
☐ thinks digital ties have destroyed personal conversation and commitment.			
☐ is against friendships made through the networks.			
☐ thinks personal friendships are stronger than those made through the net.			
2. According to the article, the civil rights movement in the USA was an example of…	☐	☐	☐
☐ excellent communication and togetherness.			
☐ the power of bringing people together in forums of discussion and protest.			
☐ very old forms of communicating.			
☐ how the world could be saved by protesting.			
3. According to the author, Twitter and Facebook can be very useful in the future…	☐	☐	☐
☐ if they are used alongside traditional forms of communication.			
☐ whenever they are connected with one another.			
☐ because they have been replaced by human togetherness.			
☐ because the digital phenomenon is a true religion.			
4. The author thinks that we can learn a lot from our digital life if we…	☐	☐	☐
☐ combine the best of both worlds by bringing our digital world onto our real one.			
☐ use the new technologies to make more and more friends.			
☐ never turn off the screen on our computer.			
☐ expand networking and exclude traditional forms of communication.			
5. American writer Clay Shirky says that the real revolutions take place…	☐	☐	☐
☐ in the digital world.			
☐ among those who learn to live a more peaceful life.			
☐ in the non-digital world.			
☐ among the followers of wise men.			
6. What is Professor Rheinghold's opinion about Twitter?	☐	☐	☐
☐ He thinks Twitter is more open than any other network.			
☐ He considers it to be useless and that it takes a lot of your time.			
☐ He likes it because it is the best way for communicating.			
☐ He finds it valuable if you know how to extract its benefits.			
7. The author's views on the new social networks could be said to be generally…	☐	☐	☐
☐ positive.			
☐ negative.			
☐ sceptical.			
☐ indifferent.			
8. The article concludes that…	☐	☐	☐
☐ it is impossible to tell what is good from what is bad on the net.			
☐ there is too much information on the net.			
☐ only those who control the net will be successful in the world.			
☐ the Internet may become the most powerful political tool in the future.			

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length.

[4 points: 1 point for grammar, 1 point for vocabulary and spelling, 1 point for cohesion, and 1 point for adequacy and coherence]

1. You recently attended an international online workshop on cooking healthy food. You want to thank the workshop coordinator for how useful this workshop has been to you. Write a **formal email** to the workshop coordinator in which you highlight the quality of the workshop, explain what you learned, and suggest improvements for future workshops.

2. Over the last few years, the number of teenagers suffering from stress and anxiety has increased significantly in many developed countries. Schools, parents, and health organisations are debating possible solutions to improve students' well-being and reduce pressure. Some experts believe that schools should not give homework or hold traditional exams, while others argue that it is necessary for academic progress. Write an **opinion essay** on whether homework and/or exams should be limited or abolished for secondary school students, giving reasons and examples to support your view.

Grammar	
Vocabulary and spelling	
Cohesion	
Adequacy and coherence	
Writing score	

Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length.

[4 points: 1 point for grammar, 1 point for vocabulary and spelling, 1 point for cohesion, and 1 point for adequacy and coherence]

1. Before going to university, you would like to spend a semester abroad improving your English while working as an au pair. Write a **formal email** to an au pair agency applying for a job as an au pair and explaining why you would like this job, your experience in childcare and the personal qualities and skills that would make you the ideal person for the job.

2. Up to 2025, Catalonia suffered from serious water supply problems that affected agriculture, industries, and personal use at home due to the prolonged absence of rainfall. The Government acted by implementing measures that affected many of us, regardless of the quantity of water we used. Write an **opinion essay** on the policies and regulations created to control water usage to be published in the school newspaper.

Grammar	
Vocabulary and spelling	
Cohesion	
Adequacy and coherence	
Writing score	

Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length.

[4 points: 1 point for grammar, 1 point for vocabulary and spelling, 1 point for cohesion, and 1 point for adequacy and coherence]

1. During your school's Communication Week, students will take part in a debate about the growing impact that social media influencers have on teenagers' behaviour, lifestyle choices, and opinions. You have been asked to write a **for and against essay** discussing both the positive and negative effects that influencers may have on young people. In your text, you should consider aspects such as the promotion of healthy or unhealthy habits, the reliability of sponsored content, and the pressure to conform to certain beauty or success standards.

2. Imagine working in your ideal job. **Write a description** of a full day at work in detail, beginning with how you commute to your workplace and what your morning routine is like. Explain your exact daily tasks and responsibilities, the people you work with, and the type of environment you work in. Include information about your colleagues, your interactions with them, and how you collaborate. Finally, explain whether you enjoy this job or not, giving clear reasons for your satisfaction or dissatisfaction.

Grammar	
Vocabulary and spelling	
Cohesion	
Adequacy and coherence	
Writing score	

Part 3: Writing

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[4 points: 1 point for grammar, 1 point for vocabulary and spelling, 1 point for cohesion and 1 point for adequacy and coherence.]

1. In many households, traditional dishes are disappearing, and only the older generations of the family still cook them, whereas the young tend to prefer some form of fast food. Your teacher has organized a class debate in which you will have to defend traditional food. As a conclusion to the debate, the teacher would like you to write an **opinion essay** with your views on the topic. In your text you should mention why you think this is happening, examples of recipes that are being lost, the advantages that these dishes have and why it is important to keep this heritage.

2. You are attending a creative writing class where you are working on feelings and sensations. For next week, you have been asked to write a **description** of a single day during your favorite season of the year. Whether it's a crisp autumn morning, a bright summer afternoon, or a snowy winter evening, bring the season to life with descriptive details. Focus on the atmosphere, the activities, and the sensations that make this day so memorable.

Grammar	
Vocabulary and spelling	
Cohesion	
Adequacy and coherence	
Writing score	

Part 3: Writing

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[4 points: 1 point for grammar, 1 point for vocabulary and spelling, 1 point for cohesion and 1 point for adequacy and coherence.]

1. You and some friends have been to a new restaurant in your town which you enjoyed very much. The owners ask you to write a **review** in Google or Trip Advisor to help them publicize it. Mention the type of food they serve, their best dishes, the ingredients they use, the service, the decoration, the value for money and any other aspect that is worth mentioning.

2. We all know life is full of ups and downs. Imagine you recently faced a significant personal challenge. Write a **narrative essay** for your high school's newspaper about a time when you faced this challenge. This could be an academic, emotional, or physical obstacle. Describe the situation, the decisions you made to overcome it, and the lessons you learned from the experience.

Grammar	
Vocabulary and spelling	
Cohesion	
Adequacy and coherence	
Writing score	

Part 3: Writing

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[4 points: 1 point for grammar, 1 point for vocabulary and spelling, 1 point for cohesion and 1 point for adequacy and coherence.]

1. Turning 18 entails making many decisions in life, such as deciding who to vote for, choosing your future education or looking for a job to pay for your education, among many others. Write an **email** to a friend or family member reflecting on your latest life-changing decisions, including your plans or goals. It could be related to career aspirations, travel plans, or personal development. Share your thoughts with this person and finish by asking for their input or experiences.

2. As part of a project on housing, your school has invited a group of interior designers and architects. They are interested in how spaces influence emotions and wellbeing. They say home is where your heart is and a place where you feel most comfortable and at peace. Write a **description** of this place that is home to you. It could be a physical location, like your childhood bedroom, a favorite park, a family gathering spot, or even a corner of a cafe. Use vivid sensory details (sights, sounds, smells, textures, and tastes) to help the designers experience the place as you do.

Grammar	
Vocabulary and spelling	
Cohesion	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. With fast fashion, consumers are offered constantly changing collections at low prices, and encouraged to frequently buy and discard clothes. Do you follow fast fashion, or do you prefer more durable clothes? Write a **for-and-against essay** in which you explain the pros and cons of fast fashion.

2. You have bought several products online from a well-known website but some of them have not arrived while the ones which have are not in good condition. Write a **formal email** to customer service complaining about the service and requesting some compensation.

3. Write a **description** of a place you have been to or would like to visit. Explain where the place is, why it is special and what things you can see or do there. Do not forget to give your opinion or a recommendation.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Social networks are everywhere, and you are probably a regular user of at least one of them. Select your favorite social network platform where you engage the most and write a **review** of it, including aspects such as overall user experience, specific features, content quality, community engagement, or any other aspect that stands out to you.

2. Many children participate in extracurricular activities (sports, foreign languages, arts and crafts, music…) beyond their academic commitments for many different reasons. Consider the potential benefits as well as the potential downsides of this practice and write a **for-and-against essay**.

3. Write a **narrative** about a day when you found yourself exploring a new and unfamiliar city. Describe the places you visited, the people you encountered, and any unexpected events that made the adventure memorable. Include details about how you moved around the city and what you learned from the experience.

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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Advertising plays a significant role in shaping consumer choices. Write an **opinion essay** examining the influence of advertising on consumer behavior. Discuss the power of persuasion, ethical considerations, and the impact of advertising on societal values and priorities.

2. Write a **formal email** addressing a complaint to a customer service department. Clearly describe the problem, provide necessary details, and request a solution or explanation.

3. Choose a popular comedy TV series available on streaming platforms and write a **review** for young viewers. Analyze the humor, character dynamics, and the show's overall appeal. Discuss specific episodes or story arcs that stood out and why you believe it would resonate with a young audience.

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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Young people spend a lot of time texting and playing on their smartphones, sometimes over three hours a day. Write a **blog entry** encouraging alternative activities that may be interesting for young people and prevent them from using their smartphones so much every day.

2. Travelling by plane helps you make the most of your holiday by taking you places with speed and efficient use of time. However, it is said that emissions from aviation are a significant contributor to climate change. How do you think we should handle this situation? Write an **opinion essay** about it for your local paper.

3. Imagine you've gone to one of the immersion shows described in the Reading comprehension text (Part 2). Write an **email** to a friend in which you explain the experience and suggest you both go together in the near future.

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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. You and your family went on holiday and rented an apartment through an online booking website. The apartment was not located where it was supposed to be, was in bad condition and did not include all the facilities that were described on the website. Write a **complaint email** to the Customer Service department of the booking agency and ask for some kind of compensation.

2. Environmental fines are often imposed on industries and companies and even polluting vehicle owners but hardly ever on individual citizens who do not recycle or respect the environment. Given the world's climate situation, should governments start making individual citizens pay environmental fines? For example, should people report to the government on their neighbours who do not recycle, or who still have traditional light bulbs and not LEDs? Would this be good for society? Write a **for-and-against essay**.

3. Hobbies are often overlooked by parents because they want their kids to do well in school. As a result, hobbies are usually not considered to be important. Can some hobbies be turned into a class taught in schools? How do you think parents should act towards kids who care more about their hobbies than getting good grades? Write an **opinion essay**.

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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Travelling by plane leaves an enormous carbon footprint that contributes to global warming. Yet, flying is often the fastest means of transport between two locations. Write an **opinion essay** discussing whether a government should regulate the citizens' use of transportation based on environmental criteria.

2. Write a **descriptive essay** about an occurrence that taught you a lot about how to deal (or how not to deal) with people. You can focus on one event or person, or on something that you learnt gradually in different situations.

3. Many cities in Europe are changing their traffic patterns by eliminating lanes for cars while opening more lanes for bicycles and battery-powered scooters and promoting public transportation. Some people like the idea of fewer cars in cities, but some business owners say that fewer cars means fewer customers. In addition, some residents say that taking public transportation is not always an option. Write a **for-and-against essay** about campaigns to restrict private car traffic in cities.

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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Many towns in Catalonia celebrate local festivals. Write an **article** for a travel magazine in which you explain and describe a local festival or celebration that you know well.

2. A national park is a large area of land which is protected by the government because of its natural beauty, plants, or animals, and which the public can usually visit with some restrictions. Have you ever visited a national park? What did you do there? Did you see any wild animals or protected flora? Write a **narrative text** in which you explain your experience there.

3. Governments often create national parks to protect wildlife and encourage conservation. Do you think governments are doing enough to protect animals in their natural habitat? Do you think governments have to take more forceful action to protect animals? Write an **opinion essay**.

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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Many traditions from the United States, such as Halloween or the character of Santa Claus, have been exported to other cultures. Write a **for-and-against essay** discussing to what extent this enriches or has a negative effect on one's own traditions.

2. Football has become a phenomenon that involves a lot of people and money. Today only important teams that have a lot of money to hire the best players in the world have a chance to win major tournaments and trophies. Do you think that football has become something other than a sport and has lost its original spirit? Write an **opinion essay**.

3. The COVID-19 pandemic has had a huge impact on cultural events. Write a **narrative essay** explaining your experience at the last concert, music festival or theatrical performance that you attended.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. In our country, young people tend to live with their parents for much longer than they do in other European countries or in the United States. Write an **opinion essay** analyzing the reasons why you think this may be so.

2. What are the key ingredients for a successful holiday trip? Write a **blog entry** in which you give recommendations to your readers about how to plan their holidays so that they can make the most of their leisure time.

3. People around the world have strong opinions about governments requiring COVID-19 vaccinations. Write an **argumentative essay** in which you take a side in the vaccination debate. Make sure to support your view with arguments.

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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. "Medical research is subject to ethical standards that promote and ensure respect for all human subjects and protect their health and rights. While the primary purpose of medical research is to generate new knowledge, this goal can never take precedence over the rights and interests of individual research subjects." Write a **for-and-against essay** about the rights and interests of individuals vs. the goal of advancing medical knowledge.

2. The #BlackLivesMatter movement is dedicated to fighting racism and anti-black violence, especially in the form of police brutality, and demands that society value the lives and humanity of black people as much as it values the lives and humanity of white people. Do you think such a movement is necessary today? Write an **opinion essay**.

3. Imagine that you have a friend who doesn't know if they want to study at university after high school or if they want to enroll in a program of vocational or professional training for 1 or 2 years. Write an **email** to them giving advice on their future studies.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Last summer you went rock climbing in the Pyrenees and realized that all the surroundings were full of plastic waste. Write an **informal letter** to a friend of yours describing your feelings.

2. Imagine that you are the chief editor of an important newspaper and you decide to write an editorial about the environment and global warming. Write a **formal essay** arguing for strong, efficient measures to protect the environment.

3. You have recently finished high school. A few years from now, when you look back on your time in high school, what part will you remember fondly? And which part will you wish you could forget? Write an **essay** describing how you think you will view your high school experience.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Due to your low marks, you have been punished and for the next three months your access to Internet after school is strictly limited to 30 minutes a day during the school week and to 1 hour a day on Saturdays and Sundays. Do you think this is an effective punishment? Write an **opinion essay**.

2. Live animals are used by many companies in the beauty industry for the testing of cosmetics. Many activists for animal rights claim that this practice should be stopped because it is cruel to the animals. The companies claim that testing on live animals is necessary to ensure safe products for humans. What do you think? Should beauty products that have been tested on animals be banned by the government? Write a **for-and-against essay**.

3. All of us occasionally have arguments with our friends, even with people who have been our very close friends for a long time. Big arguments sometimes mean the end of a friendship, and that often upsets us. In other cases, we are able to forgive and forget, and continue on with our friendship. Write a **narrative** about an argument with your best friend.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
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Maturity	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Some people believe that making a lot of money and being famous are the true signs of happiness. Do you agree? **Write an opinion essay**.

2. Animal activists all over Europe have organized campaigns against displaying live animals in zoos because they say that animals in captivity suffer from boredom and stress, and that keeping animals in cages is cruel. As a result, many European cities are considering closing their zoos. What do you think? Is it cruel to keep animals in a zoo? **Write a for-and-against essay** for zoos.

3. Most young people today use some form of social media, and many actively use several forms. **Write an essay** describing the role of social media in your life.

Grammar	
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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. What do you think of the environmental impact of fashion? Do we need to buy new clothes all the time? **Write an opinion essay** discussing the effects that fast fashion, like that promoted by chains like Zara and Primark, has on the environment.

2. All of us experience very happy moments at one time or another. **Write a narrative essay** about the happiest moment in someone's life.

3. There have been several scientific studies demonstrating that teenagers' health improves greatly if they eat a good breakfast and wake up late. This is usually difficult to achieve, because high school students often begin classes before 8 a.m., which means that many must wake up very early in order to eat breakfast and arrive at school on time. However, starting later would mean finishing classes later in the day. Do you think high schools should have a later start time? **Write a for-and-against essay**.

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Part 3: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Governments often try to influence what people choose to eat or drink by taxing some foods and beverages more than others. For example, sugary drinks have an extra tax on them in many places (Catalonia included), and the sale of alcoholic drinks is controlled by governments in most countries and highly taxed in many. The reading comprehension text suggests that meat should be taxed more in order to reduce the amount of meat people eat. Should governments try to influence our dietary habits? **Write a for-and-against essay**.

2. Reality television is extremely popular in many countries. Why are reality shows so successful? **Write an opinion essay**.

3. Many authors have written about time travel, and there have been several successful films about it, too. If you could time travel, would you visit the past or the future? Where would you go, and why? **Write an essay** about your ideal time travel experience.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. "Emoji is the new language of the heart." Do you agree with the author's statement? **Write an opinion essay**.

2. Although friendships can last a lifetime, it is also true that sometimes our relationship with a friend or someone in our family can take a turn for the worse. **Write a narrative essay** explaining what led to the breakup of a friendship.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Do you buy music or do you pirate it? Some people argue that we should put an end to music piracy, as it generates huge losses for the record companies and music artists. Others claim that the record companies already have enough money, and that the prices they charge are too expensive. **Write a for-and-against essay** in which you state the pros and cons of paying for music.

2. You have missed a flight due to unexpected delays but you are not offered any rebooking or any compensation from the airline. **Write an email** to the customer service department complaining about the service and asking for compensation. Make sure you do NOT use your own name in your email.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
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Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words. [4 points]

1. Art plays an essential role in all cultures, and for thousands of years people have been creating, criticizing, and enjoying art. Imagine that you are visiting an art museum or exhibit, and you would like to share your feelings and sensations with your best friend. **Write an email** to him/her explaining your experience. Make sure you do NOT use your own name in your email.

2. Governments often make many addictive substances illegal because they may harm the health of those who take them. But alcohol and tobacco may also be dangerous to a person's health, and they are legal. Should the government make these substances illegal? **Write an opinion essay.**

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. **Write an essay** on the consequences that the use of the latest morphing technology might have for news agencies and the lack of trust in the media.

2. Do you shop online, or do you like to go to stores? Does the type of product you are looking for make a difference in your decision? Are online stores fair competition for "real" stores? **Write an essay** in which you discuss some of the advantages and disadvantages of online shopping.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Many of the people working at Bletchley Park were good at languages and all had to be able to keep secrets. Imagine you are applying for a job as a code-breaker at a modern equivalent of Bletchley Park. **Write a formal letter** to the director explaining why you would be an excellent worker. Remember NOT to use your own name in the letter.

2. Black Friday in November has quickly become the biggest shopping day in many countries and not just in the United States, where it originated. Is it a good idea for shop owners to offer large discounts before the Christmas holidays? Do you think it is necessary to have such a day, or is it only a new form of consumerism? **Write an opinion essay.**

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Can we judge others by the way they look? Does a person's appearance influence his or her character? **Write an opinion essay.**

2. Next academic year you may be living in a shared flat with other students or in a university residence, or maybe you'll be staying in your own house with your family. **Write a 'for and against' essay** explaining the advantages and disadvantages of living away from home while you're a university student. Make sure you do NOT use your own name in your essay.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. You and a friend are planning to go shopping. You want to go on Black Friday and take advantage of all the bargains, but your friend thinks this day only promotes consumerism. Write the dialogue between you and your friend. Make sure you do NOT use your own name in your dialogue.

2. Buy Nothing Day was created as a reaction to the Black Friday shopping madness, and its creators want people to reflect on their consumer habits and to make them consume less and produce less waste. Do you agree with this idea? Write an opinion essay.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. What sort of diet should teenagers have? Do most teenagers you know "eat right"? Write an essay for your school newsletter on what teenagers really eat, and include your opinion on what they should eat.

2. Imagine that you have just returned from a trip to London with your parents. Write an entry in your blog about some good and bad experiences on this trip, and on travelling with your parents in general. (Remember to NOT mention your real name, or that of anyone in your family, in this blog entry.)

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Robots and other machines now do many things that only people used to do. Do you think using robots to monitor people's health is a good idea? Would you like to have a robot monitor you when you are sick, or when you grow old? Write an opinion essay.

2. You and your older relative have very different views of mobile phones. You think using a mobile phone is essential for maintaining contact with your friends and finding out what is going on in the world, and your older relative thinks that mobile phones may be convenient but really don't replace personal meetings, conventional telephones, watching television or reading the newspaper. Write the dialogue between you.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Cinemas in many towns and cities across the country are closing because of a lack of public. Imagine that the only cinema left in your town is about to close. Write a letter to your local newspaper arguing in favor of keeping the cinema open.

2. Explain a bad travel experience you have had. Give as many details as possible about places, people and things that went wrong, and how it all ended up. You may include some funny anecdotes, if there were any.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. You have been invited to spend some time with the Jones, an Australian family, in Sydney. Write a letter or an e-mail to their 17-year-old daughter Sarah, talking about the things you expect to learn during your stay in Australia.

2. Today the influence of English on other languages appears to be very extensive. What are the pros and cons of that situation? Do you think we are using too many English words in our own languages? Write an opinion essay presenting your views on these questions.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Imagine that you have set up a successful business before the age of 25. Write a biography of yourself and include a description of the company and the steps you took to make the company successful.

2. In many places, such as Canada and most states in the United States, the minimum driving age is 16. The legal driving age for automobiles in most European countries is 18. Write an opinion essay about lowering the legal driving age in Spain to 16. Your essay should mention both some advantages and some disadvantages of lowering the driving age.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Are love-locks romantic or a menace? Write a for or against essay about this practice.

2. Imagine you are Carolyn Barnabo. Write an entry in your blog explaining how your views on love-locks have changed over the years.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. What are, according to your own experience, the factors that have helped you to learn a foreign language? Write a personal narrative with the title "Learning English my way" in which you give answer to this question.

2. "Making Esperanto a common, international language is idealistic but impossible." Write an article for your school magazine with arguments for or against this statement.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Imagine that you are a soldier in the First World War. Write a letter to your parents about your experiences in the war.

2. Harry Patch did not explain his experiencies about the war until he was very elderly. Why do you think he waited for so many years? Write an opinion essay about it for your local paper.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Should the right to vote be lowered to the age of 16, instead of 18? What would be the advantages or disadvantages? Write an argumentative article giving opinions for and against this issue.

2. Imagine you are a candidate at your class delegate election. Write a school article inviting people to vote and encouraging your classmates to vote for you, explaining your arguments.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. "Speaking two languages has obvious practical benefits in an increasingly globalized world." What are these benefits? What are the main advantages and disadvantages of being bilingual? Write an argumentative essay. You may include examples from your own experience.

2. Write a letter to a pen friend (or key pal) who has never visited Catalonia. Explain the language diversity in the Catalan society and your own experience as a bilingual speaker.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. What makes a good teacher, according to your own experience? Write a personal narrative about the best teacher you ever had. Explain why she/he inspired you.

2. Imagine you meet one of your former primary school teachers who was important to you. Write the dialogue in which you and the teacher talk about past memories and experiences of those days.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Spain is significantly below the OECD average in PISA tests. What do you think is needed to improve our education system? Write an opinion essay in which you take into account the school system, the teachers and the students.

2. Imagine you are a student from Shanghai living in Catalonia. Write a letter or an email to your family in China in which you talk about the education system and study habits here and back home.

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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. You suspect a friend of yours is a bully but he/she does not want to acknowledge it. Write a conversation with him/her in which you explain why you think he/she should stop this behaviour. Suggest possible measures to help him/her fight this addiction.

2. What possible mesures, involving the school, parents and kids, could be taken in order to stop bullying at schools? Write an article for your school magazine explaining your ideas and proposals.

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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. You suspect a friend of yours suffers from nomophobia but doesn't want to accept it. Write a conversation with him/her in which you explain why you think so, and suggest possible measures to help him/her overcome this addiction.

2. Are we too dependent on mobile phones? Could we live without mobile phones nowadays? Write an opinion essay.

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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Imagine you are a journalist who had the chance to interview Steve Jobs, asking him questions about his life and his technological products. Write down that dialogue.

2. Write an opinion essay about the following question: Is it possible to live without computers nowadays?

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Write an opinion essay about how the use of the internet has changed our lives.

2. Write a dialogue between two people who are discussing about the advantages and/or disadvantages of the "death sites".

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Imagine that you went on a holiday in the land of the Himba. Write a letter telling a friend in Catalonia what you liked or disliked about your stay. Include your views on the Himba's way of life.

2. Imagine you are working for the Namibia Tourist Board. Write a text for a promotional campaign addressed to Europeans with the title: "Come to experience the real Africa in the Kunene region".

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Imagine you want to apply for a job as an au pair. Write a formal letter to an au pair agency explaining the reasons why you think you are the ideal person for the job.

2. Write an opinion essay about the following question:
"Is it better to work in your own country instead of working abroad?" Explain the advantages or disadvantages in either case.

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Write an e-mail to a friend. Explain a trip you have done recently. Talk about the places you visited, when and who with. Mention any interesting or funny anecdotes that happened during the journey.

2. You are a journalist for a travel magazine. Write an article describing a place you know well. Mention the interesting things to see and do there. Comment also on the historical background and cultural traits. Mention any practical things a traveller should take into account: currency, weather, local customs…

Grammar	
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Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. In the text, Professor Rheinghold talks about the "formation of forums called *personal learning networks*". Write an article for your school journal in which you defend the introduction of personal learning networks in your school.

2. A friend of yours has not joined Facebook yet. He/she is reluctant because of the fear of losing intimacy and spending too much of his/her time on it. Write a letter to him/her explaining the advantages or disadvantages of this digital tool. In your letter you should try to convince your friend to either join Facebook or not to do so.

Grammar	
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